

## Set Bit

**Problem:** Write a program to check if a bit is set or not.

Sample Test Case:

**Input:**

1  
4 1

**Output:**

NO

**Explanation:**

first line indicates number of test case second line read N and Kth bit set or not.

### Basic Approach

```
-----  
read t  
loop t times:  
    read num, k  
    set kbin = 1  
    loop (i = 1 to k - 1):  
        kbin=kbin*2  
  
    if (num AND kbin)!=0:  
        print "Yes"  
    else:  
        print "No"
```

### Better Approach

```
-----  
read t  
loop t times:  
    read num, k  
    num= num >> (k-1)  
if (num AND 1)==1:  
    print "Yes"  
else:
```

```
print "No"
```

### Best Approach

-----

```
if((n AND (1 << (k - 1))) != 0):  
    Print "Yes"  
else  
    Print "No"
```

## Count number of Set Bits

Problem: count the number of set bits (i.e., bits with value 1) in the binary representation of a given integer.

**Input:**

5

**Output:**

2

**Explanation:**

5 in binary  $\rightarrow$  0101  $\rightarrow$  2 set bits

```
read n
set count = 0

while n > 0:
    if n % 2 == 1:
        do count++
    n = n / 2

print count
```

Time complexity:  $O(\log n)$

```
while(n > 0) {
    if((n & 1) == 1)
        count++
    n = n >> 1
}
print count
```

**Optimized Approach (Brian Kernighan's Algorithm)  $O(K)$  where  $K$  is number of set bits**

It works by repeatedly checking the least significant bit and clearing it.

This happens due to how binary subtraction works:

- Subtracting 1 from a number flips all the bits **after** the rightmost set bit (including that bit).
- ANDing with the original number then **clears** that bit and keeps everything else the same.

```
while(n > 0)
    n = n & (n - 1)
```

```
        count++
    print count
```

```
n = 52
Binary of 52 → 110100
n - 1 = 51
Binary → 110011
n      = 110100
n - 1  = 110011
-----
n & n-1 = 110000
increment count → count = 1
```

The rightmost set bit in  $n$  is at position 2 (counting from right, 0-based).

- That bit is cleared in  $n \& (n - 1)$ .
- All higher bits remain unchanged.
- All lower bits (to the right of the cleared bit) become 0.

```
n = 48 → 110000
n - 1 = 47 → 101111
n & (n - 1) = 110000 & 101111 = 100000 → 32
increment count → count = 2
```

```
n = 32 → 100000
n - 1 = 31 → 011111
n & (n - 1) = 100000 & 011111 = 000000 → 0
increment count → count = 3
```

hence number of set bits in 52 are 3



## Sum of Set Bits

Problem: Count the total number of set bits from 1 to given range N

**Input:**

5

**Output:**

7

**Explanation:**

```
1 → 0001 → 1
2 → 0010 → 1
3 → 0011 → 2
4 → 0100 → 1
5 → 0101 → 2
Total = 1 + 1 + 2 + 1 + 2 = 7 set bits
```

Naïve approach

```
-----
int totalCount = 0
for (int i = 1; i <= n; i++)
{
    int num = i;
    while (num > 0)
    {
        totalCount += (num & 1)
        num >>= 1 }
    }
O(nlogn)
```

Step by step approach: (optimized approach  $O(\log n)$  using bit pattern approach)

Input: Integer n

Initialize total = 0

For each bit position i starting from 0 while ( $2^i \leq n$ ):

Set cycle\_length =  $2^{(i + 1)}$

Calculate complete\_cycles =  $n / \text{cycle\_length}$

Add to total:  $\text{complete\_cycles} * (\text{cycle\_length} / 2)$

Calculate remainder =  $n \% \text{cycle\_length}$

If remainder  $\geq 2^i$ :

Add to total: remainder -  $2^i + 1$

Print total

Step-by-step Trace for  $n = 10$

Initial:

$= 10, \text{total} = 0$

☒  $i = 0$  (LSB - bit 0)

$1 \ll 0 = 1$

$\text{cycle\_len} = 1 \ll (0 + 1) = 2$

$\text{complete\_cycles} = 10 / 2 = 5$

$\text{total} += 5 * 1 = 5$

$\text{rem} = 10 \% 2 = 0$

$\text{rem} \geq 1 \rightarrow \text{false} \rightarrow \text{nothing added}$

$\Rightarrow \text{total} = 5$

☒  $i = 1$  (bit 1)

$1 \ll 1 = 2$

$\text{cycle\_len} = 1 \ll (1 + 1) = 4$

$\text{complete\_cycles} = 10 / 4 = 2$

$\text{total} += 2 * 2 = 4$

$\text{rem} = 10 \% 4 = 2$

$\text{rem} \geq 2 \rightarrow \text{true} \rightarrow \text{total} += 2 - 2 + 1 = 1$

$\Rightarrow \text{total} = 5 + 4 + 1 = 10$

☒  $i = 2$  (bit 2)

$1 \ll 2 = 4$

$\text{cycle\_len} = 1 \ll (2 + 1) = 8$

$\text{complete\_cycles} = 10 / 8 = 1$

$\text{total} += 1 * 4 = 4$

$\text{rem} = 10 \% 8 = 2$

$\text{rem} \geq 4 \rightarrow \text{false} \rightarrow \text{nothing added}$

$\Rightarrow \text{total} = 10 + 4 = 14$

☒  $i = 3$  (bit 3)

$1 \ll 3 = 8$

$\text{cycle\_len} = 1 \ll (3 + 1) = 16$

$\text{complete\_cycles} = 10 / 16 = 0$

$\text{total} += 0$

$\text{rem} = 10 \% 16 = 10$

$\text{rem} \geq 8 \rightarrow \text{true} \rightarrow \text{total} += 10 - 8 + 1 = 3$

$\Rightarrow \text{total} = 14 + 3 = 17$

$\text{total} += 10 - 8 + 1 = 3$

? What does this 3 mean?

☒ Answer:

It means there are 3 numbers between 1 and 10 where bit 3 is set to 1 in the incomplete cycle (last part) – specifically, the numbers:

8  $\rightarrow$  1000

9  $\rightarrow$  1001

10  $\rightarrow$  1010

Each of these has bit 3 (value 8) set to 1, so we add 3 to the total.

This calculation is counting how many values in the remainder (last partial cycle) have the bit  $i$  (bit 3) set.

If remainder = 6, and  $2^i = 4$ , then range is:

→ Values with bit i set: 4, 5, 6

→ Count:  $6 - 4 + 1 = 3$  (inclusive count)

If you want to count how many integers are there from a to b, including both ends, the formula is:

Count =  $b - a + 1$

- From 4 to 6 → numbers are: 4, 5, 6
- Count = 3
- $6 - 4 = 2$  → wrong
- So, correct:  $6 - 4 + 1 = 3$
- That's where +1 comes in: inclusive counting
- The +1 is needed because you're counting an inclusive range from  $1 \ll i$  to remainder
- Even if the range has just one number, like 10, it should be counted – hence +1
- Without it, you'd miss the last number in that range
- If remainder has crossed  $1 \ll i$ , then we're in the part where bit i is 1"
- And the first such number is exactly  $1 \ll i$

⊖ i = 4

$1 \ll 4 = 16 > n$  → loop stops

☑ Final Answer:17

📊 Actual Binary Set Bit Count from 1 to 10:

| Number | Binary | Set Bits |
|--------|--------|----------|
|--------|--------|----------|

|   |      |   |
|---|------|---|
| 0 | 0000 | 0 |
|---|------|---|

|   |      |   |
|---|------|---|
| 1 | 0001 | 1 |
|---|------|---|

|   |      |   |
|---|------|---|
| 2 | 0010 | 1 |
|---|------|---|

|   |      |   |
|---|------|---|
| 3 | 0011 | 2 |
|---|------|---|

|   |      |   |
|---|------|---|
| 4 | 0100 | 1 |
|---|------|---|

|   |      |   |
|---|------|---|
| 5 | 0101 | 2 |
|---|------|---|

|   |      |   |
|---|------|---|
| 6 | 0110 | 2 |
|---|------|---|

|   |      |   |
|---|------|---|
| 7 | 0111 | 3 |
|---|------|---|

|   |      |   |
|---|------|---|
| 8 | 1000 | 1 |
|---|------|---|

|   |      |   |
|---|------|---|
| 9 | 1001 | 2 |
|---|------|---|

|    |      |   |
|----|------|---|
| 10 | 1010 | 2 |
|----|------|---|

|       |  |    |
|-------|--|----|
| Total |  | 17 |
|-------|--|----|

for n=8

Pattern Analysis Per Bit:

▣ Bit 0 (LSB):

Repeats every 2 numbers: 01010101

☑ Set in: 1, 3, 5, 7 positions → 4 times

▣ Bit 1:

Repeats every 4 numbers: 00110011

☒ Set in: 2, 3, 6, 7 → 4 times

☐ Bit 2:

Repeats every 8 numbers: 00001111

☒ Set in: 4, 5, 6, 7 → 4 times

☐ Bit 3:

Repeats every 16 numbers: 0000000011111111

☒ Set in: only 8 → 1 time

☒ Total Set Bits:

4 (bit 0) + 4 (bit 1) + 4 (bit 2) + 1 (bit 3) = 13 set bits

Binary Set Bit Patterns from 1 to 16

| Bit Position                         | Pattern Example         | Explanation              | Numbers Where Bit Is Set     | Count |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------|-------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Bit 0 (LSB) | 01 01 01 01 01 01 01 01 | Repeats every 2 numbers  | 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11, 13, 15    | 8     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Bit 1       | 00 11 00 11 00 11 00 11 | Repeats every 4 numbers  | 2, 3, 6, 7, 10, 11, 14, 15   | 8     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Bit 2       | 0000 1111 0000 1111     | Repeats every 8 numbers  | 4, 5, 6, 7, 12, 13, 14, 15   | 8     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Bit 3       | 00000000 11111111       | Repeats every 16 numbers | 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15 | 8     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Bit 4       | 00000000000000001       | Repeats every 32 numbers | 16                           | 1     |

☐ Total Set Bits from 1 to 16:

Bit 0: 8

Bit 1: 8

Bit 2: 8

Bit 3: 8

Bit 4: 1

-----

Total: 33 ☒

- For a given bit position  $i$ , the bit pattern repeats every  $\text{cycleLength} = 2^{(i + 1)}$  numbers
- In each cycle of length  $2^{(i + 1)}$ , the bit at position  $i$  is set to 1 for half of those numbers
- So we add:

$\text{completeCycles} * (\text{cycleLength} / 2)$

Which is the total number of set bits at bit  $i$  from all the full cycles.

Let's say:

- $i = 2 \rightarrow$  Bit 2
- So  $\text{cycleLength} = 2^{(2 + 1)} = 8$

Bit 2 ( $i=2$ ) pattern across 0–7:

000 (0)

001 (1)

010 (2)

011 (3)

100 (4) ☒

101 (5) ☒

110 (6) ☒

111 (7) ☒ ← bit 2 is 1 from 4 to 7 → 4 times

- That's cycleLength = 8
- Bit 2 is 1 in half of the cycle →  $8 / 2 = 4 = 2^2$

## Count set bits and store in Array

**Problem:**Count of Set bits for each number in the range upto N and Store it in array

**Input:** 5

**Output:** [0, 1, 1, 2, 1, 2]

### Naïve approach

-----

```
int[] arr = new int[n + 1];

for (int i = 0; i <= n; i++)
{
    int count = 0
    int num = i
    while (num > 0)
    {
        if (num % 2 == 1)
            count++
        num = num / 2
    }
    arr[i] = count
}
print arr
```

$O(n \log n)$

### Optimized approach using DP (Tabulation)

→ The number of set bits in i equals:

(number of set bits in  $i / 2$ ) plus 1 if i is odd, 0 if i even

-----

```
int[] arr = new int[n + 1]
arr[0]=0
for (int i = 1; i <= n; i++)
{
    arr[i] = arr[i/2] + (i & 1); //arr[i>>1]
}
print arr
```

Time Complexity  $O(n)$

### tracing for N=5

$i = 0 \rightarrow 0$

$i = 1 \rightarrow dp[1 \gg 1] + (1 \& 1) = dp[0] + 1 = 1$

i = 2 → dp[1] + 0 = 1  
i = 3 → dp[1] + 1 = 2  
i = 4 → dp[2] + 0 = 1  
i = 5 → dp[2] + 1 = 2

Final Output: 0 1 1 2 1 2

```
int[] arr = new int[n + 1];  
arr[0] = 0;  
  
for (int i = 1; i <= n; i++) {  
    arr[i] = arr[i / 2] + (i & 1);  
}  
  
for (int i = 0; i <= n; i++) {  
    System.out.print(arr[i] + " ");  
}  
}
```

## Find unique element in the array

**Problem:** Given an array of size N find the single unique element in the array

Input: 4 1 2 1 2 4 7

Output: 7

### Explanation:

#### Basic Approach:

Compare each element with all others and find the one which has no duplicate. but time consuming since it takes  $O(n^2)$

```
for i = 0 to n-1
    count = 0
    for j = 0 to n-1:
        if arr[i] == arr[j] then
            count = count + 1
    if count == 1 then
        print arr[i]
        break
```

Using Hashmap  $O(n)$  time  $O(n)$  space

-----

Input: 4 1 2 1 2 4 7

Map: {4=2, 1=2, 2=2, 7=1}

Unique: 7 → output



Using Xor  $O(n)$  time  $O(1)$  space

-----

$a \wedge a = 0$ ,  $a \wedge 0 = a$

So all duplicate elements cancel each other and the unique remains.

```
for(int i = 0; i < n; i++)  
    xor ^= arr[i]
```

$4 \wedge 1 = 5$

$5 \wedge 2 = 7$

$7 \wedge 1 = 6$

$6 \wedge 2 = 4$

$4 \wedge 4 = 0$

$0 \wedge 7 = 7 \leftarrow \text{Unique}$

## Find missing number in the given array

**Problem:** Given an array `nums` containing `n` distinct numbers in the range `[0, n]`, find the only number that is missing from the given array.

Input: 3

3 0 1

Output: 2

Explanation:

0 is always included in the array. missing number in the range is 2.

### Naïve Approach

```
-----  
for i from 0 to n do  
    found = false
```

```
    for j from 0 to n - 1 do  
        if nums[j] == i then  
            found ← true  
            break
```

```
    if found is 0 then  
        print i  
        break
```

for example: if array is [3, 0, 1]

for third iteration i=2

found = 0

Inner loop:

j = 0: `nums[0] != 2`

j = 1: `nums[1] != 2`

j = 2: `nums[2] != 2`

found == 0, so 2 is missing and printed as the result.

boolean nested array

```
-----  
boolean[] present = new boolean[n+1];
```

```
    for(int i=0; i<n; i++) {  
        nums[i] = sc.nextInt();  
        present[nums[i]] = true;  
    }
```

```
    for(int i=0; i<=n; i++) {  
        if(!present[i]) {  
            System.out.println(i);  
            return;  
        }
```

### Better approach using summation formula

Input: `nums = [3, 0, 1]`

`n = 3`

Step 1: Calculate the sum of numbers from 0 to n  
Using the formula  $\text{sum} = n * (n + 1) / 2$ :  
 $\text{sum} = 3 * (3 + 1) / 2 = 3 * 4 / 2 = 6$   
Step 2: Calculate the actual sum of elements in nums:  
 $\text{actual\_sum} = 3 + 0 + 1 = 4$   
Step 3: Find the difference:  
 $\text{missing} = \text{sum} - \text{actual\_sum} = 6 - 4 = 2$   
The missing number is 2.

Best Approach using XoR

-----  
Naive Approach  $O(n^2)$   $O(1)$  Slow, not efficient  
Sum Formula  $O(n)$   $O(1)$  Efficient but requires sum  
XOR (Best)  $O(n)$   $O(1)$  Most efficient and elegant

```
initialize xor as 0
for i = 0 to n:
    xor1 = xor1 ^ i
```

```
initialize xor1 as 0
```

```
for i 0 to n-1:
    xor2 = xor2 ^ nums[i]
```

```
missingNumber = xor1 ^ xor2
```

```
int[] nums = new int[n]
```

```
    int xor_full = 0
    int xor_array = 0

    for(int i=0; i<n; i++) {
        nums[i] = sc.nextInt()
        xor_array ^= nums[i]
    }

    for(int i=0; i<=n; i++)
        xor_full ^= i
```

```
System.out.println(xor_full ^ xor_array)
```

```
Input: nums = [3, 0, 1]
n = 3
Step 1: XOR all numbers from 0 to n:
xor = 0
xor ^= 0 → xor = 0
xor ^= 1 → xor = 1
xor ^= 2 → xor = 3
xor ^= 3 → xor = 0 (XOR of all numbers from 0 to 3)
Step 2: XOR all elements in nums:
xor ^= 3 → xor = 3
xor ^= 0 → xor = 3
```

$\text{xor} \oplus 1 \rightarrow \text{xor} = 2$  (final XOR result)  
The missing number is 2.

## X1sY0s to decimal

**Problem:** Given X number of 1's followed by Y number of 0's find the decimal value

Input: 2 2 (1100)

Output: 12

Naïve approach

```
-----
read x and y as integer values
initialize empty result string
loop from i= 0 to x-1 do
    result= result+ "1"

loop from i=0 to y-1 do
    result = result + "0"

int dec=Integer.parseInt(result,2)
```

- **Time Complexity:**  $O(x + y)$
- **Space Complexity:**  $O(x + y)$  (binary string stored in memory)

Optimized approach

```
-----

int ones = (1 << x) - 1  (1<<X raise power to the respective bit and subtracting 1 from it gives
                           the number of 1's as LSB)
int result = ones << y  (shifting ones again y times gives us number of 0's at MSB)

print result
```

No string operations  
Uses direct bit manipulation  
Time:  **$O(1)$**   
Space:  **$O(1)$**

**$2 \ll 3$**   
It means:  
Shift the binary representation of 2 to the left by 3 positions.

**$2 \gg 3$**   
This means:  
Shift the binary representation of 2 to the right by 3 bits.

## XY set bit to decimal

**Problem:** You are given two integers, x and y, representing bit positions. Your task is to create a number where **only the x-th and y-th bits are set to 1** (rest all bits are 0).

Input: 2 5

Output: 36

Explanation: binary value will be 100100 which is 36.. (2nd and 5th bit are set)

### Naïve Approach

-----

Input: x = 2, y = 5

take  $2^x$  and  $2^y$  and sum them.

val1 =  $2^2 = 4$

val2 =  $2^5 = 32$

result =  $4 + 32 = 36$

- Uses floating-point math (`Math.pow`), then casts to int.
- **Slower** and **less precise** for larger values.

### Optimized approach

-----

$(1 \ll x) \mid (1 \ll y)$

This directly sets bits using fast bit manipulation without relying on floating-point computation.

OR operation allows to combine the set bits from x and y into a single number



## XoR of sum of Pairs

**Problem:** Given an integer array `arr` of size `n`, compute the XOR of all pairwise sums of the elements in the array.

**Note:** Here  $(A[i], A[i])$ ,  $(A[i], A[j])$ ,  $(A[j], A[i])$  all are considered as different pairs.

Naive approach  $O(n^2)$

```
-----
result = 0
for i from 0 to n-1:
    for j from 0 to n-1:
        sum = arr[i] + arr[j]
        result = result ^ sum
print result
```

suppose array size is 2 and elements are 1 and 2: [1,2]

| i | j | arr[i] | arr[j] | arr[i] + arr[j] |
|---|---|--------|--------|-----------------|
| 0 | 0 | 1      | 1      | 2               |
| 0 | 1 | 1      | 2      | 3               |
| 1 | 0 | 2      | 1      | 3               |
| 1 | 1 | 2      | 2      | 4               |

```
ans = 0 ^ 2 ^ 3 ^ 3 ^ 4
     = ((2 ^ 3) ^ 3) ^ 4
     = (1 ^ 3) ^ 4
     = 2 ^ 4
     = 6
```

Let's count how many times the inner loop runs.

- When  $i = 0$ ,  $j$  runs  $n$  times
- When  $i = 1$ ,  $j$  runs  $n - 1$  times
- When  $i = 2$ ,  $j$  runs  $n - 2$  times
- ...
- When  $i = n - 1$ ,  $j$  runs 1 time

So total operations:

```
= n + (n-1) + (n-2) + ... + 1
= n(n+1)/2
=  $O(n^2)$ 
```

**Optimized Approach:**  $O(n)$

```
-----
xor = 0
for i from 0 to n-1:
    xor = xor ^ arr[i]
print(xor * 2)
```



**Input:** arr[] = {1, 5, 6}

**Output:** 4

all possible pairs = { 1+1, 1+5, 1+6, 5+1, 5+5, 5+6, 6+1, 6+5, 6+6}  
{ 2, 6, 7, 6, 10, 11, 7, 11, 12}

$$2 \wedge 6 \wedge 7 \wedge 6 \wedge 10 \wedge 11 \wedge 7 \wedge 6 \wedge 11 \wedge 12 = 4$$

as XoR property,  $a \wedge a = 0$  hence same elements gets cancelled out..

and remaining are  $2 \wedge 10 \wedge 12 = 4$

as u can observe remaining elements each are the twice of original elemnts..  
hence its same as finding xor of 1 5 6 and then multiplying by 2

**Input:**

3

5 1 2

**Output:**

12

## Sum of Xor of all unique pairs

**Problem:** Given an array of  $n$  integers, find the sum of xor of all pairs of numbers in the array.

Input : {7, 3, 5}

Output : 12

$$7 \wedge 3 = 4$$

$$3 \wedge 5 = 6$$

$$7 \wedge 5 = 2$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Sum} &= 4 + 6 + 2 \\ &= 12 \end{aligned}$$

Naive Approach:

```
for (int i = 0; i < n; i++)
    for (int j = i + 1; j < n; j++)
        Sum += arr[i] ^ arr[j]

print Sum
```

Optimized Approach:

```
-----
total = 0

for bit = 0 to 31:
    count_set = 0

    for i = 0 to n - 1:
        if ((arr[i] >> bit) & 1) == 1:
            count_set = count_set + 1

    count_unset = n - count_set

    pair_contribution = count_set * count_unset * (1 << bit) (Equals to 2^bit)

    total = total + pair_contribution

return total
```

Java use **32-bit signed integers**, where:

- The range of an int in Java is:  
- $2^{31}$  to  $2^{31} - 1$   
i.e., -2147483648 to 2147483647
- So, even the largest positive value  $2^{31} - 1$  takes **31 bits** (0 to 30) for magnitude, and the **31st bit (index 31)** is used for the **sign bit** (1 for negative, 0 for positive).
- We go from **bit 0 to 31 to cover all bits in a 32-bit integer**

arr = {2, 3, 4, 5, 7}

Binary forms:

2 → 0010 ☒ bit 1 set  
3 → 0011 ☒ bit 1 set  
4 → 0100 ☒ bit 1 not set  
5 → 0101 ☒  
7 → 0111 ☒

🔍 For bit 1:

Set (bit 1 = 1): 2, 3, 7 → total = 3 → countSet = 3

Unset (bit 1 = 0): 4, 5 → total = 2 → countUnset = 2

Now list **every pair** (x, y) such that:

- x has bit 1 set
- y has bit 1 unset

From set: 2

- (2, 4)
- (2, 5)

From set: 3

- (3, 4)
- (3, 5)

From set: 7

- (7, 4)
- (7, 5)

☑ Total such pairs:  $3 \times 2 = 6$

Each of these pairs, when XORed, will have **bit 1 set to 1**.

- So: countSet \* countUnset = 6 valid pairs
- formula: countset\*countunset\*  $2^1$  (bit 1 weight)  
And since **bit 1 represents  $2^1 = 2$** ,  
➡ Each such pair contributes 2 to the total sum of all XORs.

Total contribution from bit 1 =  $3 * 2 * 2^1 = 12$

So, when bit 1 is set in the XOR result, it adds a value of 2 to the total sum.

example 2:

-----  
arr = {7, 3, 5}  
n = 3

📄 bit = 0

int countSet = 0;

▶ Inner loop (i = 0 to 2):

i = 0: arr[0] = 7,  $7 \gg 0 = 7$ ,  $7 \& 1 = 1 \rightarrow$  ☑ countSet = 1

i = 1: arr[1] = 3,  $3 \gg 0 = 3$ ,  $3 \& 1 = 1 \rightarrow$  ☑ countSet = 2

i = 2: arr[2] = 5,  $5 \gg 0 = 5$ ,  $5 \& 1 = 1 \rightarrow$  ☑ countSet = 3

int countUnset = n - countSet = 3 - 3 = 0;

total +=  $3 * 0 * (1 \ll 0) = 0$

✓ total = 0

📄 bit = 1

countSet = 0;

▶ Inner loop:

i = 0:  $7 \gg 1 = 3$ ,  $3 \& 1 = 1 \rightarrow$  ☑ countSet = 1

i = 1:  $3 \gg 1 = 1$ ,  $1 \& 1 = 1 \rightarrow$  ☑ countSet = 2

i = 2:  $5 \gg 1 = 2$ ,  $2 \& 1 = 0 \rightarrow$  ✗

countUnset = 3 - 2 = 1;

total +=  $2 * 1 * (1 \ll 1) = 2 * 1 * 2 = 4$ ;

✓ total = 0 + 4 = 4

📄 bit = 2

countSet = 0;

▶ Inner loop:

i = 0:  $7 \gg 2 = 1$ ,  $1 \& 1 = 1 \rightarrow \checkmark$  countSet = 1

i = 1:  $3 \gg 2 = 0$ ,  $0 \& 1 = 0 \rightarrow \times$

i = 2:  $5 \gg 2 = 1$ ,  $1 \& 1 = 1 \rightarrow \checkmark$  countSet = 2

countUnset = 3 - 2 = 1;

total +=  $2 * 1 * (1 \ll 2) = 2 * 1 * 4 = 8$ ;

✓ total = 4 + 8 = 12

☐ bit = 3 to bit = 31

All bits higher than 2 in 7, 3, 5 are 0.

For each bit:

countSet = 0, countUnset = 3

total +=  $0 * 3 * (1 \ll \text{bit}) = 0$

✓ total Sum remains 12

input= 5 9 7 6

output=47

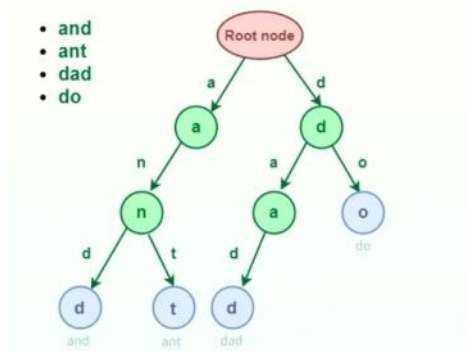
This is for the **optimized XOR sum of all pairs**:

- **Time:**  $O(32 * n) \rightarrow$  Since we go over 32 bits for each of n elements.
- **Space:**  $O(1)$

## Trie Data Structure

- A Trie (or prefix tree) is a tree-like data structure used to store sequences (like strings or bit sequences).
- Each edge represents one element (character or bit).
- Common prefixes share the same path from the root.
- Very useful for prefix-related queries.

Trie supports operations such as insertion, search, deletion of keys, and prefix searches.



- **Insert/Search/Prefix Search** all run in  $O(L)$ , where  $L$  is length of the word or prefix.
- This is **faster than hash maps** in some cases, especially for prefix searches and when collisions are costly
- Space depends on total nodes, up to  $O(\text{ALPHABET\_SIZE} \times N \times L)$  worst case. (N: length of word)
- Usually large because each node has an array of child pointers.

### Trie Applications

#### 1. Autocomplete / Auto-suggestion

Suggest words based on a prefix typed by the user.

#### 2. Spell Checking

Verify if a word exists and suggest corrections.

#### 3. Implementing Dictionaries

Storing and retrieving words efficiently.

#### 4. Finding Longest Prefixes in dictionary

For example, in search engines or IP address lookup. etc

### Representation of Trie Node

- **Trie data structure** consists of nodes connected by edges.
- Each node represents a character or a part of a string.
- The root node acts as a starting point and does not store any character.

### TrieNode Class

#### Purpose:

Represents a **single node** in the Trie.

#### Contains:

- An array of child nodes (usually size 26 for lowercase letters).
- A flag to indicate if the node represents the **end of a valid word**

We're inserting "apple" into the Trie.

-----

```

TrieNode curr = root;
for (char ch : word.toCharArray()) {
    int index = ch - 'a';
    if (curr.children[index] == null) {
        curr.children[index] = new TrieNode();
    }
    curr = curr.children[index];
}

```

#### Step 1: 'a'

- `ch = 'a'`
- `index = 'a' - 'a' = 0`
- `curr = root`

```

if (curr.children[0] == null)
    curr.children[0] = new TrieNode();
curr = curr.children[0];

```

☑ `curr` now points to the 'a' node.

#### Step 2: 'p'

Now, we're processing the **next character 'p'**.

- `ch = 'p'`
- `index = 'p' - 'a' = 15`

```

if (curr.children[15] == null)
    curr.children[15] = new TrieNode();
curr = curr.children[15];

```

👉 But here's the **key**:

- At this point, `curr` is already pointing to the 'a' node (from the previous step).
- So `curr.children[15]` is accessing the 'p' **child of the 'a' node**.

## Max Subarray XOR

### Problem:

Given an array of integers. The task is to find the maximum subarray XOR value in the given array.

**Input:** `arr[] = {1, 2, 3, 4}`

**Output:** 7

**Explanation:** The subarray {3, 4} has maximum XOR value

**Input:** `arr[] = {8, 1, 2, 12, 7, 6}`

**Output:** 15

**Explanation:** The subarray {1, 2, 12} has maximum XOR value

### Naive Approach:

```
-----
int max = 0
for (int i = 0; i < n; i++)
    int xor = 0
    for (int j = i; j < n; j++)
        xor = xor ^ arr[j]
        if (xor > max)
            max = xor;
    }
}

print max
```

### Optimized Approach:

Insert each number:  $O(32)$   
Query each number:  $O(32)$   
Total:  $O(n)$  for  $n$  = array size

$$A \wedge A = 0$$

$$A \wedge 0 = A$$

And most importantly:

$$(A \wedge B \wedge C) \wedge (A \wedge B) = C$$

$$(A \wedge B \wedge C) \wedge (A \wedge B)$$

$$= (A \wedge B) \wedge C \wedge (A \wedge B)$$

$$= ((A \wedge B) \wedge (A \wedge B)) \wedge C$$

$$= 0 \wedge C = C$$

Given an array `arr[]`, we define:

```
prefix[0] = arr[0]
prefix[1] = arr[0] ^ arr[1]
prefix[2] = arr[0] ^ arr[1] ^ arr[2]
...
prefix[j] = arr[0] ^ arr[1] ^ ... ^ arr[j]
```

For array: [1, 2, 3, 4]

### Prefix XORs:

$$\text{prefix}[0] = 1$$

$$\text{prefix}[1] = 1 \wedge 2 = 3$$

$$\text{prefix}[2] = 3 \wedge 3 = 0$$

$$\text{prefix}[3] = 0 \wedge 4 = 4$$

So when you XOR two prefix values:

$\text{prefix}[j] \wedge \text{prefix}[i - 1]$

You effectively **cancel out the first i elements**, and are left with:

$\text{arr}[i] \wedge \text{arr}[i+1] \wedge \dots \wedge \text{arr}[j]$

Which is exactly the **XOR of the subarray from i to j**.

$\text{arr} = [1, 2, 3, 4]$

Assume We want to compute the XOR of subarray from  $i = 1$  to  $j = 3$ , i.e.:

Normal calculation:  $\text{arr}[1] \wedge \text{arr}[2] \wedge \text{arr}[3] = 2 \wedge 3 \wedge 4 = 5$

Step 1: **Compute prefix XORs**

**index prefix[i] (XOR from 0 to i)**

0  $\text{arr}[0] = 1$

1  $\text{arr}[0] \wedge \text{arr}[1] = 1 \wedge 2 = 3$

2  $1 \wedge 2 \wedge 3 = 3 \wedge 3 = 0$

3  $1 \wedge 2 \wedge 3 \wedge 4 = 0 \wedge 4 = 4$

so  $\text{prefix}[3] = 4$

$\text{prefix}[i-1] = \text{prefix}[0] = 1$

**Step 2: Apply formula**

To compute XOR from index  $i=1$  to  $j=3$ :

$\text{subarray\_xor} = \text{prefix}[3] \wedge \text{prefix}[0] = 4 \wedge 1 = 5 \checkmark$

Explanation of cancel out:

-----  
 $\text{prefix}[3] = \text{arr}[0] \wedge \text{arr}[1] \wedge \text{arr}[2] \wedge \text{arr}[3]$   
 $= 1 \wedge 2 \wedge 3 \wedge 4$

$\text{prefix}[0] = \text{arr}[0]$   
 $= 1$

Now,

$\text{prefix}[3] \wedge \text{prefix}[0]$   
 $= (1 \wedge 2 \wedge 3 \wedge 4) \wedge 1$

Apply XOR associativity:

$= 1 \wedge 2 \wedge 3 \wedge 4 \wedge 1$

$= (1 \wedge 1) \wedge 2 \wedge 3 \wedge 4$

$= 0 \wedge 2 \wedge 3 \wedge 4$

$= 2 \wedge 3 \wedge 4 = 5 \checkmark$

Hence

To get XOR of subarray from index  $i$  to  $j$ , do:

**$\text{XOR}(i, j) = \text{prefix}[j] \wedge \text{prefix}[i - 1]$**

Because the earlier terms cancel out using XOR properties

Idea:

-----

For the current prefix XOR (say,  $\text{prefix}[j]$ ), we want to **find a previous prefix XOR** ( $\text{prefix}[i - 1]$ ) in such a way that their XOR is **as large as possible**.

So:

- We build a Trie with all the **previous prefix XORs**
- For every new prefix XOR, we **query the Trie** to find the **best matching XOR** (i.e., most differing bits from high to low)
- This lets us compute  $\text{max}(\text{prefix}[j] \wedge \text{best\_match})$  in  **$O(32)$**  time per element.
- By checking for **opposite bits at each level**, you greedily maximize XOR.

**Visual Diagram after for trie based on binary values (only last 3 bits):**

We'll start with  $\text{xor} = 0$  and update it with each element of the array:

**i arr[i] xor (prefix) 3-bit binary**

0 - 0 000

1 1  $0 \wedge 1 = 1$  001



|   |   |                  |     |
|---|---|------------------|-----|
| 2 | 2 | $1 \wedge 2 = 3$ | 011 |
| 3 | 3 | $3 \wedge 3 = 0$ | 000 |
| 4 | 4 | $0 \wedge 4 = 4$ | 100 |

We will insert each of these XORs into the Trie using **3 bits** from MSB to LSB (bit 2  $\rightarrow$  1  $\rightarrow$  0).

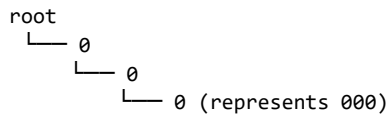
### Step-by-step Insertion

#### ♦ Insert 000 (prefix 0)

Binary: 000

**Bit Position (i) Bit Action**

|   |   |                                |
|---|---|--------------------------------|
| 2 | 0 | Create child[0] at root        |
| 1 | 0 | Create child[0] under previous |
| 0 | 0 | Create child[0] under previous |

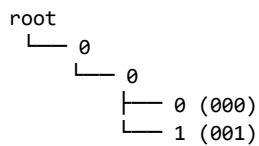


#### ♦ Insert 001 (prefix 1)

Binary: 001

**Bit Position (i) Bit Action**

|   |   |                                     |
|---|---|-------------------------------------|
| 2 | 0 | Already exists                      |
| 1 | 0 | Already exists                      |
| 0 | 1 | Create child[1] under previous node |



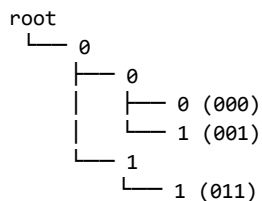
#### ♦ Insert 011 (prefix 3)

Binary: 011

**Bit Position (i) Bit Action**

|   |   |                                |
|---|---|--------------------------------|
| 2 | 0 | Already exists                 |
| 1 | 1 | Create child[1] under first 0  |
| 0 | 1 | Create child[1] under previous |

Trie:



#### ♦ Insert 000 again (prefix 0)

Binary: 000

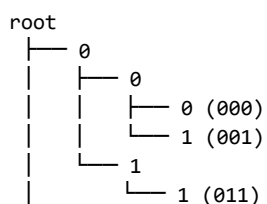
☒ Path already exists: no new nodes created.

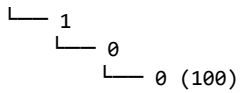
#### ♦ Insert 100 (prefix 4)

Binary: 100

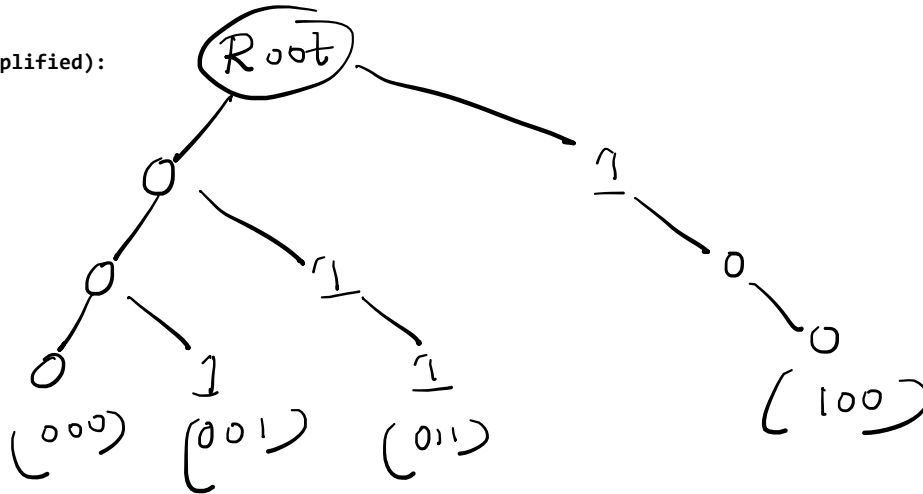
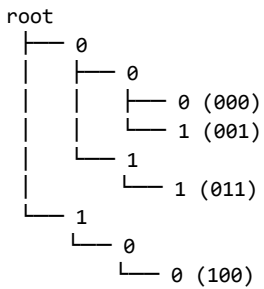
**Bit Position (i) Bit Action**

|   |   |                         |
|---|---|-------------------------|
| 2 | 1 | Create child[1] at root |
| 1 | 0 | Create child[0]         |
| 0 | 0 | Create child[0]         |





☑ Final Trie Diagram (simplified):



query() greedily walks the Trie from top to bottom, and at each level:

- It looks at the current bit in val
- Tries to go to the child node with the **opposite bit** (to maximize XOR)
- If it can't, it takes the same bit path

The result is the **maximum XOR** value it can make using any prefix stored in the Trie.

To **maximize XOR**, we want to choose **opposite bits** at each level.

- If current bit is 0, try 1 in Trie.
- If current bit is 1, try 0 in Trie.

Because  $1 \wedge 0 = 1$  (better than  $1 \wedge 1 = 0$ )

Let's Run query(root, 4)

we want to find the number in the Trie that maximizes  $4 \wedge x$ , where  $x$  is a prefix already in the Trie.

int xor = 0;

We're now trying to find the number in the Trie that gives the **maximum XOR** with 4.

4 = 100 (in 3-bit view: bits 2,1,0)

We start from **bit 2 (MSB)** → **bit 0 (LSB)**

► Bit 2:

bit =  $(4 \gg 2) \& 1 = 1$

opp = 0

We want **opposite** of 1 → that is 0

Check if curr.child[0] exists from root:

☑ YES (0, 1, 3 all go through bit 2 = 0)

So:

xor |=  $(1 \ll 2)$ ; // 0 | 4 = 4

curr = curr.child[0];

We now move down into the child[0] branch.

☑ We just locked in a 1 at **bit 2** in XOR.

► Bit 1:

bit = 0

opp = 1

We want child[1]

☑ YES (3 has bit1 = 1)

So:

xor |=  $(1 \ll 1)$ ; // 4 | 2 = 6

curr = curr.child[1];

☑ Locked in a 1 at **bit 1**

► Bit 0:

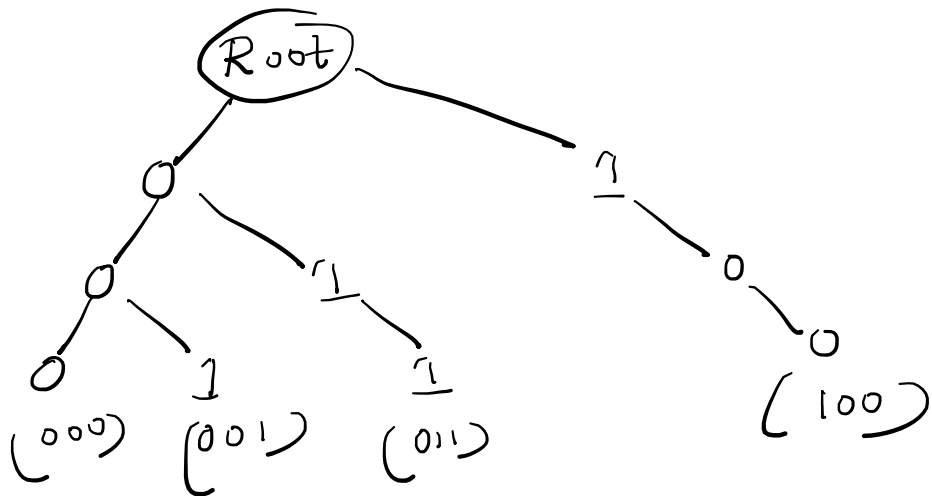
bit = 0

opp = 1

We want child[1]

☑ YES (3 has bit0 = 1)

xor |=  $(1 \ll 0)$ ; // 6 | 1 = 7



```
curr = curr.child[1];
```

☒ Locked in a 1 at bit 0

So, the number in the Trie that gives the **best XOR with 4** is 3

Because:

$4 \oplus 3 = 7$  ☒

Full XOR Tracing:

Bit Position Bit in val (4) Opp Exists? XOR Gained

|         |   |   |                                     |          |
|---------|---|---|-------------------------------------|----------|
| 2 (MSB) | 1 | 0 | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | +4 (100) |
| 1       | 0 | 1 | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | +2 (010) |
| 0 (LSB) | 0 | 1 | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | +1 (001) |

Total XOR = 4 + 2 + 1 = 7 ( $4 \oplus 3 = 7$ )

`xor |= (1 << i)`

signifies that **at bit i**, we found a value in the Trie that had the **opposite bit** – which helps set bit i in the result to 1  
That increases the total XOR value.

- At each bit:

- If the **opposite bit exists**, we go there (to maximize XOR).
- Because **XOR of opposite bits gives 1**, we add **(1 << i)** to the result.

- You query with current prefix XOR (like 12) to find which **previous prefix** gives the **maximum XOR** when XORed with it.

- This helps find the **maximum subarray XOR ending at current index**.

- You repeat this for every index to get the global max.

```
arr = [3, 10, 5]
prefix[0] = 0      (initial)
prefix[1] = 3      (0 ^ 3)
prefix[2] = 9      (3 ^ 10)
prefix[3] = 12     (9 ^ 5)
```

At i = 2, you have:

```
xor = 12
```

You call: query(12)

Trie has previous prefix values: {0, 3, 9}

Then:

$12 \oplus 0 = 12$

$12 \oplus 3 = 15$

$12 \oplus 9 = 5$

So the best you can get is 15

Hence, query(12) is returning 15, and you update your max = 15

## XorSUM of all pairs with AND

### Problem:

You are given two integer arrays, arr1 and arr2, both containing non-negative integers. Define a new list containing the bitwise AND of every possible pair formed by taking one element from arr1 and one from arr2

Your task is to find the XOR sum of all elements in this new list, where the XOR sum is the bitwise XOR of all the elements.

Input:

arr1 = [4, 7]

arr2 = [3, 8]

Output: 4

Naive Approach:

```
int xor_sum = 0;
for (int i = 0; i < n; i++)
    for (int j = 0; j < m; j++)
        xor_sum ^= (arr1[i] & arr2[j])
```

```
System.out.println(xor_sum)
```

Pairs:

4 & 3 = 0

4 & 8 = 0

7 & 3 = 3

7 & 8 = 0

List = [0, 0, 3, 0]

XOR sum =  $0 \oplus 0 \oplus 3 \oplus 0 = 3$

$[4, 3]$   
 $[7, 8]$

$(4 \& 7) \oplus (4 \& 8) \oplus (3 \& 7) \oplus (3 \& 8)$

$(4 \wedge 3) \oplus (7 \wedge 8)$

### Optimized Approach:

Bitwise property:

$(a1 \& b1) \oplus (a1 \& b2) \oplus \dots \oplus (a2 \& b1) \oplus (a2 \& b2) \dots$

can be rewritten using distributivity:

$= (a1 \oplus a2 \oplus \dots \oplus an) \& (b1 \oplus b2 \oplus \dots \oplus bm)$

So the final XOR sum is:

$(arr1\_xor) \& (arr2\_xor)$

Time Complexity:  $O(n + m)$

Space Complexity:  $O(1)$

- $XOR(arr1) = 4 \oplus 7 = 3$
- $XOR(arr2) = 3 \oplus 8 = 11$  (binary 1011)
- Result =  $3 \& 11 = 3$

Output matches XOR sum = 3

$(a1 \& b1) \oplus (a1 \& b2) \oplus (a2 \& b1) \oplus (a2 \& b2)$

$= (a1 \oplus a2) \& (b1 \oplus b2)$

Let:

$a1 = 4, a2 = 7$

$b1 = 3, b2 = 8$

$$\begin{array}{r} 0011 \\ 1011 \\ \hline 0011 = 3 \end{array}$$

```

arr1 = [1, 2, 3]
arr2 = [6, 5]
Trace (Naive)
Compute AND of all combinations:
1 & 6 = 0
1 & 5 = 1
2 & 6 = 2
2 & 5 = 0
3 & 6 = 2
3 & 5 = 1
Resulting list: [0, 1, 2, 0, 2, 1]
XOR sum:  $0 \wedge 1 \wedge 2 \wedge 0 \wedge 2 \wedge 1 = 0$ 

```

Distributive property is similar for AND and XOR.  
 $(a1 \wedge a2) \& (b1 \wedge b2) = (a1 \& b1) \wedge (a1 \& b2) \wedge (a2 \& b1) \wedge (a2 \& b2)$

**XOR Distributive Diagram**  
 $(1 \& 2 \& 3) \wedge (6 \& 5)$   
 $XOR(arr1) = 1 \wedge 2 \wedge 3 = 0$   
 $XOR(arr2) = 6 \wedge 5 = 3$   
Final Result =  $0 \& 3 = 0$

```

initialize xor1 to 0
for i from 0 to n-1 do
    xor1 = xor1 ^ arr1[i]

initialize xor2 to 0
for j from 0 to m-1 do
    xor2 = xor2 ^ arr2[j]

result = xor1 AND xor2
print result

```

## Bitwise XoR of all Pairings

### Problem:

You are given two arrays `nums1` and `nums2` containing non-negative integers. Consider all pairs  $(i, j)$  where  $i$  ranges over indices of `nums1` and  $j$  ranges over indices of `nums2`. For each pair, compute the bitwise XOR of `nums1[i]` and `nums2[j]`.  
print bitwise xor of all possible pairs from `num1` and `num2`.

Input:

3 4

2 1 3

Output:

13

Naive Approach:

```
for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {  
    for (int j = 0; j < m; j++) {  
        result ^= (nums1[i] ^ nums2[j]);  
    }  
}
```

```
System.out.println(result);
```

### Optimized Approach:

XOR is commutative and associative:

$a \wedge b = b \wedge a$ , and  $(a \wedge b) \wedge c = a \wedge (b \wedge c)$

When you XOR the same number multiple times:

- XORing a number **even** times results in 0  
(because  $x \wedge x = 0$ , so pairs cancel out)
- XORing a number **odd** times results in the number itself  
(because if you have an odd number of  $x$ 's, one  $x$  remains after pairs cancel)

Let's say:

`nums1` = [a1, a2, ..., an]

`nums2` = [b1, b2, ..., bm]

All pairwise XORs:

$(a1 \wedge b1), (a1 \wedge b2), \dots, (a1 \wedge bm), (a2 \wedge b1), \dots, (an \wedge bm)$

Rewriting the total XOR:

$(a1 \wedge a2 \wedge \dots \wedge an)$  repeated  $m$  times  $\wedge (b1 \wedge b2 \wedge \dots \wedge bm)$  repeated  $n$  times

So the total XOR is:

if  $m$  is odd: use XOR of all `nums1`

if  $n$  is odd: use XOR of all `nums2`

Input:

`nums1` = [2, 1, 3]

`nums2` = [10, 2, 5, 0]

- $n$  = length of the first array (`nums1`)
- $m$  = length of the second array (`nums2`)
  
- $\text{XOR}(\text{nums1}) = 2 \wedge 1 \wedge 3 = 0$
- $\text{XOR}(\text{nums2}) = 10 \wedge 2 \wedge 5 \wedge 0 = 13$
- $m = 4$  (even), so ignore  $\text{XOR}(\text{nums1})$
- $n = 3$  (odd), so take  $\text{XOR}(\text{nums2})$

Result =  $0 \wedge 13 = 13$

If  $n$  is odd and  $m$  is even, why do elements from `nums1` cancel out, and only  $\text{xor}(\text{nums2})$  remains?

$$(a \wedge b) \wedge c = a \wedge (b \wedge c)$$

Each element of nums1 is XORed with **all** elements of nums2.  
 So every nums1[i] is repeated m times in pairing.  
 Likewise, every nums2[j] is repeated n times in pairing.  
 hence When n is odd and m is even → only xor(nums2) contributes to the final result.

**So the final result is:**

$$\text{result} = \begin{cases} \text{XOR}(\text{nums1}) \oplus \text{XOR}(\text{nums2}) & \text{if both } m, n \text{ are odd} \\ \text{XOR}(\text{nums1}) & \text{if } m \text{ is odd and } n \text{ is even} \\ \text{XOR}(\text{nums2}) & \text{if } n \text{ is odd and } m \text{ is even} \\ 0 & \text{if both } m, n \text{ are even} \end{cases}$$

nums1 = [2, 3] → xor1 = 2 ^ 3 = 1  
 nums2 = [5, 7, 1] → xor2 = 5 ^ 7 ^ 1 = 3  
 n = 2 (even), m = 3 (odd)

result = xor1 ^ 0 = 1

- all pairs are: (2^5)^(2^7)^(2^1)^(3^5)(3^7)^(3^1)  
 as u observe: 5 7 and 1 are appeared even times hence they cancel out. (this is bcz length of n is 2)  
 Hence remaining ans will be 2^3 which is 1.
- Since m is odd, XOR of xor1 repeated m times equals xor1 itself.
- Since n is even, XOR of xor2 repeated n times cancels out to 0.
- XORing with zero leaves xor1 unchanged.

0 0 1 0  
 0 0 1 0  
 -----  
a ^ a = 0

2 ^ 2 ^ 2 ^ 3 ^ 3 ^ 3  
 0 ^ 2 ^ 3 ^ 3 ^ 3  
 2 ^ 3 ^ 3 ^ 3  
2 ^ 3

Logic

-----

Input: n, m  
 Input: nums1[0...n-1]  
 Input: nums2[0...m-1]

Initialize xor1 = 0  
 For i from 0 to n-1:  
     xor1 = xor1 XOR nums1[i]

Initialize xor2 = 0  
 For j from 0 to m-1:  
     xor2 = xor2 XOR nums2[j]

Initialize result = 0

If m is odd:  
     result = result XOR xor1

If n is odd:  
     result = result XOR xor2

Output result

**O(n+m) time**

even  $\begin{bmatrix} 2, 5 \\ 7, 8 \end{bmatrix}$

$(2, 7), (2, 8), (5, 7), (5, 8)$

$$(\cancel{2 \cap 7}) \wedge (\cancel{2 \cap 8}) \wedge (\cancel{5 \cap 7}) \wedge (\cancel{5 \cap 8}) \\ = \underline{\underline{0}}$$



Longest consecutive 1's

- Every iteration **shrinks the group of 1s** by one from the **right**
- So each step removes **1 bit from the group**, hence we count iterations = length of the longest streak

Let's say  $n = 29$

→ Binary: 11101

Longest consecutive 1s = 3 (from left)

Naive:

-----

```
while (n > 0) {
    if ((n & 1) == 1) {
        curr_len++;
        if (curr_len > max_len)
            max_len = curr_len;
    } else {
        curr_len = 0;
    }
    n = n >> 1;
}
```

```
System.out.println(max_len);
```

Time Complexity:  $O(\log n)$

Space Complexity:  $O(1)$

```
while (n != 0) {
    n = n & (n << 1);
    count++;
}
```

Time Complexity:  $O(k)$  where  $k$  is length of max 1s

- $n = n \& (n \ll 1)$  shrinks each group of 1s by 1 from the right
- Number of times we can repeat this until  $n == 0$  is equal to the length of the longest streak
- It's not removing the 0, but actually trimming 1s from each group

Problem:

Input:

Output:

Naive Approach:

Optimized Approach:

Problem:

Input:

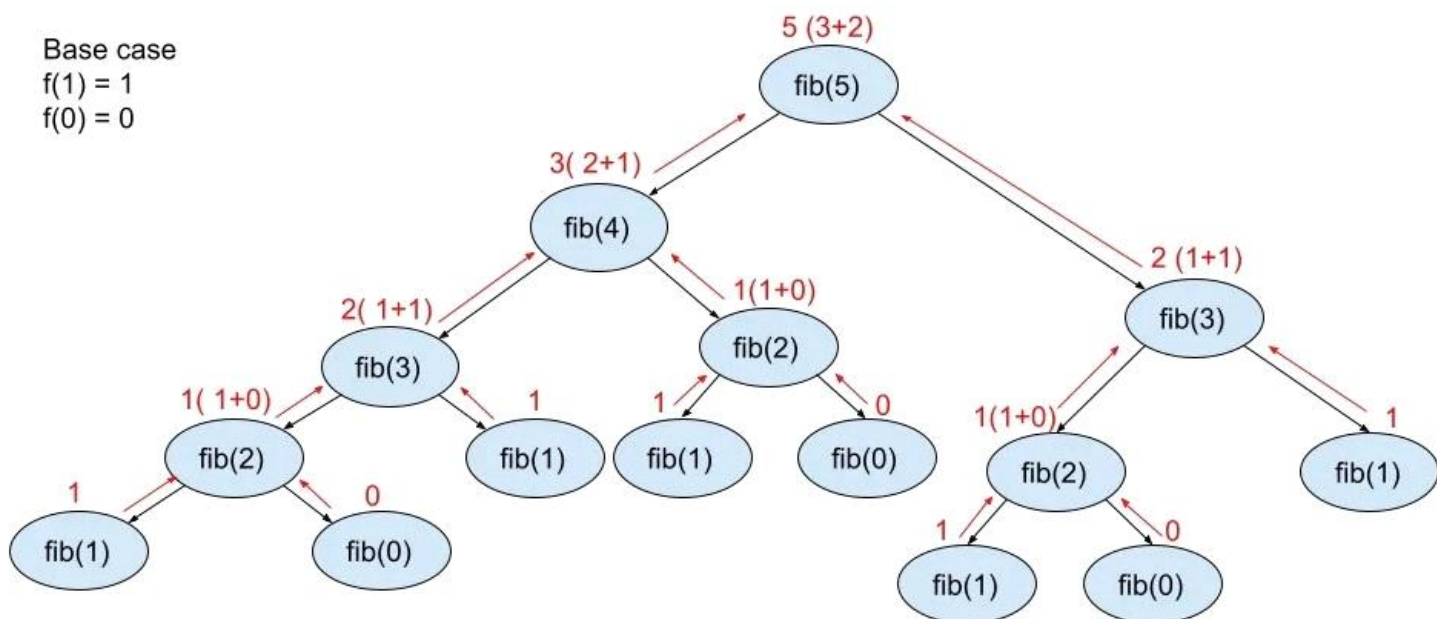
Output:

Naive Approach:

Optimized Approach:

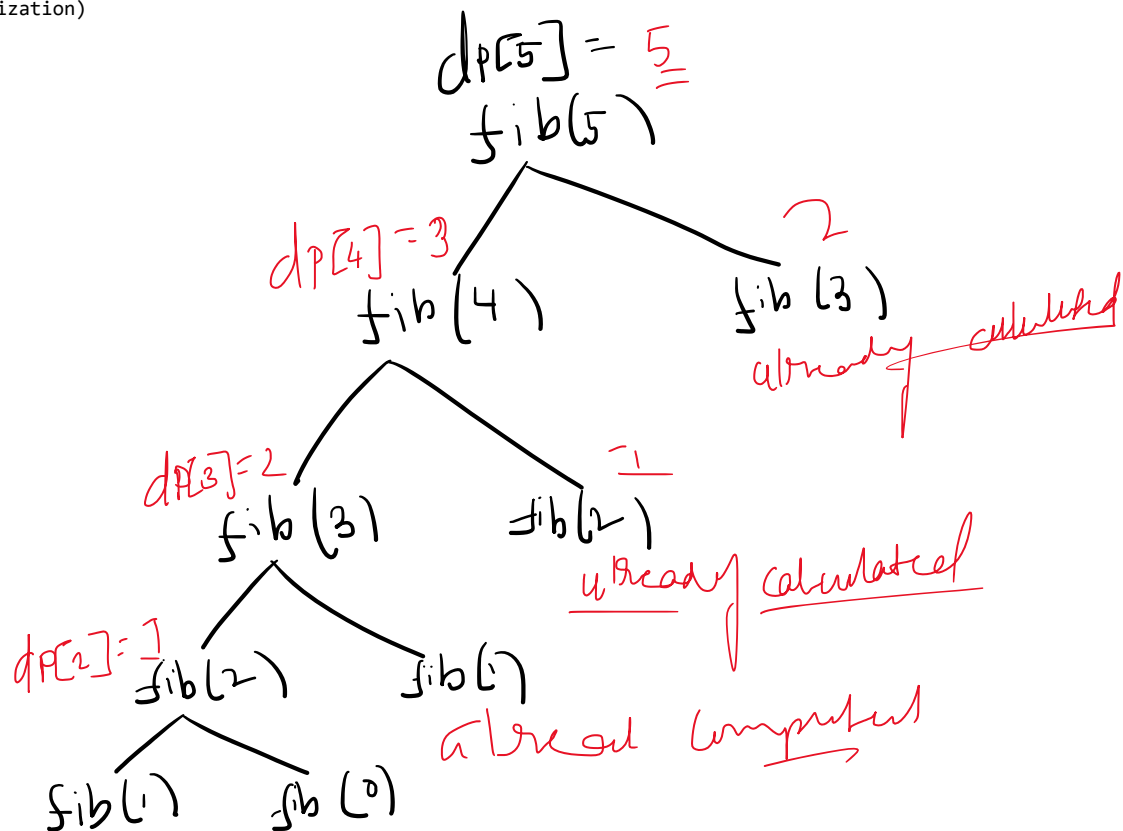
## fibonacci series recursion

```
public class FibonacciRecursive {  
    public static int fibonacci(int n) {  
        if (n == 0)  
            return 0;  
        else if (n == 1)  
            return 1;  
        else  
            return fibonacci(n - 1) + fibonacci(n - 2);  
    }  
  
    public static void main(String[] args) {  
        int n = 10;  
  
        System.out.println("Fibonacci series up to " + n + " terms:");  
        for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {  
            System.out.print(fibonacci(i) + " ");  
        }  
    }  
}
```



Exponential  $O(2^n)$

| Approach                      | Time Complexity | Space Complexity |
|-------------------------------|-----------------|------------------|
| Naive Recursion               | $O(2^n)$        | $O(n)$           |
| Recursion + Memoization       | $O(n)$          | $O(n)$           |
| Iterative DP (Bottom-Up)      | $O(n)$          | $O(n)$           |
| Iterative with Constant Space | $O(n)$          | $O(1)$           |



```

public class fib_memo {
    static int[] dp;

    public static int fib(int n) {
        if (n <= 1) return n;
        if (dp[n] != -1)
            return dp[n];
        dp[n] = fib(n - 1) + fib(n - 2);
        return dp[n];
    }

    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Scanner sc = new Scanner(System.in);
        int n = sc.nextInt();
        dp = new int[n + 1];
        Arrays.fill(dp, -1);
        System.out.println(fib(n));
    }
}

```

| n | dp[n] |
|---|-------|
| 0 | 0     |
| 1 | 1     |
| 2 | 1     |
| 3 | 2     |
| 4 | 3     |
| 5 | 5     |

Final dp[] after computation for n = 5:

**Time Complexity:**

$O(n)$

**Why?**

- Each fib(n) is computed **only once**, and stored in dp[].
- Space complexity:  $O(n)$  for the array and call stack.

- You store each Fibonacci number in dp[n] once.
- So each fib(k) from 0 to n is computed **only once**.

## fibonacci series (tabulation bottom up)

24 May 2025 14:50

```
import java.util.*;

public class fib_tab {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Scanner sc = new Scanner(System.in);
        int n = sc.nextInt();
        int[] dp = new int[n + 1];

        if (n > 0) dp[1] = 1;
        for (int i = 2; i <= n; i++) {
            dp[i] = dp[i - 1] + dp[i - 2];
        }
        System.out.println(dp[n]);
    }
}
```

$$\begin{aligned} dp[3] &= dp[2] + dp[1] \\ &= 1 + 1 \\ &= 2 \end{aligned}$$

**Time Complexity:**

$O(n)$

**Space Complexity:**

$O(n)$

# fibanccci series space optimized version of tabulation

24 May 2025 14:52

```
import java.util.*;

public class fib_best {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Scanner sc = new Scanner(System.in);
        int n = sc.nextInt();
        if (n == 0) {
            System.out.println(0);
            return;
        }
        int a = 0, b = 1;
        for (int i = 2; i <= n; i++) {
            int sum = a + b;
            a = b;
            b = sum;
        }
        System.out.println(b);
    }
}
```

**Time Complexity:**

$O(n)$

**Space Complexity:**

$O(1)$



## 0/1 knapsack problem using recursion

24 May 2025 09:12

Given  $n$  items where each item has some weight and profit associated with it and also given a bag with capacity  $W$ , [i.e., the bag can hold at most  $W$  weight in it]. The task is to put the items into the bag such that the sum of profits associated with them is the maximum possible.

**Note:** The constraint here is we can either put an item completely into the bag or cannot put it at all [It is not possible to put a part of an item into the bag].

**Input:**  $W = 4$ ,  $\text{profit}[] = [1, 2, 3]$ ,  $\text{weight}[] = [4, 5, 1]$

**Output:** 3

**Explanation:** There are two items which have weight less than or equal to 4. If we select the item with weight 4, the possible profit is 1. And if we select the item with weight 1, the possible profit is 3. So the maximum possible profit is 3. Note that we cannot put both the items with weight 4 and 1 together as the capacity of the bag is 4.

1. **Base Case:** If  $n == 0$  or  $W == 0$ , return 0.
2. **If current item can't be included** ( $\text{weight} > \text{current capacity}$ ):
  - Skip it: call recursively with  $n - 1$
3. **Else:**
  - Include current item: add its value and reduce capacity and recursively call  $n-1$
  - Exclude current item and directly call  $n-1$
  - Return max of Include and Exclude calls

```
public static int knapsack(int n, int W, int[] wt, int[] val) {
    if(n == 0 || W == 0)
        return 0;
    if(wt[n - 1] > W)
        return knapsack(n - 1, W, wt, val);
    else {
        int include = val[n - 1] + knapsack(n - 1, W - wt[n - 1], wt, val);
        int exclude = knapsack(n - 1, W, wt, val);
        return Math.max(include, exclude);
    }
}
```

### How it works:

- At every item, you make 2 choices:
  - Include the item
  - Exclude the item
- Then **recurse** on remaining items and updated capacity

### 📦 What happens:

- Subproblems **repeat multiple times**
- No memory of already computed values

for example:

For  $n=3$ ,  $W=4$ , you may call:

$\text{knapsack}(3, 4)$

↙                      ↘  
(2, 3)                  (2, 4)  
↙    ↘                  ↙    ↘  
(1,3)(1,2)    (1,4)(1,3)

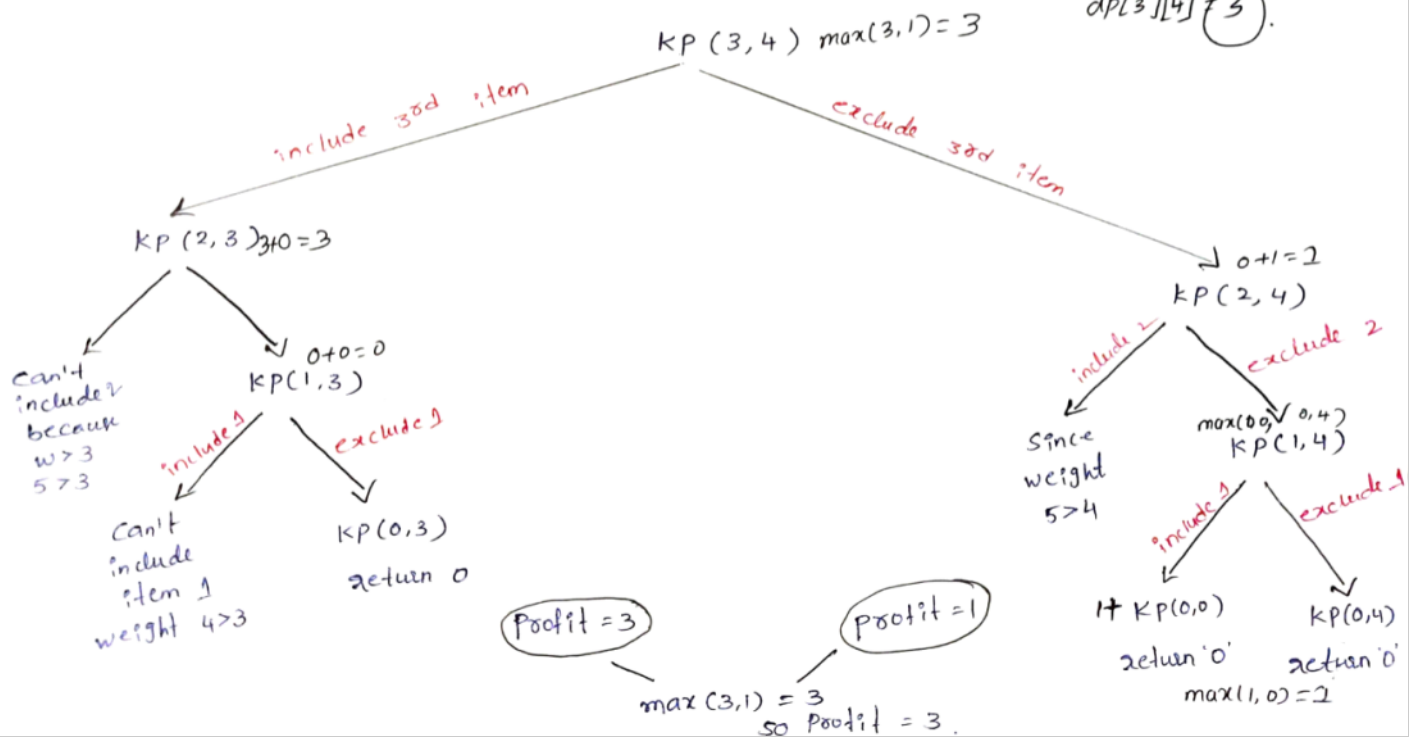
📦 Subproblem (1,3) is solved **twice**, wasting time.

# 0/1 Knapsack using Recursion & DP (top-down)

W = 3    profit = [1, 2, 3]  
weight = [4, 5, 1]

For DP

$dp[1][3] = 0$   
 $dp[2][3] = 0$   
 $dp[2][4] = 1$   
 $dp[3][4] = 3$



## Subset with sum K

**Problem:** Given  $n$  integers and an integer  $k$ , determine if there exists a subset of the given integers whose sum is exactly  $k$ .

Input:

$n = 4$

$arr = [3, 1, 5, 9]$

$k = 9$

Output: true

Because subset  $[3, 1, 5]$  or  $[9]$  sums to 9.

$n = 3$

$arr = [1, 2, 3]$

$k = 5$

Output: true

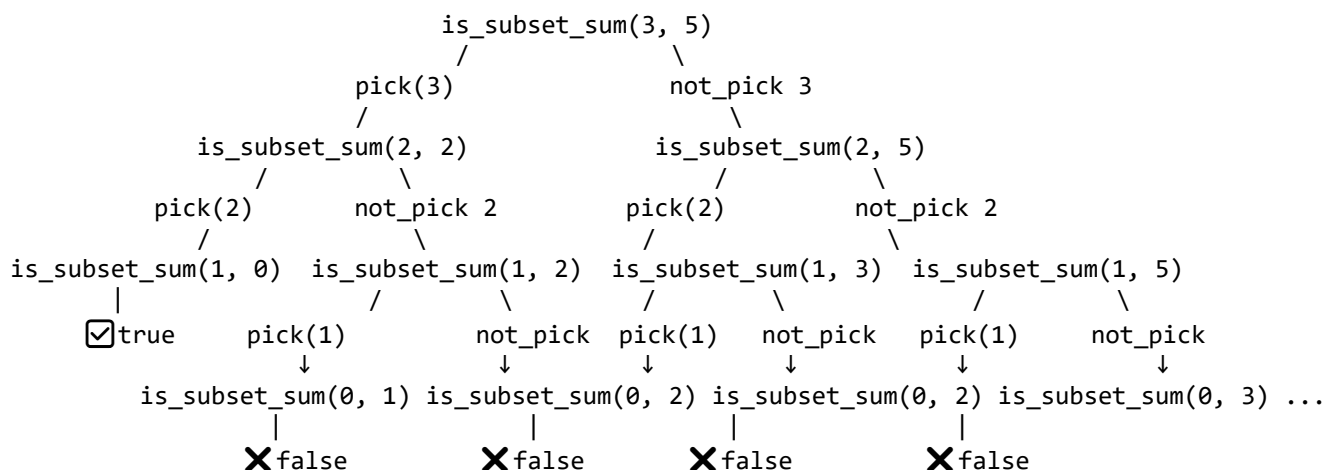
Recursive Approach Using Recursion –  $O(2^n)$  Time and  $O(n)$  Space

-----

```
boolean is_subset_sum(int[] arr, int n, int sum)
    if (sum == 0) return true;
    if (n == 0) return false;          //or arr[0]==sum..here n is index
    boolean nt_pick=is_subset_sum(arr, n - 1, sum);
    if(arr[n-1]<=k)
        boolean pick=is_subset_sum(arr, n - 1, sum - arr[n-1]);
    return pick||nt_pick;
```

recursive decision tree (input= 1 2 3 and sum=5)

-----



other variations

-----

- count of subsets: for this just return pick+not\_pick

- print the actual subset
- Variants like: , min number of elements summing to k.

## subset sum using memoization Top-Down

DP  $O(\text{sum} * n)$  Time and  $O(\text{sum} * n)$  Space

### Optimized Approach using memoization

In computing, "memoize" means to store and reuse the results of expensive function calls.  
(Top-Down DP)

- Memoization = storing results of expensive recursive calls so that we don't recompute them.
- It uses a recursive (function call) approach, and stores the result in a dp array or map.
  - Use a 2D boolean DP array  $dp[n][k+1]$  to store results of subproblems.
  - $dp[i][sum]$  indicates whether a subset of  $arr[0..i]$  can sum to sum.
  - Avoid recomputation by storing results.

**Time Complexity:**  $O(nk)$

**Space Complexity:**  $O(nk)$  for dp +  $O(n)$  recursion stack

When implementing a **recursive approach** to solve the subset sum problem, we observe that many subproblems are computed multiple times. For instance, when computing  $isSubsetSum(arr, sum)$ , where  $arr[] = \{2, 3, 1, 1\}$  and  $sum = 4$  we might need to compute  $isSubsetSum(1, 3)$  multiple times.

- The recursive solution involves changing two parameters: the **current index** in the array ( $n$ ) and the **current target sum** ( $sum$ ). We need to track both parameters, so we create a 2D array of size  $(n) \times (sum+1)$  because the value of  $n$  will be in the range  $[0, n]$  and  $sum$  will be in the range  $[0, sum]$ .
- We initialize the 2D array with -1 to indicate that no subproblems have been computed yet.
- We check if the value at  $dp[n][sum]$  is -1. If it is, we proceed to compute the result. otherwise, we return the stored result.

#### Idea:

Store results of already solved subproblems in a DP table:

- Use a 2D array  $dp[n][k+1]$
- $dp[i][sum]$  means: Is there a subset of  $arr[0..i]$  that adds up to sum?

Before computing a state, check:

```
if (dp[i][sum] != -1) return dp[i][sum] == 1;
```

$arr = [1, 2, 3], k = 5$

Possible  $i$  (indices): 0, 1, 2  $\rightarrow$  3 values

Possible sum: 0 to 5  $\rightarrow$  6 values

Total unique states =  $3 * 6 = 18$

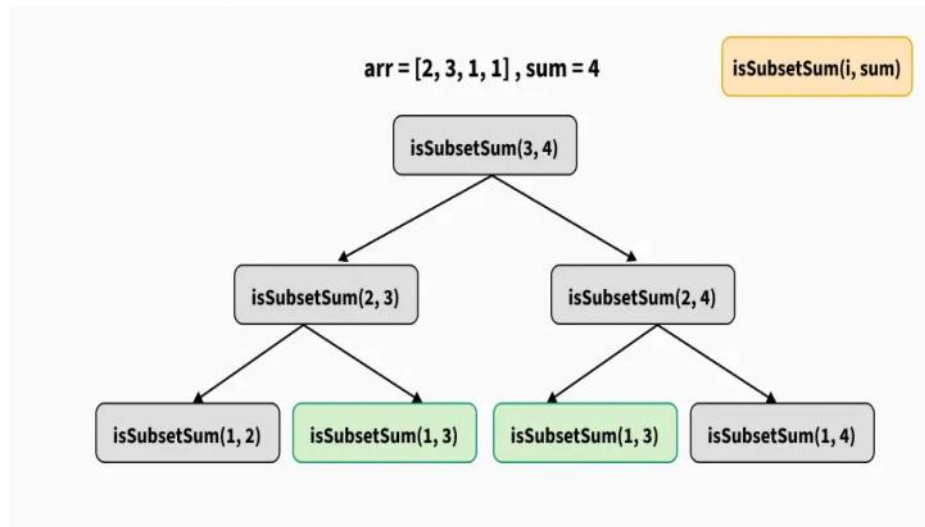
So the recursive function will run maximum 18 times

$arr[] = \{2, 3, 1, 1\}$  and  $sum = 4$  we might need to compute  $isSubsetSum(1, 3)$  multiple times.

**Key reuse:** for example:

- $subset\_sum(1, 3)$  is first computed using base case  $subset\_sum(0, 0)$
- Its result ( $dp[1][3] = 1$ ) is stored

- Later, inside `subset_sum(2, 3)` and again in `subset_sum(2, 4)`, the result is reused from `dp[1][3]`
- This is the core benefit of memoization: avoiding duplicate computations by remembering earlier answers.



```

subset_sum(3, 4)
├── not_pick → subset_sum(2, 4)
│   ├── not_pick → subset_sum(1, 4)
│   │   ├── not_pick → subset_sum(0, 4) = 0 → dp[0][4] = 0
│   │   └── pick → subset_sum(0, 1) = 0 → dp[0][1] = 0
│   └── → dp[1][4] = 0
│   └── pick → subset_sum(1, 3)
│       ├── not_pick → subset_sum(0, 3) = 0 → dp[0][3] = 0
│       └── pick → subset_sum(0, 0) = 1 → ✓ base → dp[0][0] = 1
│       └── → dp[1][3] = 1
│       └── → dp[2][4] = 1 ← (from dp[1][3])
├── pick → subset_sum(2, 3)
│   ├── not_pick → subset_sum(1, 3) = ✓ reused → dp[1][3] = 1
│   └── pick → subset_sum(1, 2)
│       ├── not_pick → subset_sum(0, 2) = 1 → dp[0][2] = 1
│       └── pick → subset_sum(0, 1) = 0 → dp[0][1] = 0
│       └── → dp[1][2] = 1
│       └── → dp[2][3] = 1
└── → dp[3][4] = 1 (from dp[2][4] or dp[2][3])
  
```

stack function calls

-----

| Step | Function Call    | Condition / Explanation                         | Result | dp[i][k] Updated |
|------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------|--------|------------------|
| 1    | subset_sum(0, 0) | Base case (k=0)                                 | true   | dp[0][0] = 1     |
| 2    | subset_sum(0, 1) | arr[0]=2 ≠ 1 → false                            | false  | dp[0][1] = 0     |
| 3    | subset_sum(0, 2) | arr[0]=2 == 2 → true                            | true   | dp[0][2] = 1     |
| 4    | subset_sum(0, 3) | arr[0]=2 ≠ 3 → false                            | false  | dp[0][3] = 0     |
| 5    | subset_sum(0, 4) | arr[0]=2 ≠ 4 → false                            | false  | dp[0][4] = 0     |
| 6    | subset_sum(1, 1) | not_pick=0, pick from subset_sum(0, -2) invalid | false  | dp[1][1] = 0     |

|    |                               |                                                           |                    |                           |
|----|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------|
| 7  | <code>subset_sum(1, 2)</code> | <code>not_pick = dp[0][2] = 1, pick = invalid</code>      | <code>true</code>  | <code>dp[1][2] = 1</code> |
| 8  | <code>subset_sum(1, 3)</code> | <code>pick from subset_sum(0, 0) = 1</code>               | <code>true</code>  | <code>dp[1][3] = 1</code> |
| 9  | <code>subset_sum(1, 4)</code> | <code>not_pick = 0, pick = dp[0][1] = 0</code>            | <code>false</code> | <code>dp[1][4] = 0</code> |
| 10 | <code>subset_sum(2, 3)</code> | <code>not_pick = dp[1][3] = 1, pick = dp[1][2] = 1</code> | <code>true</code>  | <code>dp[2][3] = 1</code> |
| 11 | <code>subset_sum(2, 4)</code> | <code>not_pick = dp[1][4] = 0, pick = dp[1][3] = 1</code> | <code>true</code>  | <code>dp[2][4] = 1</code> |
| 12 | <code>subset_sum(3, 4)</code> | <code>not_pick = dp[2][4] = 1, pick = dp[2][3] = 1</code> | <code>true</code>  | <code>dp[3][4] = 1</code> |

initial call `subset(n-1,k)` where `k` is the sum

```

Function subset_sum(n, k):
    If k == 0:
        return True

    If n == 0:
        return arr[0] == k (or false)

    If dp[i][k] != -1:
        return dp[i][k]

    not_pick = subset_sum(n - 1, k)

    pick = False
    If arr[i] <= k:
        pick = subset_sum(n - 1, k - arr[n])

    dp[n][k] = pick || not_pick

    return dp[i][k] == 1

```

the **sum k can range from 0 to k inclusive.**

This means we need to store results for all these values:

`k = 0, 1, 2, ..., k`

=> total `(k + 1)` values

If you only create `dp[n][k]`, then the **index k is out of bounds**, because array indices go from 0 to `k - 1`.

**In top-down recursion:**

- You start with the **last index `i = n - 1`**
- You recurse down to **index 0**

- So valid  $i$  values are  $0$  to  $n - 1 \rightarrow$  total  $n$  rows
- Therefore,  $dp[n][\dots]$  ( $0$ -based indexing) is **exact**.

For input  $arr = [2, 3, 1, 1]$ ,  $k = 4$ , we call:

```
subset_sum(3, 4)  ← this is the top-level problem
    ↓
subset_sum(2, 4)
    ↓
subset_sum(1, 4)
    ↓
subset_sum(0, 4)
```

We **start at the top** ( $i = n - 1$ ,  $k = \text{sum}$ ) and go downward into subproblems ( $i - 1$ , smaller  $k$ ) – hence called **top-down**.

for counting number of such subsets.

```
dp[n][k] = pick + not_pick;
return dp[n][k];
```



## subset sum with K Tabulation approach(Bottom Up)

### Total operations:

- For each i (0 to n-1): **n iterations**
- For each j (0 to k): **k+1 iterations**
- Total = roughly  $n * k$  operations.

```
boolean[][] dp = new boolean[n][k + 1];

for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) dp[i][0] = true
// for all other sums, dp[0][sum] remains false by default (boolean array)
if (arr[0] <= k) dp[0][arr[0]] = true
for (int i = 1; i < n; i++)
    for (int sum = 1; sum <= k; sum++)
        boolean not_pick = dp[i - 1][sum]
        boolean pick = false
        if (arr[i] <= sum)
            pick = dp[i - 1][sum - arr[i]]

        dp[i][sum] = pick || not_pick;

return dp[n - 1][k]
```

This line sets  $dp[i][0] = \text{true}$  for all  $i$  because:

- The **subset sum problem** asks: "Is there a subset of the first  $i$  elements that sums to  $j$ ?"
- When  $j = 0$  (sum = 0), the answer is **always YES** regardless of which elements you consider.

Why?

- Because the **empty subset** (no elements chosen) always has sum 0.

So for **any**  $i$ , it is always possible to form sum 0 by choosing no elements.

### What does filling the table signify in each iteration?

- Each iteration considers one more element of the array.
- For every possible sum from 0 to  $k$ , it answers:  
"Can I form this sum using elements up to index  $i$ ?"
- It **builds up knowledge** from smaller subproblems (previous rows) to solve bigger subproblems (current row).
- By the time the table is fully filled, it contains answers
- for **all subsets** and **all sums** up to  $k$ .

### Quick visual for example $\text{arr}=[2,3,1,1]$ , $k=4$

| i \ sum | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---------|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 (2)   | T | F | T | F | F |
| 1 (3)   | T | F | T | T | T |
| 2 (1)   | T | T | T | T | T |
| 3 (1)   | T | T | T | T | T |

In the DP table for the **subset sum problem**, each cell  $dp[i][\text{sum}]$  represents:

**Is there a subset among the first  $i+1$  elements ( $\text{arr}[0..i]$ ) that sums up to sum?**

$dp[2][1] = \text{true}$  – What does this mean?

Using the first 3 elements of the array ( $\text{arr}[0]$ ,  $\text{arr}[1]$ , and  $\text{arr}[2]$ ), we can form a subset whose sum is exactly

1.

`dp[1][2] = true`

It means:

Using the first two elements of the array (`arr[0]`, `arr[1]`), it is possible to form a subset whose sum is exactly 2.

📄 Given:

Array = [2, 3, 1, 1]

Index 1 means second element → `arr[1] = 3`

So we are checking whether using only [2, 3], we can form sum = 2.

Initial dp table after base setup (T = true, F = false):

| i \ sum | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---------|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0       | T | F | T | F | F |
| 1       | T | F | F | F | F |
| 2       | T | F | F | F | F |
| 3       | T | F | F | F | F |

Loop trace:

For i = 1 (element = 3):

- sum = 1:
  - not\_pick = `dp[0][1]` = F
  - pick: `arr[1] = 3 > 1` → no pick → F
  - `dp[1][1]` = F || F = F
- sum = 2:
  - not\_pick = `dp[0][2]` = T
  - pick: `arr[1] = 3 > 2` → no pick → F
  - `dp[1][2]` = T || F = T
- sum = 3:
  - not\_pick = `dp[0][3]` = F
  - pick: `arr[1] = 3 ≤ 3` → `dp[0][3-3]=dp[0][0]` = T
  - `dp[1][3]` = F || T = T
- sum = 4:
  - not\_pick = `dp[0][4]` = F
  - pick: `arr[1] = 3 ≤ 4` → `dp[0][4-3] = dp[0][1]` = F
  - `dp[1][4]` = F || F = F

dp after i=1:

| i \ sum | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---------|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0       | T | F | T | F | F |
| 1       | T | F | T | T | F |
| 2       | T | F | F | F | F |
| 3       | T | F | F | F | F |

Expression

Meaning

`dp[i - 1][sum]` Can I make sum **without** using `arr[i]` (not pick)?

`dp[i - 1][sum - arr[i]]` Can I make sum **by including** `arr[i]`? (pick)

Suppose:

`arr = [2, 3, 1, 1]`, sum = 4, you're at `i = 2` → `arr[2] = 1`

You want `dp[2][4]` = ?

Can we form sum = 4 using the first 3 elements: [2, 3, 1]?

1. not\_pick:

→ `dp[1][4]`

→ Did we already form 4 using just [2, 3]?

2. pick:

→ Only valid if  $\text{arr}[2] \leq 4 \rightarrow \checkmark$  true

→ We check:  $\text{dp}[1][4 - \text{arr}[2]] = \text{dp}[1][3]$

So we need:

- $\text{dp}[1][4] = ?$
- $\text{dp}[1][3] = ?$

- $\text{dp}[1][4]$  (using  $[2,3]$ ) is false because neither 2 nor 3 nor  $2+3=5$  equals 4.
- $\text{dp}[1][3]$  (using  $[2,3]$ ) is true because subset  $[3]$  sums to 3.

So  $\text{dp}[2][4] = \text{false} \parallel \text{true} = \text{true}$

- At  $\text{dp}[2][4]$ , we get true because we can pick  $\text{arr}[2] = 1$  and combine with sum 3 from previous elements (subset  $[3]$ ) to get sum 4.
- So the subset is  $[3, 1]$  – from first 3 elements.

## Subset sum with K space optimized approach

### Using Space Optimized DP - $O(\text{sum} \times n)$ Time and $O(\text{sum})$ Space

- Instead of a 2D  $\text{dp}[n][k+1]$  table, we use a 1D boolean array  $\text{dp}[k+1]$ .
- $\text{dp}[\text{sum}]$  means:  
*Is there a subset (from elements processed so far) with sum sum?*
- We update this array for each element.
- We update sums in **reverse order** (from  $k$  down to  $\text{arr}[i]$ ) to avoid using the updated values of the same iteration.

Imagine we go **forward** from  $\text{sum} = \text{arr}[i]$  up to  $k$ . When we update  $\text{dp}[\text{sum}] = \text{dp}[\text{sum}] \mid \mid \text{dp}[\text{sum} - \text{arr}[i]]$ , the value of  $\text{dp}[\text{sum} - \text{arr}[i]]$  might have just been updated in the current iteration **using the same element  $\text{arr}[i]$** . That means the current element could be counted multiple times for the same subset sum, which is wrong (we want each element counted once per subset).

To **avoid reusing the same element multiple times** in one iteration

First,  $\text{arr}[0] = 2$ :

→  $\text{dp}[2] = \text{true}$

Now,  $\text{arr}[0] = 2$  again (due to forward iteration):

→  $\text{dp}[4] = \text{dp}[2] = \text{true}$

This falsely concludes:

→  $\text{dp}[4] = \text{true} \Rightarrow \text{subset } \{2, 2\} \text{ exists}$

But 2 appears **only once** in input!

**That's wrong.** The subset  $\{2, 2\}$  isn't valid in 0/1 case.

- That condition checks if a subset with sum  $(\text{sum} - \text{arr}[i])$  already exists, then by adding the current element  $\text{arr}[i]$ , a subset with sum  $\text{sum}$  can also be formed.
- 
- Explanation:
  - $\text{dp}[\text{sum} - \text{arr}[i]] == \text{true}$  means:  
There exists a subset among the elements processed so far whose sum equals  $\text{sum} - \text{arr}[i]$ .
  - If you add the current element  $\text{arr}[i]$  to that subset, the sum becomes  $(\text{sum} - \text{arr}[i]) + \text{arr}[i] = \text{sum}$ .
  - So, by including  $\text{arr}[i]$ , we can form a subset with sum  $\text{sum}$ .

Suppose:

- $\text{arr}[i] = 3$

- We want to check if a subset sum of  $\text{sum} = 5$  is possible.

If  $\text{dp}[5 - 3] = \text{dp}[2]$  is true (meaning subset with sum 2 exists), then by adding 3, subset sum 5 can be formed, so  $\text{dp}[5] = \text{true}$ .

```
boolean[] dp = new boolean[k+1];  
dp[0] = true;
```

$\text{dp}[0] = \text{true}$

It represents:

An empty subset can always give  $\text{sum} = 0$ .

So it's always true from the start.

```
if (arr[0] <= k) dp[arr[0]] = true;  
for (int i=1; i<n; i++) {  
    for (int sum=k; sum>=arr[i]; sum--) {  
        if (dp[sum - arr[i]]) {  
            dp[sum] = true;  
        }  
    }  
}
```

```
System.out.println(dp[k]);
```

arr = [2,3,1,1] and k = 4

| Index (Sum) | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|-------------|---|---|---|---|---|
| dp (start)  | T | F | F | F | F |

| Index (Sum)       | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|-------------------|---|---|---|---|---|
| dp after arr[0]=2 | T | F | T | F | F |

**Step 2: Process arr[1] = 3**

Loop from 4 to 3:

- dp[3] = dp[0] = true
- So update dp[3] = true

| Index (Sum)       | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|-------------------|---|---|---|---|---|
| dp after arr[1]=3 | T | F | T | T | F |

**Step 3: Process arr[2] = 1**

Loop from 4 to 1:

- dp[4] = dp[3] = true
- dp[3] = dp[2] = true (already true)
- dp[1] = dp[0] = true

| Index (Sum)       | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|-------------------|---|---|---|---|---|
| dp after arr[2]=1 | T | T | T | T | T |

☑ We found dp[4] = true ⇒ subset exists.

similarly step 4: arr[3]=1

**Final DP Table**

| Sum | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|-----|---|---|---|---|---|
| dp  | T | T | T | T | T |

Meaning:

-----

You can form all sums from 0 to 4 using subsets of {2, 3, 1, 1}.

Some subsets:

- Sum 1 → {1}
- Sum 2 → {2}
- Sum 3 → {2,1} or {3}
- Sum 4 → {3,1} or {2,1,1}

## String Partitioning

Given a string `s` and a dictionary `wordDict`, determine if `s` can be segmented into a space-separated sequence of one or more dictionary words.

**Input:** `s = "applepenapple", wordDict = ["apple","pen"]`

**Output:** `true`

**Explanation:** Return true because "applepenapple" can be segmented as "apple pen apple". Note that you are allowed to reuse a dictionary word.

**Example 3:**

**Input:** `s = "catsanddog", wordDict = ["cats","dog","sand","and","cat"]`

**Output:** `false`

### Approach 1: Recursion without memoization ( $O(2^n)$ )

#### ✧ Idea:

At every position `i` in the string `s`, try **all possible prefixes** `s[0...j]` and:

- If prefix is in dictionary ☒, recursively check the **remaining suffix** `s[j+1:]`.

#### Input:

`s = "applepenapple"`

`wordDict = ["apple", "pen"]`

#### ☒ Goal:

Check if "applepenapple" can be segmented using words from the dictionary ["apple", "pen"].

#### ☒ Dictionary:

`dict = {"apple", "pen"}`

#### 🔍 RECURSION TRACE:

We will recursively try all **prefixes** of the current string and proceed only when the prefix is in the dictionary.

#### Step 1: Call with `s = "applepenapple"`

Check all prefixes:

- "a" ✗
- "ap" ✗
- "app" ✗
- "appl" ✗
- "apple" ☒ → in dictionary → Recurse on "penapple"

#### Step 2: Call with `s = "penapple"`

Check all prefixes:

- "p" ✗
- "pe" ✗
- "pen" ☒ → in dictionary → Recurse on "apple"

#### Step 3: Call with `s = "apple"`

Check all prefixes:

- "a" ✗
- "ap" ✗
- "app" ✗
- "appl" ✗
- "apple" ☒ → in dictionary → Recurse on ""

#### Step 4: Call with `s = ""` → Reached empty string → return true

Now we backtrack all the way up:

- Step 3 returns true
- Step 2 returns true
- Step 1 returns true

**FINAL RESULT: true**

We could segment:

"apple" + "pen" + "apple"

**CALL STACK:**

```
word_break("applepenapple")
└─ prefix = "apple" ✓
    └─ word_break("penapple")
        └─ prefix = "pen" ✓
            └─ word_break("apple")
                └─ prefix = "apple" ✓
                    └─ word_break("") → ✓ base case
```

```
public static boolean word_break(String s, Set<String> dict)
    if (s.length() == 0)
        return true
    for (int i = 1; i <= s.length(); i++)
        String prefix = s.substring(0, i)
        if (dict.contains(prefix))
            if (word_break(s.substring(i), dict))
                return true
    return false
```

Approach 2 using DP (same time complexity)

-----

We use a dp[i] array where:

- dp[i] = true means s[0..i-1] can be segmented using words from the dictionary.

```
s = "applepenapple"
wordDict = ["apple", "pen"]
```

Setup:

```
s.length() = 13
```

dp array size = 14 (0 to 13)

dp[0] = true (empty string can be segmented)

dp[i] means s[0..i-1] can be segmented into dictionary words.

```

Initially:
dp = [T, F, F, F, F, F, F, F, F, F, F, F, F, F]
Index: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13
Iteration over i from 1 to 13:
i = 1
Check j = 0: s[0..0] = "a" not in dict → dp[1] = false

i = 2
j = 0: "ap" no

j = 1: "p" no → dp[2] = false

i = 3
j=0: "app" no

j=1: "pp" no

j=2: "p" no → dp[3] = false

i = 4
j=0: "appl" no

j=1: "ppl" no

j=2: "pl" no

j=3: "l" no → dp[4] = false

i = 5
j=0: "apple" → YES, in dict and dp[0] = true
→ dp[5] = true, break inner loop

dp = [T, F, F, F, F, T, F, F, F, F, F, F, F, F]
i = 6
j=0: "applep" no

j=1: "pplep" no

j=2: "plep" no

j=3: "lep" no

j=4: "ep" no

j=5: "p" no → dp[6] = false

i = 7
similarly check substrings ending at 7 → no match
dp[7] = false

i = 8
j=0 to 4 no matches

j=5: s[5..7] = "pen" YES in dict, dp[5] = true
→ dp[8] = true, break inner loop

dp = [T, F, F, F, F, T, F, F, T, F, F, F, F, F]
i = 9
check substrings ending at 9 → no matches
dp[9] = false

i = 10
no matches
dp[10] = false

i = 11
no matches
dp[11] = false

i = 12

```



```
no matches
dp[12] = false
```

```
i = 13
j=0 to 7 no matches
```

```
j=8: s[8..12] = "apple" in dict, dp[8] = true → YES
→ dp[13] = true
```

```
dp = [T, F, F, F, F, T, F, F, T, F, F, F, F, T]
```

```
Final dp array:
```

```
r
```

```
Index:  0  1  2  3  4  5  6  7  8  9 10 11 12 13
```

```
dp[] = [T, F, F, F, F, T, F, F, T, F, F, F, F, T]
```

```
dp[13] = true means the whole string "applepenapple" can be segmented as dictionary words.
```

```
Summary:
```

```
"apple" at indices [0..4]
```

```
"pen" at indices [5..7]
```

```
"apple" at indices [8..12]
```

```
Function String_partitioning(s: string, dict: set of words):
    n = length of s
```

```
    dp = array of boolean of size (n + 1)
    dp[0] = true    // base case
```

```
    for i from 1 to n:
        for j from 0 to i:
            if dp[j] == 1 AND substring s[j to i-1] in dict
                dp[i] = true
                break
    return dp[n]
```

## Minimum number of partitions.

Given a string  $s$  find the minimum number of partitions of a string  $s$  such that each partition is a word from the dictionary,

You only want the minimum number of valid words to cover the entire string.

```
s = "pineapplepenapple"
dict = ["pine", "apple", "pen", "applepen", "pineapple"]
Partitions:
```

"pine" + "apple" + "pen" + "apple" → 4 partitions

"pineapple" + "pen" + "apple" → 3 partitions (minimum)

"pine" + "applepen" + "apple" → 3 partitions (minimum)

Minimum partitions = 3, but some partitions have 4 parts.

• len = 13 (length of "applepenapple")  
We fill  $dp[]$  from  $i=1$  to 13.

**i = 1:**  
Check substrings  $s[j..i-1]$ :  
•  $j=0$ :  $s[0..0] = "a" \rightarrow$  not in dict  $\rightarrow$  no update  $\rightarrow dp[1] = \infty$

**i = 2:**  
•  $j=0$ : "ap"  $\rightarrow$  no  
•  $j=1$ : "p"  $\rightarrow$  no  
 $dp[2] = \infty$

**i = 3:**  
•  $j=0$ : "app"  $\rightarrow$  no  
•  $j=1$ : "pp"  $\rightarrow$  no  
•  $j=2$ : "p"  $\rightarrow$  no  
 $dp[3] = \infty$

**i = 4:**  
•  $j=0$ : "appl"  $\rightarrow$  no  
•  $j=1$ : "ppl"  $\rightarrow$  no  
•  $j=2$ : "pl"  $\rightarrow$  no  
•  $j=3$ : "l"  $\rightarrow$  no  
 $dp[4] = \infty$

**i = 5:**  
•  $j=0$ : "apple"  $\rightarrow$  yes in dict and  $dp[0] = 0$   
 $\rightarrow dp[5] = \min(\infty, 0 + 1) = 1$   
• other  $j$ 's ignored since  $dp[j]$  is  $\infty$

**i = 6:**  
•  $j=0$ : "applep"  $\rightarrow$  no  
•  $j=1..5$  substrings no match  
 $dp[6] = \infty$

**i = 7:**  
•  $j=0..6$  no substring in dict  
 $dp[7] = \infty$

**i = 8:**  
•  $j=0..7$  no substring in dict  
 $dp[8] = \infty$

**i = 9:**  
•  $j=0..4$  no

- $j=5$ : "pen" → yes in dict and  $dp[5] = 1$   
→  $dp[9] = \min(\infty, 1 + 1) = 2$

**i = 10..12:**

No valid substrings in dict

$dp[10] = \infty$ ,  $dp[11] = \infty$ ,  $dp[12] = \infty$

**i = 13:**

- $j=0..8$  no
- $j=9$ : "apple" → yes and  $dp[9] = 2$   
→  $dp[13] = \min(\infty, 2 + 1) = 3$

- $dp[5] = 1$  means minimum 1 partition for "apple"
  - $dp[9] = 2$  means minimum 2 partitions for "applepen"
  - $dp[13] = 3$  means minimum 3 partitions for full string
- So the minimum partitions to segment "applepenapple" into dictionary words = 3

```
int len = s.length();
int[] dp = new int[len + 1];
Arrays.fill(dp, Integer.MAX_VALUE);
dp[0] = 0;
for (int i = 1; i <= len; i++) {
    for (int j = 0; j < i; j++) {
        String sub = s.substring(j, i);
        if (dp[j] != Integer.MAX_VALUE && dict.contains(sub)) {
            dp[i] = Math.min(dp[i], dp[j] + 1);
        }
    }
}
if (dp[len] == Integer.MAX_VALUE) {
    System.out.println(-1);
} else {
    System.out.println(dp[len]);
}
```

## Number of ways to Partition String

Given a string `s` and a set of dictionary words `dict`, Count how many ways the string can be broken into valid dictionary words.

Note: all segmentations must start from the beginning of the string `s`.

So it is mandatory to begin matching from index 0 of the string and proceed left to right

**Input:**

```
s = "applepenapple"
```

```
dict = ["apple", "pen"]
```

**Output:**

1

Because only one valid way: "apple pen apple"

**Input:**

```
s = "pineapplepenapple"
```

```
dict = ["apple", "pen", "applepen", "pine", "pineapple"]
```

**Output:**

3

**Explanation:**

The string "pineapplepenapple" can be segmented in 3 ways:

"pine" + "apple" + "pen" + "apple"

"pineapple" + "pen" + "apple"

"pine" + "applepen" + "apple"

```
int len = s.length()
int[] dp = new int[len + 1]
dp[0] = 1
```

```
for (int i = 1; i <= len; i++)
    for (int j = 0; j < i; j++)
        String sub = s.substring(j, i)
        if (dict.contains(sub)) {
            dp[i] += dp[j]
```

```
s = "pineapplepenapple"
```

```
Length = 17
```

```
Initialize:
```

```
dp[0] = 1 (empty string)
```

```
dp[1] to dp[17] = 0
```

```
Now iterate:
```

**At i = 4:**

- `s[0..4]` = "pine" is in dict  
→ `dp[4] += dp[0]` = 1  
→ `dp[4]` = 1

**At i = 9:**

- `s[4..9]` = "apple" is in dict  
→ `dp[9] += dp[4]` = 1  
→ `dp[9]` = 1
- `s[0..9]` = "pineapple" is in dict  
→ `dp[9] += dp[0]` = 1  
→ `dp[9]` = 2

**At i = 12:**

- `s[9..12]` = "pen" is in dict

→  $dp[12] += dp[9] = 2$

→  $dp[12] = 2$

At  $i = 13$ :

- $s[4..13] = \text{"applepen"}$  is in dict

→  $dp[13] += dp[4] = 1$

→  $dp[13] = 1$

At  $i = 17$ :

- $s[12..17] = \text{"apple"}$  is in dict

→  $dp[17] += dp[12] = 2$

→  $dp[17] = 2$

- $s[13..17] = \text{"apple"}$  is in dict

→  $dp[17] += dp[13] = 1$

→  $dp[17] = 3$

#### ☒ Final DP Table

Index (i)  $dp[i]$   $s[0..i-1]$

|    |   |                     |
|----|---|---------------------|
| 0  | 1 | ""                  |
| 4  | 1 | "pine"              |
| 9  | 2 | "pineapple"         |
| 12 | 2 | "pineapplepen"      |
| 13 | 1 | "pineapplepena"     |
| 17 | 3 | "pineapplepenapple" |

→ So,  $dp[17] = 3 = \text{number of ways to partition.}$

#### ☒ Time and Space Complexity

- Time:  $O(n^2)$  due to nested loops over substring generation
- Space:  $O(n)$  for  $dp[]$  array

Why is  $dp[12] = 2$  for:

$s = \text{"pineapplepenapple"}$

$\text{dict} = [\text{"apple"}, \text{"pen"}, \text{"applepen"}, \text{"pine"}, \text{"pineapple"}]$

We're checking all possible substrings ending at index 12.

Let's try all valid segmentations of "pineapplepen":

Option 1:

- "pine" (0..3) + "applepen" (4..11)

- "pine" and "applepen" are both in dict → ☒

→ So one valid segmentation

Option 2:

- "pineapple" (0..8) + "pen" (9..11)

- Both in dict → ☒

→ Second valid segmentation

#### ☒ Therefore:

- $dp[12] = 2$  because:
  - "pine" + "applepen"
  - "pineapple" + "pen"

These are 2 valid ways to split "pineapplepen"

$dp[9] = dp[0] + dp[4] = 1 + 1 = 2$

This means there are two ways to segment "pineapple":

"pine" + "apple"

"pineapple"

```
Function String_partitioning(s: string, dict: set of words):  
    n = length of s  
  
    dp = array of boolean of size (n + 1)  
    dp[0] = true    // base case  
  
    for i from 1 to n:  
        for j from 0 to i:  
            if dp[j] == 1 AND substring s[j to i-1] in dict  
                dp[i] = true  
                break  
    return dp[n]
```

## Min fib terms to sum upto K

### Problem:

Given a number  $k$ , the task is to find the minimum number of Fibonacci terms (including repetitions) whose sum equals  $k$ .

**Note:** You may use any Fibonacci number multiple times.

### Examples:

**Input:**  $k = 7$

**Output:** 2

**Explanation:** Possible ways to sum up to 7 using Fibonacci numbers:

$5 + 2 = 7$  (2 terms)

$3 + 3 + 1 = 7$  (3 terms)

$2 + 2 + 2 + 1 = 7$  (4 terms)

The minimum number of terms is 2, using  $5 + 2$ .

- Use **Fibonacci numbers** (like 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, ...)  $\leq k$
- Can use any Fibonacci number **multiple times**
- Return the **minimum number of terms** required to form sum =  $k$
- Try all Fibonacci numbers  $\leq k$ . For each, recursively subtract and find the minimum number of terms.

In each recursive call:

- You try all valid Fibonacci numbers  $f$  such that  $f \leq k$
- You do:  $\text{min} = \min(\text{min}, 1 + \text{solve}(k - f))$
- The  $1 +$  is because you've used one term ( $f$ )
- You return the smallest number of terms needed to build  $k$

$\text{solve}(7)$

Fibonacci numbers  $\leq 7$ : [1, 2, 3, 5]

You try:

| Choice ( $f$ ) | Subproblem | Terms | Total | Terms |
|----------------|------------|-------|-------|-------|
|----------------|------------|-------|-------|-------|

|         |                   |   |                       |  |
|---------|-------------------|---|-----------------------|--|
| $f = 1$ | $\text{solve}(6)$ | ? | $1 + \text{solve}(6)$ |  |
|---------|-------------------|---|-----------------------|--|

|         |                   |   |             |   |
|---------|-------------------|---|-------------|---|
| $f = 2$ | $\text{solve}(5)$ | 1 | $1 + 1 = 2$ | ☑ |
|---------|-------------------|---|-------------|---|

|         |                   |   |             |  |
|---------|-------------------|---|-------------|--|
| $f = 3$ | $\text{solve}(4)$ | 2 | $1 + 2 = 3$ |  |
|---------|-------------------|---|-------------|--|

|         |                   |   |             |   |
|---------|-------------------|---|-------------|---|
| $f = 5$ | $\text{solve}(2)$ | 1 | $1 + 1 = 2$ | ☑ |
|---------|-------------------|---|-------------|---|

Now among all these, the **minimum** is:

$\text{min} = \min(3, 2, 2) = 2$

So  $\text{solve}(7) = 2$

time complexity:  $O(2^k)$   
space:  $O(k)$



## Backtracking Intro

Backtracking algorithms are like problem-solving strategies that help explore different options to find the best solution. They work by trying out different paths and if one doesn't work, they backtrack and try another until they find the right one. It's like solving a puzzle by testing different pieces until they fit together perfectly.

**There are three types of problems in backtracking:**

- Decision Problem - In this, we search for a feasible solution.
- Optimization Problem - In this, we search for the best solution.
- Enumeration Problem - In this, we find all feasible solutions.

|                                             |                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Recursion does not always need backtracking | Backtracking always uses recursion to solve problems |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|

|                                                |                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Recursion usually involves $O(n)$ stack space. | Backtracking can be $O(n!)$ or more depending on constraints. |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|

## Print all valid parantheses

**Problem:** Given a number  $n$ , print all combinations of balanced parentheses of length  $n$ .

**Note:** A sequence of parentheses is balanced if every opening bracket ( has a corresponding closing bracket ) in the correct order.

**Examples:**

**Input:**  $n = 2$

**Output:** "( )"

**Explanation:** Only one valid sequence can be formed using 1 pair of parentheses, and it is balanced.

**Input :**  $n = 4$

**Output:** "( ( ) )", "( ) ( )"

**Explanation:** Two valid balanced sequences are possible with 2 pairs: one with nested parentheses, and one with pairs side by side.

### Approach 1: Naive – Generate All Sequences → Filter Valid Ones

**Idea:**

Generate all strings of length  $n$  using only ( and ), then **check each** for balance using a counter.

**Time Complexity:**

- Total sequences =  $2^n$
- For each,  $O(n)$  to check balance  
 $\Rightarrow O(n * 2^n)$

**Step 1: Generate All Strings of ( and ) of length  $n$**

Each position has 2 choices:

- Either '('
- Or ')'

So total strings =

$\Rightarrow 2^n$  strings

**Step 2: For Each String, Check if It Is Balanced**

To validate a string (e.g., "(()))("), we must check balance:

- Use a counter:
  - +1 for '('
  - -1 for ')'
- At any point, if counter  $< 0 \rightarrow$  invalid
- At the end, if counter  $== 0 \rightarrow$  valid

This check takes  $O(n)$  time per string.

**Hence:**

**Total Time**

- $2^n$  strings
- Each string takes  $O(n)$  time to validate

**Space Complexity:**

- $O(n)$  for recursion stack and string builder

Let's now trace the naive approach for  $n = 2$ .

☒ **Step 1: Generate All Strings of Length 2 Using '(' and ')'**

Total possible combinations =  $2^2 = 4$

All strings of length 2:

1. ((
2. ()

3. )(

4. ))



there is only one valid path= ()

☒ **Step 2: Check for Balance**

We use a **counter method**:

- +1 for '(', -1 for ')'
- If counter < 0 at any point → invalid
- At end, if counter == 0 → valid

Note: if closing bracket appears before opening its invalid pair as its not balanced paranthesis.

| String Steps             | Valid                                   |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| (( +1, +1 → 2            | No                                      |
| () +1, -1 → 0            | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Yes |
| )( -1 → invalid at start | No                                      |
| )) -1, -2 → invalid      | No                                      |

**TRACE FOR n = 4**

Generated Strings:

- ((( ( - X
- (((), (( ( - X
- (( ) - ✓
- () ( ) - ✓
- All others → invalid due to imbalance or wrong order

Total combinations: 2^4 = 16

All combinations (binary tree traversal):



### Pseudo Code Naive Approach

```
-----  
if n % 2 != 0  
    System.out.println("No valid sequences")  
    return  
creat empty arraylist result  
    generate("", n)  
    for String s : result  
        System.out.println(s)  
  
static void generate(String current, int n)  
    if current.length() == n  
        if is_valid(current)  
            result.add(current)  
        return  
    generate(current + "(", n)  
    generate(current + ")", n)  
  
static boolean is_valid(String str)  
    int count = 0  
    for int i = 0; i < str.length(); i = i + 1  
        char ch = str.charAt(i)  
        if ch == '('  
            count = count + 1  
        else  
            count = count - 1  
        if count < 0  
            return false  
    return count == 0
```

### Optimized Approach: using recursion with pruning (only generate valid strings)

- Maintain counts of how many '(' and ')' used so far.
- Only add '(' if count of '(' used < n/2.
- Only add ')' if count of ')' used < count of '(' used (to keep balance).
- This avoids generating invalid sequences altogether, improving efficiency drastically.

### Explanation:

- max = number of pairs = n/2.
- open = number of '(' used.
- close = number of ')' used.
- Recursively build string, only adding valid parentheses.

### Time Complexity:

- $O(4^n / \sqrt{n})$  – Catalan number complexity (number of balanced parentheses strings).
- Much better than naive  $O(n * 2^n)$ .

### Explanation:

- ```
-----
```
- Each balanced parentheses sequence consists of **pairs** of parentheses.
  - One **pair** is "()" which has length 2 characters.
  - If you want to generate sequences with **n pairs**, total length of the string is always  $2 \times n$  characters.

#### Why 4?

- Because there are 2 choices for each of the  $2n$  positions: total combinations =  $2^{2n} = 4^n$

The total number of balanced parentheses sequences with **n pairs** is the **nth Catalan number**:

```
ArrayList<String> result = new ArrayList

    if n % 2 != 0
        print "No valid sequences"
        return
    generate("", 0, 0, n / 2)
    for each String s in result
        print s

void generate(String current, int open, int close, int max)
    if current.length == max * 2
        result.add(current)
        return
    if open < max
        generate(current + "(", open + 1, close, max)
    if close < open
        generate(current + ")", open, close + 1, max)
```

#### Why max \* 2?

- max = number of pairs (e.g., 2 pairs means max = 2)
- Total length of balanced parentheses string = 2 \* max (because each pair has an opening and a closing bracket)

- The "backtracking" is **in the recursion itself** for this problem.
- Because strings are immutable, each recursive call has its own current state.
- After returning from recursion, the caller tries other branches without needing to undo changes explicitly.

## Magic Square

Given a matrix, check whether it's [Magic Square](#) or not. A Magic Square is a  $n \times n$  matrix of the distinct elements from 1 to  $n^2$  where the sum of any row, column, or diagonal is always equal to the same number.

### Examples:

**Input :**  $n = 3$

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
| 2 | 7 | 6 |
| 9 | 5 | 1 |
| 4 | 3 | 8 |

**Output :** Magic matrix

**Explanation:** In matrix sum of each row and each column and diagonals sum is same = 15.

Naive approach(  $O(n^2)$  )

```
-----
boolean[] seen = new boolean[n * n + 1];
for (int i = 0; i < n; i++)
    for (int j = 0; j < n; j++)
        mat[i][j] = sc.nextInt();
        if (mat[i][j] < 1 || mat[i][j] > n * n || seen[mat[i][j]])
            System.out.println("Not a Magic Matrix");
            return
        }
        seen[mat[i][j]] = true
    }
    if (isMagicSquare(mat, n))
        System.out.println("Magic matrix");
    else
        System.out.println("Not a Magic Matrix");
}

static boolean isMagicSquare(int[][] mat, int n)
{
    int sumd1 = 0, sumd2 = 0
    for (int i = 0; i < n; i++)
        sumd1 += mat[i][i]
        sumd2 += mat[i][n - 1 - i]

    if (sumd1 != sumd2)
        return false;

    for (int i = 0; i < n; i++)
        int rowSum = 0, colSum = 0;
        for (int j = 0; j < n; j++)
            rowSum += mat[i][j]
            colSum += mat[j][i]

        if (rowSum != colSum || colSum != sumd1)
            return false

    return true
}
```

## Minimum cost to convert to a Magic Square

### Problem:

Consider a 3 X 3 matrix,  $s$ , of integers in the inclusive range  $[1, 9]$ . We can convert any digit,  $a$ , to any other digit,  $b$ , in the range  $[1, 9]$  at cost  $|a - b|$ .

Given  $s$ , convert it into a magic square at minimal cost by changing zero or more of its digits. The task is to find minimum cost.

**Note:** The resulting matrix must contain distinct integers in the inclusive range  $[1, 9]$ .

Input:

```
Input : mat[][] = { { 4, 9, 2 },
                    { 3, 5, 7 },
                    { 8, 1, 5 } };
```

Output : 1

Given matrix  $s$  is not a magic square. To convert it into magic square we change the bottom right value,  $s[2][2]$ , from 5 to 6 at a cost of  $|5 - 6| = 1$ .

```
mat[][] =           { { 4, 8, 2 },
                      { 4, 5, 7 },
                      { 6, 1, 6 } };
```

Output : 4

naive Approach:

- There are **only 8 possible 3x3 magic squares** with numbers from 1 to 9.
- So, we can:
  1. Store all 8 valid magic squares.
  2. For each, compute the cost to convert the given matrix to that square.
  3. Return the minimum cost.

### Why Only 8 Magic Squares?

#### 1. Fixed sum condition:

For a 3x3 magic square with numbers 1 to 9, the sum of all numbers is:  
 $1+2+3+4+5+6+7+8+9 = 45$

2. Since there are **3 rows**, each row must sum to:  $45/3=15$

3. So each **row, column, and diagonal must sum to 15**.

4. All 9 digits are **distinct** and must be in range 1 to 9.

5. Mathematically, for 3x3 with these constraints, there's **only one base magic square**:

```
8 1 6
3 5 7
4 9 2
```

6. From this square, you can get **7 more** by applying **symmetry operations**:

- 3 rotations (90°, 180°, 270°)
- 4 reflections (horizontal, vertical, and diagonal)

These transformations **don't create new unique configurations**, just symmetric versions.

- 1 original
- 3 rotations
- 4 reflections

1+3+4=8 distinct 3×3 magic squares

Rotated 90°:

```
4 3 8
9 5 1
2 7 6
```

Rotated 180°:

```
2 9 4
7 5 3
6 1 8
```

**270° Clockwise Rotation = 90° Counter-Clockwise**

Rotating **270° clockwise** is the same as rotating **90° counter-clockwise**.

To do this:

- Take each **column from right to left**, and turn it into a row **from top to bottom**.

```
8 1 6
3 5 7
4 9 2
```

More formally:

The element at position `mat[i][j]` moves to `mat[cols - 1 - j][i]`.

```
6 7 2
1 5 9
8 3 4
```

**What do "4 reflections" mean in a 3×3 magic square?**

A **reflection** means "flipping" the matrix across some axis, like a mirror.

For a 3×3 grid, there are **4 meaningful reflections** that produce different (but valid) magic squares from the original:

☒ **Original magic square:**

```
8 1 6
3 5 7
4 9 2
```

☒ **1. Horizontal Reflection (flip top-to-bottom)**

```
4 9 2
3 5 7
8 1 6
```

☒ **2. Vertical Reflection (flip left-to-right)**

```
6 1 8
7 5 3
2 9 4
```

☒ **3. Main Diagonal Reflection (top-left to bottom-right)**

Swap `mat[i][j]` with `mat[j][i]`

```
8 3 4
1 5 9
6 7 2
```

☒ **4. Anti-diagonal Reflection (top-right to bottom-left)**

Swap `mat[i][j]` with `mat[n-1-j][n-1-i]`

```
2 7 6
```



```

9 5 1
4 3 8
8 1 6
3 5 7
4 9 2

```

```

int[][] mat = new int[3][3]

for (int i = 0; i < 3; i++)
    for (int j = 0; j < 3; j++)
        mat[i][j] = sc.nextInt()

int[][][] magic_squares = {
    { {8, 1, 6}, {3, 5, 7}, {4, 9, 2} },
    { {6, 1, 8}, {7, 5, 3}, {2, 9, 4} },
    { {4, 9, 2}, {3, 5, 7}, {8, 1, 6} },
    { {2, 9, 4}, {7, 5, 3}, {6, 1, 8} },
    { {8, 3, 4}, {1, 5, 9}, {6, 7, 2} },
    { {4, 3, 8}, {9, 5, 1}, {2, 7, 6} },
    { {6, 7, 2}, {1, 5, 9}, {8, 3, 4} },
    { {2, 7, 6}, {9, 5, 1}, {4, 3, 8} }
};

int min_cost = Integer.MAX_VALUE;

for (int[][] magic : magic_squares)
    int cost = 0;
    for (int i = 0; i < 3; i++)
        for (int j = 0; j < 3; j++)
            cost += Math.abs(mat[i][j] - magic[i][j])
    min_cost = Math.min(min_cost, cost)
}

System.out.println(min_cost)

```

We subtract to find how much adjustment is needed at each cell to reach the corresponding number in the magic square. Summing these differences gives the total cost to convert the input matrix to that magic square.

Approach Using Backtracking: ( $O(9!)$ )

- Generates all permutations of numbers 1 to 9.
- Each permutation represents a candidate 3x3 matrix (flattened as a 1D array of length 9).
- For each permutation, it checks if it forms a magic square.
- If yes, it computes the cost to convert the input matrix to this magic square.

- Keeps track of the minimal cost found so far.

#### Why 9! (factorial 9)?

- You are arranging **9 distinct numbers** (from 1 to 9) in **9 positions**.
- The number of ways to arrange  $n$  distinct elements in  $n$  positions is  $n!$  ( $n$  factorial).
- So for 9 numbers, the total number of permutations is:  
 $9! = 9 \times 8 \times 7 \times 6 \times 5 \times 4 \times 3 \times 2 \times 1 = 362,880$

#### Intuition

- For the first position, you can choose any of the 9 numbers.
- For the second position, you can choose from remaining 8 numbers.
- For the third, remaining 7 numbers, and so on...

#### So in backtracking:

- You try all 9! permutations of numbers 1 to 9.
- Each permutation forms a possible 3x3 matrix.
- You check which ones are magic squares.

At each recursion level  $idx$  (from 0 to 8), we choose one number from 1 to 9 **not yet used**.

We maintain:

- `arr[]`: the current forming permutation.
- `visited[]`: tracks what numbers are already used.

#### Example:

- $idx = 0 \rightarrow$  try 1
- $idx = 1 \rightarrow$  try 2 (since 1 visited)
- $idx = 2 \rightarrow$  try 3 (1, 2 visited)
- ...
- $idx = 8 \rightarrow$  try 9 (all others visited)

One permutation: [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9]

- The visited array ensures each number is used exactly once.
- Recursive calls explore all possible sequences.
- Backtracking unmarks numbers so they can be reused in other permutations.
- Base case triggers when all positions are filled.

Without resetting `visited[i]` to false, once a number is used, it would never be available again for other permutations, and you won't explore all possibilities.

Backtracking **restores the state to how it was before choosing that number**, so the algorithm can explore other branches.

#### Stack Pushes (recursive calls)

```
-----
idx = 0 → arr[0] = 1, visited[1] = true
  idx = 1 → arr[1] = 2, visited[2] = true
    idx = 2 → arr[2] = 3, visited[3] = true
      idx = 3 → arr[3] = 4, visited[4] = true
        idx = 4 → arr[4] = 5, visited[5] = true
          idx = 5 → arr[5] = 6, visited[6] = true
            idx = 6 → arr[6] = 7, visited[7] = true
              idx = 7 → arr[7] = 8, visited[8] = true
                idx = 8 → arr[8] = 9, visited[9] = true
                  idx = 9 → complete arr: [1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8,9]
```

#### We return to:

`idx = 8`

- `arr = [1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8]`
- `visited[9] = true, visited[8] = true`
- Now we unmark 9:

```
visited[9] = false
arr = [1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8]
```

- At this point, loop in `idx=8` has tried:
  - $i = 1$  to 8  $\rightarrow$  already visited
  - $i = 9 \rightarrow$  tried, now backtracked

→ So no new values left to try at `idx=8`, so we backtrack again.

**Backtrack to:**

`idx = 7`

- `arr = [1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8]`
- `visited[8] = true` → unvisit

`visited[8] = false`  
`arr = [1,2,3,4,5,6,7]`

Now in the loop for `idx=7`, we had:

- `i = 8` → tried before
- So next: `i = 9` → not visited

`arr[7] = 9`

`visited[9] = true`

→ `arr = [1,2,3,4,5,6,7,9]`

`permutations(arr, visited, idx + 1, input);` // i.e., `idx = 8`

→ Move to `idx = 8`

**At `idx = 8`:**

- `visited[1 to 7] = true`
- `visited[9] = true`
- `i = 1` → visited
- `i = 2` → visited

...

- `i = 8` → not visited

→ We pick:

`arr[8] = 8`

`visited[8] = true`

Now:

`arr = [1,2,3,4,5,6,7,9,8]`

**Reached base case!**

- `idx = 9` → Full permutation ready
- Check if it's a magic square
- Whether it's valid or not, we now backtrack to `idx=6` and so on and compute 9! permutations.

### Key Detail:

When backtracking, the for loop **remembers where it was**. If `i = 8` was the last tried value at `idx = 7`, then in the next iteration it tries `i = 9`.

So it doesn't skip 8 arbitrarily – it just **doesn't retry** it because it already tried `i = 8` in that position **before**

**At `idx = 7`:**

- You had already done:

`i = 8` → `arr[7] = 8` → leads to `[1..8,9]`

That was fully explored.

- After backtracking:

- `visited[8] = false`
- Loop now continues with:

`i = 9 → arr[7] = 9`

## subset sum with K print all subsets using backtracking

```
void printSubsetSum(int i, int n, int[] arr, int targetSum, List<Integer> subset)
{
    if (targetSum == 0) {
        // Print current subset
        for (int x : subset) System.out.print(x + " ");
        System.out.println();
        return;
    }
    if (i == n || targetSum < 0)
        return;

    // Not pick current element
    printSubsetSum(i + 1, n, arr, targetSum, subset);

    // Pick current element if it is <= targetSum
    if (arr[i] <= targetSum) {
        subset.add(arr[i]);
        printSubsetSum(i + 1, n, arr, targetSum - arr[i], subset);
        subset.remove(subset.size() - 1); // backtrack
    }
}
```

**subset.remove(subset.size() - 1); means:**

- Remove the **last element** added to the list subset.
- This is done **after** the recursive call returns, to **undo** the previous addition.
- It's part of **backtracking**, restoring the state so other recursive paths can try different subsets without interference.

In simpler terms:

- When you add an element to subset and explore further,
- After exploring that path, you remove that element to **go back** and try other possibilities.

**Trace with Input [1, 2, 1], sum = 3:**

- Start: i=0, targetSum=3, subset = []
- 1) At i=0 (value = 1), targetSum=3
- **Not pick 1:**
    - Call: i=1, targetSum=3, subset=[]
- 2) At i=1 (value = 2), targetSum=3
- **Not pick 2:**
    - Call: i=2, targetSum=3, subset=[]
- 3) At i=2 (value = 1), targetSum=3
- **Not pick 1:**
    - Call: i=3, targetSum=3, subset=[]
    - i == n, targetSum != 0 → return (dead end)
  - **Pick 1 (because  $1 \leq 3$ ):**
    - subset = [1]
    - targetSum = 3 - 1 = 2
    - Call: i=3, targetSum=2, subset=[1]
    - i == n, targetSum != 0 → return (dead end)
- Backtrack: subset = []

**Back to i=1 (value=2), targetSum=3**

- **Pick 2** ( $2 \leq 3$ ):
  - subset = [2]
  - targetSum =  $3 - 2 = 1$
  - Call: i=2, targetSum=1, subset=[2]

**4) At i=2 (value=1), targetSum=1**

- **Not pick 1:**
  - Call: i=3, targetSum=1, subset=[2]
  - $i == n$ , targetSum  $\neq 0 \rightarrow$  return (dead end)
- **Pick 1** ( $1 \leq 1$ ):
  - subset = [2, 1]
  - targetSum =  $1 - 1 = 0$
  - Call: i=3, targetSum=0, subset=[2,1]

Since targetSum == 0  $\rightarrow$  **print [2 1]**

Backtrack: subset = [2]

Backtrack: subset = []

**Back to i=0 (value=1), targetSum=3**

- **Pick 1** ( $1 \leq 3$ ):
  - subset = [1]
  - targetSum =  $3 - 1 = 2$
  - Call: i=1, targetSum=2, subset=[1]

**5) At i=1 (value=2), targetSum=2**

- **Not pick 2:**
  - Call: i=2, targetSum=2, subset=[1]

**6) At i=2 (value=1), targetSum=2**

- **Not pick 1:**
  - Call: i=3, targetSum=2, subset=[1]
  - $i == n$ , targetSum  $\neq 0 \rightarrow$  return (dead end)
- **Pick 1** ( $1 \leq 2$ ):
  - subset = [1, 1]
  - targetSum =  $2 - 1 = 1$
  - Call: i=3, targetSum=1, subset=[1,1]
  - $i == n$ , targetSum  $\neq 0 \rightarrow$  return (dead end)

Backtrack: subset = [1]

- **Pick 2** ( $2 \leq 2$ ):
  - subset = [1, 2]
  - targetSum =  $2 - 2 = 0$
  - Call: i=2, targetSum=0, subset=[1,2]

Since targetSum == 0  $\rightarrow$  **print [1 2]**

Backtrack: subset = [1]

Backtrack: subset = []

**Output subsets for sum = 3:**

- [2 1]
- [1 2]

## print all subsets backtracking 1

**Problem:** Print all valid subsets of a given array.

Input:

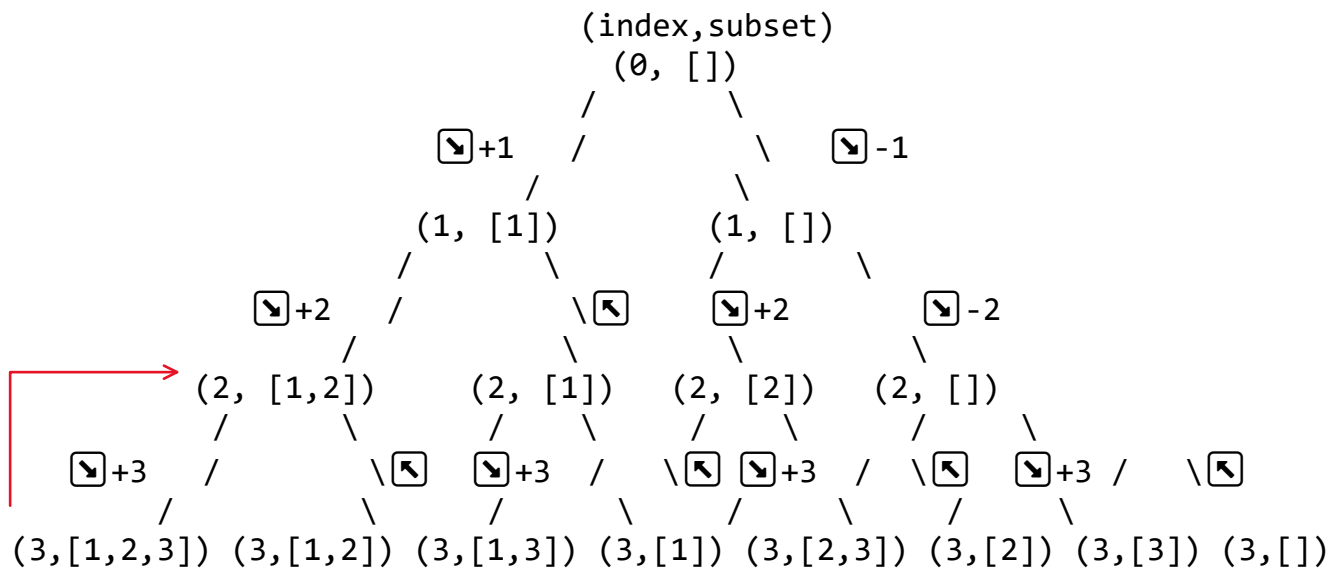
Output:

Naive Approach:

Optimized Approach:

| Call Stack Level | index | subset (current) | Action                                 | Next calls                                          |
|------------------|-------|------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 0                | 0     | []               | Include nums[0] = 1                    | Call generateSubsets(nums,1,[1])                    |
| 1                | 1     | [1]              | Include nums[1] = 2                    | Call generateSubsets(nums,2,[1,2])                  |
| 2                | 2     | [1,2]            | Include nums[2] = 3                    | Call generateSubsets(nums,3,[1,2,3])                |
| 3                | 3     | [1,2,3]          | index == nums.length → print [1, 2, 3] | Return                                              |
| 2 (backtrack)    | 2     | [1,2,3]          | Remove last: 3 → subset = [1,2]        | Exclude nums[2], call generateSubsets(nums,3,[1,2]) |
| 3                | 3     | [1,2]            | index == nums.length → print [1, 2]    | Return                                              |
| 1 (backtrack)    | 1     | [1,2]            | Remove last: 2 → subset = [1]          | Exclude nums[1], call generateSubsets(nums,2,[1])   |
| 2                | 2     | [1]              | Include nums[2] = 3                    | Call generateSubsets(nums,3,[1,3])                  |
| 3                | 3     | [1,3]            | index == nums.length → print [1, 3]    | Return                                              |
| 2 (backtrack)    | 2     | [1,3]            | Remove last: 3 → subset = [1]          | Exclude nums[2], call generateSubsets(nums,3,[1])   |
| 3                | 3     | [1]              | index == nums.length → print [1]       | Return                                              |
| 0 (backtrack)    | 0     | [1]              | Remove last: 1 → subset = []           | Exclude nums[0], call generateSubsets(nums,1,[])    |
| 1                | 1     | []               | Include nums[1] = 2                    | Call generateSubsets(nums,2,[2])                    |
| 2                | 2     | [2]              | Include nums[2] = 3                    | Call generateSubsets(nums,3,[2,3])                  |
| 3                | 3     | [2,3]            | index == nums.length → print [2, 3]    | Return                                              |
| 2 (backtrack)    | 2     | [2,3]            | Remove last: 3 → subset = [2]          | Exclude nums[2], call generateSubsets(nums,3,[2])   |
| 3                | 3     | [2]              | index == nums.length → print [2]       | Return                                              |
| 1 (backtrack)    | 1     | [2]              | Remove last: 2 → subset = []           | Exclude nums[1], call generateSubsets(nums,2,[])    |
| 2                | 2     | []               | Include nums[2] = 3                    | Call generateSubsets(nums,3,[3])                    |

|               |   |     |                                  |                                                  |
|---------------|---|-----|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| 3             | 3 | [3] | index == nums.length → print [3] | Return                                           |
| 2 (backtrack) | 2 | [3] | Remove last: 3 → subset = []     | Exclude nums[2], call generateSubsets(nums,3,[]) |
| 3             | 3 | []  | index == nums.length → print []  | Return                                           |



- **+1, +2, +3** → means we **included** the next number (e.g., included 1, 2, or 3).
- **-1, -2, -3** → means we **excluded** the number at that step.
- **↩** → the stack **returns** from that recursive call to explore other possibilities (backtracking).

Call Stack:

```

generateSubsets([1,2,3], 0, [])
|
├── include 1 → [1]
│   └── generateSubsets([1,2,3], 1, [1])
│       ├── include 2 → [1,2]
│       │   └── generateSubsets([1,2,3], 2, [1,2])
│       │       ├── include 3 → [1,2,3]
│       │       │   └── generateSubsets([1,2,3], 3, [1,2,3])
│       │       │       └── index == 3 → print [1,2,3]
│       │       └── (backtrack)
│       └── (backtrack)
└── (backtrack)

```

So now:

We hit base case index == nums.length

Print [1,2,3]

Function returns to previous level

↩ **BACKTRACKING: LEVEL 2**  
 We go one level up, where:  
 index = 2



```
subset = [1, 2, 3]
```

Now we execute:

```
subset.remove(subset.size() - 1);
```

Now subset becomes: [1, 2]

And now we move to:

```
generateSubsets(nums, 3, subset); // Option 2: exclude nums[2]
```

So now call becomes:

```
generateSubsets([1,2,3], 3, [1,2]) again base case reached
```

```
→ print [1,2]
```

**Backtrack to Index = 1, Subset = [1,2]**

We go one level up:

**We were at:**

```
generateSubsets([1,2,3], 2, [1,2])
```

Now, we **backtrack** by removing 2:

```
subset = [1]
```

Now we're back at:

```
generateSubsets([1,2,3], 1, [1])
```

- Include 2 → [1,2] → explored fully ☑

Now try:

► **Exclude 2**

```
generateSubsets([1,2,3], 2, [1])
```

**Now at Index = 2, Subset = [1]**

- Include 3 → [1,3] → generateSubsets(3, [1,3]) → print ☑
- Backtrack → subset = [1]
- Exclude 3 → generateSubsets(3, [1]) → print [1] ☑

```
call generateSubsets(nums, 0, subset)
```

```
static void generateSubsets(int[] nums, int index, List<Integer> subset)
    if (index == nums.length) {
        System.out.println(subset);
        return;
```

```
// Option 1: Include nums[index]
```

```
subset.add(nums[index]);
```

```
generateSubsets(nums, index + 1, subset);
```

```
// Backtrack: Remove last added element
```

```
subset.remove(subset.size() - 1);
```

```
// Option 2: explore further options
```

```
generateSubsets(nums, index + 1, subset);
```

Print all subsets in the  
lexicographical order 2

### Problem:

Input:

3

arr = [2, 1, 3]

Output:

[], [1], [1, 2], [1, 2, 3], [1, 3], [2], [2, 3],[3]

- Read input array arr of size n from user.
- Sort the array arr to ensure subsets are in lexicographical order.
- Initialize:
  - ans: list to store all subsets.
  - temp: temporary list to build each subset.
- Call generate(idx = 0, temp = []) to start recursive generation.
- Inside generate(idx, temp):
  - Add current subset temp to ans.
  - Loop from i = idx to n - 1:
    - Add arr[i] to temp.
    - Recurse: generate(i + 1, temp)
    - Backtrack: remove last element from temp list.

For each subset in ans:

Print a left square bracket [

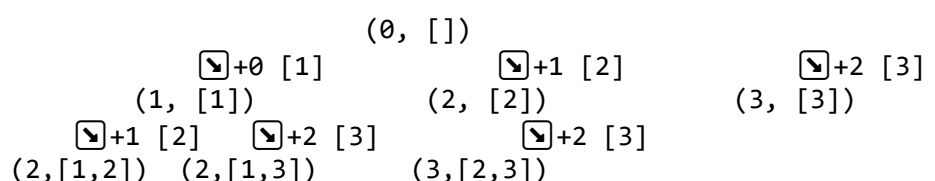
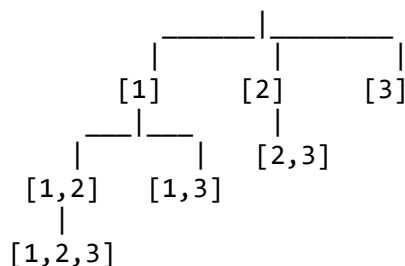
Iterate through each element of the current subset:

Print the element

If it is **not the last element**, print a comma followed by a space

After printing all elements of a subset, print the right bracket ] and move to the next line

[ ]



$\boxed{\text{ans}} + 2 \text{ [3]}$   
 (3, [1, 2, 3])

| Call | Stack Level | idx | temp      | Action Taken         | Next Calls (i from idx) |
|------|-------------|-----|-----------|----------------------|-------------------------|
| 0    |             | 0   | []        | Add [] to ans        | i=0 → Add 1             |
| 1    |             | 1   | [1]       | Add [1] to ans       | i=1 → Add 2             |
| 2    |             | 2   | [1, 2]    | Add [1, 2] to ans    | i=2 → Add 3             |
| 3    |             | 3   | [1, 2, 3] | Add [1, 2, 3] to ans | i=3 ends → backtrack 3  |
| 2    |             | 2   | [1, 2]    | Remove 3 from temp   | i=2 ends → backtrack 2  |
| 1    |             | 1   | [1]       | Remove 2 from temp   | i=2 → Add 3             |
| 2    |             | 3   | [1, 3]    | Add [1, 3] to ans    | i=3 ends → backtrack 3  |
| 1    |             | 1   | [1]       | Remove 3 from temp   | i=2 ends → backtrack 1  |
| 0    |             | 0   | []        | Remove 1 from temp   | i=1 → Add 2             |
| 1    |             | 2   | [2]       | Add [2] to ans       | i=2 → Add 3             |
| 2    |             | 3   | [2, 3]    | Add [2, 3] to ans    | i=3 ends → backtrack 3  |
| 1    |             | 2   | [2]       | Remove 3 from temp   | i=2 ends → backtrack 2  |
| 0    |             | 0   | []        | Remove 2 from temp   | i=2 → Add 3             |
| 1    |             | 3   | [3]       | Add [3] to ans       | i=3 ends → backtrack 3  |
| 0    |             | 0   | []        | Remove 3 from temp   | Loop ends, done         |

## Print all valid String partitions Backtracking 3

Print all valid partitions of a string `s` using a given dictionary  
Given:

- String: `s`
- Dictionary: `wordDict`

Task: Print all ways to split `s` into dictionary words such that the entire string is used and every substring in the partition exists in the dictionary.

Input

pineapplepenapple

5

apple

pen

applepen

pine

pineapple

Output

pine apple pen apple

pineapple pen apple

pine applepen apple

```
s = "pineapplepenapple"
```

```
dict = ["apple", "pen", "applepen", "pine", "pineapple"]
```

We are calling:

```
backtrack("pineapplepenapple", 0, dict, [])
```

We'll build the string from `start = 0`, and at each step we check every substring `s[start:end]` and recurse when it's a valid dictionary word.

Step-by-step Trace:

At `start = 0`:

Check substrings:

`s[0:1] = "p" → ✗`

...

`s[0:4] = "pine" → ☑`

→ Add "pine" to path → `path = ["pine"]`

At `start = 4`:

Check substrings:

`s[4:5] = "a" → ✗`

...

s[4:9] = "apple" → ☒

→ Add "apple" to path → path = ["pine", "apple"]

At start = 9:

Check substrings:

s[9:12] = "pen" → ☒

→ Add "pen" to path → path = ["pine", "apple", "pen"]

At start = 12:

Check substrings:

s[12:17] = "apple" → ☒

→ Add "apple" to path → path = ["pine", "apple", "pen", "apple"]

✓ Reached end → start == s.length()

☒ Output this partition:

text

Copy

Edit

pine apple pen apple

Now backtrack:

Remove last: "apple" → ["pine", "apple", "pen"]

No more substrings at start=12, backtrack

Remove "pen" → ["pine", "apple"]

Back to start = 9, try more:

s[9:14] = "pena" ✗

...

Done → backtrack

Backtrack again to ["pine"] and start = 4, now try:

s[4:12] = "applepen" → ☒

→ Add "applepen" → ["pine", "applepen"]

At start = 12:

s[12:17] = "apple" → ☒

→ Add "apple" → ["pine", "applepen", "apple"]

✓ Reached end → print:

pine applepen apple

Backtrack → remove "apple" → ["pine", "applepen"]

→ No more substrings → remove "applepen" → ["pine"]

Backtrack to start = 0, try:

s[0:9] = "pineapple" → ☒

→ Add "pineapple" → ["pineapple"]

At start = 9:

s[9:12] = "pen" → ☒

→ Add "pen" → ["pineapple", "pen"]

At start = 12:

s[12:17] = "apple" → ☒

→ Add "apple" → ["pineapple", "pen", "apple"]

✓ Print:

text

Copy

Edit

pineapple pen apple

☒ Final Output (3 Ways)

nginx

Copy

Edit

pine apple pen apple

pine applepen apple

pineapple pen apple

## N Queens Problem

Given an integer  $n$ , the task is to find the solution to the **n-queens problem**, where  $n$  queens are placed on an  $n \times n$  chessboard such that no two queens can attack each other.

The N Queen is the problem of placing N chess queens on an  $N \times N$  chessboard so that no two queens attack each other.

In N-Queens, this means:

1. They lie on the same row
  2. They lie on the same column
  3. They lie on the same diagonal
- There are two types of diagonals:
- Main diagonal
  - Anti-diagonal

$n = 4$

Output=

```
. Q . .  
. . . Q  
Q . . .  
. . Q .
```

### APPROACH 1: Naive Backtracking

Idea:

-----

Try placing queens row by row and for every row, try all columns. Check for safety by scanning the board.

Time Complexity:  $O(N!)$

(Each row has N options, then N-1, then N-2, ...  $\rightarrow N!$ )

Space Complexity:  $O(N^2)$  (Board matrix)

[N-Queens Problem | using Backtracking | Leetcode Hard](#)

#45

N



QUEENS

Backtracking Problem

✓

Approach

✓

Code

✓

Complexity





# Intro to DP

19 May 2025 16:27

Dynamic programming has two main approaches: top-down (memoization) and bottom-up (tabulation). These methods solve problems by storing and reusing solutions to overlapping subproblems, but they differ in how they approach the problem.

## 1. Top-Down (Memoization):

- This approach is also known as "recursive dynamic programming".
- It starts with the main problem and recursively breaks it down into smaller subproblems.
- It stores the solutions to these subproblems in a cache (like array) to avoid recalculating them.
- It checks if the result for a subproblem is already in the cache before solving it recursively.

## 2. Bottom-Up (Tabulation):

- This approach is also known as "iterative dynamic programming".
- It starts with the base cases and builds the solution iteratively, working its way up to the main problem.
- It uses a table to store the solutions to subproblems, filling it in a systematic way.
- It calculates the solution to larger problems based on the solutions to smaller problems already stored in the table.

Explain Rod cutting problem for both approaches before subset with sum k.

**Top-Down** Recursive +  
Memoization

Start from the final problem, solve  
smaller

**Bottom-Up** Iterative +  
Tabulation

Start from base cases, build up to  
answer

## 0/1 knapsack problem using DP memoization top down

24 May 2025 11:19

### What Happens in Recursion?

In recursive or top-down approaches:

- The order of subproblem solving is dynamic, controlled by the call stack.
- A subproblem is solved only when it's needed (lazy evaluation).
- Memoization helps avoid recomputation, but you don't control which subproblems get solved first.

This can sometimes lead to:

- Deep recursion (stack overflow)
- Harder debugging and tracing
- Unpredictable order of execution

### Dynamic Programming (Top-Down or Bottom-Up)

#### ▶ How it works:

- DP approach **stores** solutions to subproblems (in a `dp[n][W]` table)
- If a subproblem is already solved, just **return** the stored result (memoization)

#### ☑ Efficiency:

- **No redundant calls**
- Fills only each unique  $(n, W)$  state once

| Approach        | Time Complexity | Space Complexity    |
|-----------------|-----------------|---------------------|
| Recursion       | $O(2^n)$        | $O(n)$ (call stack) |
| Top-Down DP     | $O(n * W)$      | $O(n * W)$          |
| Bottom-Up DP    | $O(n * W)$      | $O(n * W)$          |
| Space Optimized | $O(n * W)$      | $O(W)$              |

Both recursive approach and DP versions have the **same recursive structure**.  
**BUT**, the DP version **remembers the answer** for  $(n, W)$  and reuses it.

### Why It Matters

Let's say:

- You call `knapsack(3, 4)`
- It internally calls `knapsack(2, 3)` and `knapsack(2, 4)`
- Without memoization: these may both call `knapsack(1, 3)` → redundant
- With memoization: `knapsack(1, 3)` is solved once and reused

#### Approach

-----

`dp[i][w]` = max value using items  $0 \dots i$  with remaining capacity  $w$

function:

```
knapsack(int n, int W, int[] wt, int[] val, int[][] dp)

    if(n == 0 || W == 0)
        return 0
```

```

if(dp[n][W] != -1)
    return dp[n][W]
if(wt[n - 1] > W)
    dp[n][W] = knapsack(n - 1, W, wt, val, dp);
else {
    int include = val[n - 1] + knapsack(n - 1, W - wt[n - 1], wt, val, dp)
    int exclude = knapsack(n - 1, W, wt, val, dp);
    dp[n][W] = Math.max(include, exclude);
}
return dp[n][W]

```

```

n = 3
w = 5
wt = [1, 2, 3]
val = [10, 15, 40]

```

We want  $dp[2][5] \rightarrow$  max value with first 3 items and capacity 5.

1. Try including item 2 (wt=3):  $val[2] + dp[1][2] = 40 + dp[1][2]$

2. Try excluding item 2:  $dp[1][5]$

Continue evaluating  $dp[1][2]$ ,  $dp[1][5]$ , ... and so on recursively.

# Climbing Stairs to reach to the top

24 May 2025 09:21

# Count ways to reach the nth stair using step 1, 2 or 3

24 May 2025 09:22

## knapsack Space Optimized DP

24 May 2025 13:12

### Why Optimize?

In the 2D DP table  $dp[i][j]$ , each row  $i$  depends **only on the previous row  $i-1$** . So we can reduce the space from  $O(n * W) \rightarrow O(W)$  using a 1D array.

In the **0/1 Knapsack problem**, we use a 2D DP table  $dp[i][j]$ :

- $i$  = index of item.
- $j$  = capacity from 0 to  $W$ .

### Observation:

- $dp[i][j]$  depends **only on row  $i-1$**  (i.e., previous row).
- So, at any point, to compute  $dp[i][j]$ , only  $dp[i-1][...]$  values are required.

When updating  $dp[j]$ , we don't want to reuse the **updated  $dp[j - wt[i]]$**  from the same iteration.

**When we go backward ( $j = W$  to  $0$ ):**

- $dp[j - weight[i]]$  has **not been updated yet** in this iteration.
- It still holds the value **from previous item ( $i-1$ )** – exactly what we want.

$dp = [0 \ 0 \ 0 \ 0 \ 0 \ 0]$

Now loop  $j = 5$  to  $3$ :

$dp[5] = \max(0, 2 + dp[2]) \rightarrow dp[5] = 2$

$dp[4] = \max(0, 2 + dp[1]) \rightarrow dp[4] = 2$

$dp[3] = \max(0, 2 + dp[0]) \rightarrow dp[3] = 2$

At each step:

- $dp[j - weight[i]]$  is still the **old value** (from previous state).
- We **don't touch**  $dp[2]$ ,  $dp[1]$ , or  $dp[0]$  until after they're read.

Each item can be included **only once**.

So when computing  $dp[j]$ , it must depend on the values **before including the current item**.

### ☒ Scenario: Why Reverse Loop?

Let's walk through a **concrete example** and compare **forward vs reverse iteration**.

**Example:**

Items:  $wt = [2]$ ,  $val = [5]$

Capacity = 4

We'll build the  $dp$  array of size 5 (0 to 4).

**WRONG: Forward Iteration ( $j = 0$  to  $W$ )**

```
for(int j = 0; j <= w; j++) {
    if(j >= wt[i]) {
        dp[j] = Math.max(dp[j], val[i] + dp[j - wt[i]]);
    }
}
```

**Let's simulate:**

- Initially:  $dp = [0, 0, 0, 0, 0]$
- Process item  $wt = 2$ ,  $val = 5$

### Forward update:

$j = 2 \rightarrow dp[2] = \max(0, 5 + dp[0]) = 5 \quad \rightarrow dp[2] = 5$   
 $j = 3 \rightarrow dp[3] = \max(0, 5 + dp[1]) = 5 \quad \rightarrow dp[3] = 5$   
 $j = 4 \rightarrow dp[4] = \max(0, 5 + dp[2]) = 10 \quad \rightarrow \text{X wrong!}$

### Problem:

- $dp[4]$  is using  $dp[2] = 5$ , which was **just updated this round** (for this item).
- This means it's **using the same item more than once**, which is invalid in 0/1 Knapsack.

### ☒ CORRECT: Reverse Iteration ( $j = W$ to $0$ )

```
for(int j = w; j >= wt[i]; j--) {  
    dp[j] = Math.max(dp[j], val[i] + dp[j - wt[i]]);  
}
```

### Let's simulate the correct version:

- Initially:  $dp = [0, 0, 0, 0, 0]$

### Reverse update:

- $j = 4 \rightarrow dp[4] = \max(0, 5 + dp[2]) = 0 + 5 = 5$
- $j = 3 \rightarrow dp[3] = \max(0, 5 + dp[1]) = 0 + 5 = 5$
- $j = 2 \rightarrow dp[2] = \max(0, 5 + dp[0]) = 5$

Final  $dp = [0, 0, 5, 5, 5]$

☒ Now we used each item **only once**, and  $dp[4]$  uses  $dp[2]$  from **previous state** – not the one updated this round.

Idea:

Why  $j \geq \text{weight}[i]$ ?

Because:

- We can **only pick** item  $i$  if the **remaining capacity  $j$  is at least  $\text{weight}[i]$** .
- Otherwise, the item **won't fit** in the knapsack.

$n = 4$

$W = 8$

$\text{profit}[] = \{2, 3, 4, 1\}$

$\text{weight}[] = \{3, 4, 5, 6\}$

```
int[] dp = new int[W + 1]  
  
for(int i = 0; i < n; i++)  
    for(int j = W; j >= weight[i]; j--)  
        dp[j] = Math.max(dp[j], profit[i] + dp[j - weight[i]]);
```

$dp = [0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0]$

After Item 1 (profit = 2, weight = 3)

$j = 8$  to  $3 \rightarrow dp[j] = \max(dp[j], 2 + dp[j - 3])$

$dp[8] = \max(0, 2 + dp[5]) = 2$

```
dp[7] = max(0, 2 + dp[4]) = 2
dp[6] = max(0, 2 + dp[3]) = 2
dp[5] = max(0, 2 + dp[2]) = 2
dp[4] = max(0, 2 + dp[1]) = 2
dp[3] = max(0, 2 + dp[0]) = 2
```

```
dp = [0, 0, 0, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2]
```

```
After Item 2 (profit = 3, weight = 4)
j = 8 to 4 → dp[j] = max(dp[j], 3 + dp[j - 4])
dp[8] = max(2, 3 + dp[4]) = max(2, 3 + 2) = 5
dp[7] = max(2, 3 + dp[3]) = max(2, 3 + 2) = 5
dp[6] = max(2, 3 + dp[2]) = max(2, 3 + 0) = 3
dp[5] = max(2, 3 + dp[1]) = 3
dp[4] = max(2, 3 + dp[0]) = 3
dp = [0, 0, 0, 2, 3, 3, 3, 5, 5]
```

```
After Item 3 (profit = 4, weight = 5)
j = 8 to 5 → dp[j] = max(dp[j], 4 + dp[j - 5])
dp[8] = max(5, 4 + dp[3]) = max(5, 6) = 6
dp[7] = max(5, 4 + dp[2]) = 5
dp[6] = max(3, 4 + dp[1]) = 4
dp[5] = max(3, 4 + dp[0]) = 4
dp = [0, 0, 0, 2, 3, 4, 4, 5, 6]
```

```
After Item 4 (profit = 1, weight = 6)
j = 8 to 6 → dp[j] = max(dp[j], 1 + dp[j - 6])
dp[8] = max(6, 1 + dp[2]) = max(6, 1) = 6
dp[7] = max(5, 1 + dp[1]) = 5
dp[6] = max(4, 1 + dp[0]) = 4
```

```
dp = [0, 0, 0, 2, 3, 4, 4, 5, 6]
```

```
Final Answer: dp[8] = 6
```



## knapsack using Tabulation bottom up DP

24 May 2025 13:13

### Top-down (memoized recursion):

You only solve what's needed:

`solve(0, W) → solve(1, W), solve(1, W - wt[0]), .`

### What Happens in Tabulation?

In **tabulation (bottom-up)**:

- You solve all subproblems in a **fixed, predetermined order**.
- You **build the solution step by step**, from the smallest subproblems to the biggest.
- You can **observe and control** how values evolve in the `dp[][]` table.

This gives:

- Better predictability
- Easier tracing/debugging
- Efficient space optimization (1D arrays)
- No risk of stack overflow

### Bottom-up:

```
t
for i = 0 to n:
    for j = 0 to W:
        dp[i][j] = ...
```

You **explicitly control** the order: row-by-row, left-to-right (or right-to-left in space optimization).

### Tabulation = Iterative Bottom-Up

- You fill a **dp table iteratively**, solving smaller subproblems first.
- You know exactly **which previous values** are needed to compute the current value.

Because of this controlled flow:

- You can **identify redundancy**
- You can determine if **earlier rows** of the table can be reused

### Why Tabulation Helps Space Optimization

Let's use **0/1 Knapsack** as an example.

**In Full Tabulation:**

```
int[][] dp = new int[n+1][W+1];
```

- Time:  $O(nW)$
- Space:  $O(nW)$

Each `dp[i][j]` depends only on:

```
dp[i-1][j]           // exclude
dp[i-1][j - wt[i]]    // include
```

So only **row i-1** is needed. This insight comes **because tabulation exposes dependencies explicitly**.  
From this, we **optimize**:

```
int[] dp = new int[W+1];
```

We reuse the same row (backwards traversal), maintaining correctness.

**This space optimization is only possible because tabulation clearly shows the subproblem dependency direction.**

### Bottom-Up DP (Tabulation) – Key Idea

We use a  $dp[n+1][W+1]$  table where:

- $dp[i][j]$  = maximum profit using first  $i$  items and capacity  $j$

For every item  $i$  and capacity  $j$ :

- **If the item's weight is more than capacity  $j$ , we can't pick it**  
 $dp[i][j] = dp[i-1][j]$
  - **Else, we have 2 choices:**
    - **Include it:**  $profit = profit[i-1] + dp[i-1][j - weight[i-1]]$
    - **Exclude it:**  $profit = dp[i-1][j]$
- Take maximum:  
 $dp[i][j] = \max(dp[i-1][j], profit[i-1] + dp[i-1][j - weight[i-1]])$

### Initialization

- If  $i == 0$  or  $j == 0$ , then  $dp[i][j] = 0$   
(0 items or 0 capacity  $\Rightarrow$  0 profit)

### Final Answer

- The value at  $dp[n][W]$  contains the **maximum profit**

### Example

$W = 4$

$profit = [1, 2, 3]$

$weight = [4, 5, 1]$

### Time and Space Complexity

- **Time:**  $O(n * W) \rightarrow$  loop over all items and capacities
- **Space:**  $O(n * W)$  for full 2D table

If you **include** the  $i$ -th item, then:

- You gain its profit:  $profit[i - 1]$
- But you reduce available capacity by  $weight[i - 1]$
- So now, you can only get additional profit from the remaining capacity

So, the **total profit if you include this item** is:

$profit[i - 1] + profit\_from\_remaining\_capacity$

Which is:

$profit[i - 1] + dp[i - 1][j - weight[i - 1]]$

## Min absolute difference of 2 subsets

27 May 2025 15:21

Given an array `arr[]`:

- Divide into two subsets `S1` and `S2`
- Goal: Minimize  $|\text{sum}(S1) - \text{sum}(S2)|$

Let:

- `total_sum` = sum of all array elements
- `sum1` = `sum(S1)`
- `sum2` = `sum(S2)` = `total_sum - sum1`

$$|\text{sum1} - \text{sum2}| = |\text{sum1} - (\text{total\_sum} - \text{sum1})| = |2 * \text{sum1} - \text{total\_sum}|$$

We want to minimize  $|2 * \text{sum1} - \text{total\_sum}|$

So, for minimum absolute difference:

So the problem becomes:

Find a subset sum `sum1` as close as possible to `total / 2`.

Example:

`arr = [1, 6, 11, 5]`

`total_sum = 23`

We want `sum1` as close to 11.5 as possible.

If we pick:

- `sum1 = 11` → `sum2 = 12` → difference = 1
- `sum1 = 12` → `sum2 = 11` → difference = 1
- `sum1 = 10` → `sum2 = 13` → difference = 3
- `sum1 = 9` → `sum2 = 14` → difference = 5

Only around 11.5 is the minimum difference achieved

### Final Logic

Use 1D DP to find all subset sums  $\leq 11$

Then find the maximum  $j \leq 11$  such that `dp[j] = true`

- We loop from `target = total_sum / 2` down to 0
- First `j` such that `dp[j] == true` gives closest possible subset sum
- `dp[j] = true` means: it is possible to form a subset sum equal to `j`.
  - using some elements of the array
- We call this value `s1`, and `s2 = total_sum - s1`
- Then difference =  $|s1 - s2|$

This guarantees minimum absolute difference

We need to partition the array such that the sum of one subset (`sum1`) is as close as possible to `total_sum / 2`.

$$|2 * \text{sum1} - 23|$$

Try a few values:

| sum1 | 2sum1 | 2sum1 - 23 |   |
|------|-------|------------|---|
| 0    | 0     | 23         |   |
| 6    | 12    | 11         |   |
| 11   | 22    | 1          | ✓ |
| 12   | 24    | 1          | ✓ |
| 13   | 26    | 3          |   |

You can see minimum difference at sum1 = 11 or 12

```
arr = [1, 6, 11, 5]
total = 23, target = 11
```

After DP filling:

```
dp[11] = true
dp[10] = false
dp[9] = false
dp[8] = true
...
→ s1 = 11
→ Compute diff = 23 - 2 * 11 = 1
{1, 6, 5} and {11} → diff = 1
```

```
arr = [1, 3, 5]
n = 3
total = 9
target = total / 2 = 4 (we will use this as upper bound in dp)
boolean[] dp = new boolean[5]; // 0 to 4
dp[0] = true; // subset sum of 0 is always possible (empty set)
dp = [T, F, F, F, F] → We can make only sum 0 at the start
    0  1  2  3  4
```

**Now process arr[0] = 1**

We update in reverse:

```
for (j = 4 to 1):
    dp[j] = dp[j] || dp[j - 1]
→ j = 1: dp[1] = dp[1] || dp[0] = F || T = T
Updated:
```

```
dp = [T, T, F, F, F]
```

This means:

- ✓ We can now make **sum 1** (using element 1)

**Process arr[1] = 3**

For j = 4 to 3:

```
→ j = 4: dp[4] = dp[4] || dp[1] = F || T = T
→ j = 3: dp[3] = dp[3] || dp[0] = F || T = T
```

Updated:

dp = [T, T, F, T, T]

This means:

- ☒ We can now make:
  - sum 3: using only 3
  - sum 4: using 1 + 3

**Process arr[2] = 5**

We skip it since our target is 4 (and  $5 > 4$ )

☒ **Final dp array:**

dp = [T, T, F, T, T]  
      0  1  2  3  4

☒ **Justifying:**

**dp[j] = true  $\Rightarrow$  There exists a subset with sum j**

**j    dp[j] Possible Subset**

0    true  $\emptyset$  (empty set)

1    true [1]

2    false –

3    true [3]

4    true [1, 3]

## Min fib terms to sum upto K

30 May 2025 12:07

1. Create DP array  $dp[0...k]$
2. Set  $dp[0] = 0$  (0 terms needed to make sum 0)
3. For every  $i$  from 1 to  $k$ :
  - For every Fibonacci number  $f \leq i$ :
    - Update  $dp[i] = \min(dp[i], 1 + dp[i - f])$
4. Return  $dp[k]$

$k = 7$

Fibonacci numbers: [1, 2, 3, 5]

Let's fill  $dp[0...7]$

| $i$ | $f \leq i$                                         | Best $dp[i]$ |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| 0   | —                                                  | 0            |
| 1   | $1 \rightarrow dp[0]+1 = 1$                        | 1            |
| 2   | $1 \rightarrow dp[1]+1=2, 2 \rightarrow dp[0]+1=1$ | 1            |
| 3   | $1+dp[2]=2, 2+dp[1]=2, 3+dp[0]=1$                  | 1            |
| 4   | $1+dp[3]=2, 2+dp[2]=2, 3+dp[1]=2$                  | 2            |
| 5   | $1+dp[4]=3, 2+dp[3]=2, 3+dp[2]=2, 5+dp[0]=1$       | 1            |
| 6   | $1+dp[5]=2, 2+dp[4]=3, 3+dp[3]=2, 5+dp[1]=2$       | 2            |
| 7   | $1+dp[6]=3, 2+dp[5]=2, 3+dp[4]=3, 5+dp[2]=2$       | 2            |

$\rightarrow dp[7] = 2$  is final answer.

Time  $O(k \times f)$  ( $f = \text{fib nums} \leq k$ )

Space  $O(k)$

## Climbing Stairs (with order)

02 June 2025 10:44

You are climbing a staircase. It takes  $n$  steps to reach the top.  
Each time you can either climb **1 or 2 steps**.  
**Find the number of distinct ways** you can climb to the top.

Input=5  
output=8

Explanation:

All combinations of 1-step and 2-steps:

1. 1+1+1+1+1
2. 1+1+1+2
3. 1+1+2+1
4. 1+2+1+1
5. 2+1+1+1
6. 1+2+2
7. 2+1+2
8. 2+2+1

Total = **8 ways**

Input:  $n = 3$

Output: 3

Explanation:

1. 1+1+1
2. 1+2
3. 2+1

Total= **3 ways**

You are at step 0 and need to reach step  $n$ .

At each move, you can:

- Climb **1 step**, or
- Climb **2 steps**

You need to compute the **total number of distinct sequences** of such moves to reach step  $n$ .

### Approach 1: Naïve Recursive

**Idea:** Try both options (1 or 2 steps) from current step.

We define a function  $f(n)$  = number of ways to reach the top from step 0 to  $n$ .

At any step  $n$ , the last move could be:

- A 1-step from  $n-1$ , or
- A 2-step from  $n-2$

So,

$$f(n) = f(n - 1) + f(n - 2)$$

This is exactly the **Fibonacci recurrence**.

- $f(0) = 1$ : 1 way to stay at step 0 (do nothing)
- $f(1) = 1$ : 1 way to climb 1 step (just one 1-step move)

Recursion  $O(2^n)$   $O(n)$

DP with Array  $O(n)$   $O(n)$

Optimized DP  $O(n)$   $O(1)$

DP top down

-----  
**Algorithm:**

- Define count\_ways(n) which returns number of ways to climb n steps.
- If n == 0 or 1, return 1.
- If memo[n] already computed, return it.
- Else, compute count\_ways(n-1) + count\_ways(n-2) and store in memo[n].

**Time and Space:**

- Time:  $O(n)$
- Space:  $O(n)$  for recursion stack +  $O(n)$  for memo array

```
memo = new int[n + 1]
Arrays.fill(memo, -1)
```

```
    if (n == 0 || n == 1)
        return 1
    if (memo[n] != -1)
        return memo[n]
    memo[n] = count_ways(n - 1) + count_ways(n - 2);
    return memo[n]
}
```

Dp bottom up

-----

- Create dp array of size n + 1.
- Set dp[0] = 1, dp[1] = 1.
- For each i from 2 to n, dp[i] = dp[i-1] + dp[i-2].
- Return dp[n].

**Time and Space:**

- Time:  $O(n)$
- Space:  $O(n)$

```
int n = sc.nextInt();
int[] dp = new int[n + 1]
dp[0] = 1
dp[1] = 1
for (int i = 2; i <= n; i++) {
    dp[i] = dp[i - 1] + dp[i - 2]
}
System.out.println(dp[n])
}
```

Optimized dp using 2 variables

-----

```
int n = sc.nextInt()
int prev = 1, curr = 1
for (int i = 2; i <= n; i++) {
    int temp = curr
    curr = curr + prev
    prev = temp
}
System.out.println(curr)
```

### Using Mathematical Formula - $O(1)$ Time and $O(1)$ Space

The basic idea is that we can first try to reach the nth stair using as many steps of size 2 as possible. So, if n is even we can reach nth stair by using ( $s = n/2$ ) steps of size 2 else if n is odd, we can reach ( $s = n/2$ ) steps of size 2 and 1 step of size 1. Now, for every subsequent way we can break the steps of size 2 into two steps of size 1.



## Climbing stairs order doesn't matter

02 June 2025 11:50

You want to know **how many ways to reach the top** with steps of size 1 or 2.

- **Example:** For  $n=3$ , these are the ways:

$1 + 1 + 1$

$1 + 2$

$2 + 1$

- Here,  $1 + 2$  and  $2 + 1$  are **different** ways because order is different.
- The count for  $n=3$  is 3.

### Order does not matter (combinations)

For the same  $n=3$ , combinations are:

$1 + 1 + 1$

$1 + 2$

- Here,  $1 + 2$  and  $2 + 1$  are considered the **same** because order is ignored.
- The count for  $n=3$  is 2.

for  $n=4$

### Order matters:

- $1 + 1 + 1 + 1$
- $1 + 1 + 2$
- $1 + 2 + 1$
- $2 + 1 + 1$
- $2 + 2$

Count = 5

### Order does not matter:

- $1 + 1 + 1 + 1$
- $1 + 1 + 2$
- $2 + 2$

Count = 3

### Idea:

simple formula works for combinations

- Maximum pairs of 2 steps =  $n / 2$ .
- For each  $k$  pairs of 2-steps, rest are 1-steps.
- So total ways = number of possible pairs from 0 to  $n/2 \rightarrow (n/2) + 1$ .

## Rod Cutting Problem

28 May 2025 12:43

Given:

- A rod of length  $n$ .
- An array `price[]`, where `price[i]` is the price of a rod piece of length  $i$ .

Task:

- Cut the rod into smaller pieces (any number of cuts allowed) to **maximize the total price** obtained.

Example:

```
N=4
prices=[1,5,8,9]
output=
10
```

- **Maximum revenue = 10**
- **Optimal cuts = [2, 2]**  
This means:
  - Cut rod into two pieces of length 2
  - Each sells for 5 → total = 10

Explanation:

We want to find the best combination of cuts that sum to 4 and give maximum total price.

**All combinations:**

1. Cut [1,1,1,1] →  $1 + 1 + 1 + 1 = 4$
2. Cut [2,2] →  $5 + 5 = 10$
3. Cut [1,3] →  $1 + 8 = 9$
4. Cut [4] → 9
5. Cut [1,1,2] →  $1 + 1 + 5 = 7$
6. Cut [2,1,1] →  $5 + 1 + 1 = 7$

*Input: price[] = [1, 5, 8, 9, 10, 17, 17, 20]*

*Output: 22*

*Explanation: The maximum obtainable value is 22 by cutting in two pieces of lengths 2 and 6, i.e.,  $5 + 17 = 22$ .*

**Maximum Revenue = 22**

**Optimal Cuts = [2, 6]**

*This means*

- You have a rod of length 8 inches.
- You cut it into two pieces:
  - One of length 2 inches (price=5 for 2 inches)
  - One of length 6 inches (price=17 for 6 inches)

### Algorithm

1. For a rod of length  $n$ , try every possible first cut (from length 1 to  $n$ ).
2. Recursively calculate maximum value for the remaining rod.
3. Take maximum of all such combinations.

**Time Complexity:**

Exponential →  $O(2^n)$

**Space Complexity:**

$O(n)$  (for recursion stack)

Better Approach (Bottom Up DP)

### Algorithm

1. Create a `dp[]` array where `dp[i]` = maximum price for length `i`.
    - `dp[i]` stores the **maximum money** you can earn for a rod of length `i`. We fill it from `dp[1]` to `dp[4]`.
  2. For each length `i`, try all cuts `j` (from 1 to `i`).  
`j` represents a **possible first cut length**. That is:
    - If you're solving for rod of total length `i`,
    - You're trying **every way you can cut off a piece of length `j`** (from 1 to `i`),
    - Then combining that with the best answer for the **remaining rod of length `i - j`**.
  3. Maximize `dp[i]` using:  
`dp[i] = max(dp[i], price[j-1] + dp[i-j])`
- **Time Complexity:**  $O(n^2)$  – for each rod length `i`, we try all cuts `j = 1` to `i`.
  - **Space Complexity:**  $O(n)$  – only one 1D `dp[]` array is used.

Test Case (`n = 4`, `price = [1,5,8,9]`)

```
dp[1] = max(1) → 1
dp[2] = max(1+dp[1]=2, 5) → 5
dp[3] = max(1+dp[2]=6, 5+dp[1]=6, 8) → 8
dp[4] = max(1+dp[3]=9, 5+dp[2]=10, 8+dp[1]=9, 9) → 10
```

You're solving a **small problem first** (length 1), saving its answer, and **using that saved answer** to solve the next bigger problem (length 2), and so on...

You're building the solution **bottom-up** – from small pieces to the whole.

Each time, you're asking:

What if I cut the first piece of size `j`, and then use the best I already know for the remaining part.

### Imagine this:

You have a rod of length `n`.

You also have a **price list** like this:

|         |   |   |   |   |    |    |    |    |
|---------|---|---|---|---|----|----|----|----|
| Length: | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5  | 6  | 7  | 8  |
| Price:  | 1 | 5 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 17 | 17 | 20 |

Now, you want to **cut the rod in pieces** such that the **total money you get is the maximum possible**.

But instead of solving it all at once, you think:

“Hmm, let me first figure out the **best way to make money from a rod of length 1.**”

Then:

“Now let's figure out the best for **length 2**, using what I already know for length 1.”

And then for 3, and 4... all the way up to 8.

Each time, you're **just adding one more inch**, and trying all ways to use that new

length using the pieces you already figured out.  
So basically, you're **filling a table** like this:

```
best[0] = 0           → no rod, no money
best[1] = 1           → best for 1 inch
best[2] = 5           → best for 2 inches
best[3] = 8
best[4] = 10
best[5] = 13
best[6] = 17
best[7] = 18
best[8] = 22          → final best value
```

By the time you reach length 8, you already know the **best prices** for all smaller lengths, and you use that info to decide what's best for 8.

for example:

-----

Price list (0-based indexing):

```
Length:  1   2   3   4   ...
Price:    1   5   8   9   ...
```

Suppose we have:

```
best[0] = 0
```

```
best[1] = 1
```

```
best[2] = 5
```

Now we want to compute:

```
best[3] = ?
```

### Try All Possible First Cuts

We'll try every first cut from 1 to 3 and use previously solved `best[]` values.

#### ► Option 1: First Cut = 1 inch

- Cut rod: [1] + [2 remaining]
- Price = `price[0] + best[2]` = 1 + 5 = 6

#### ► Option 2: First Cut = 2 inches

- Cut rod: [2] + [1 remaining]
- Price = `price[1] + best[1]` = 5 + 1 = 6

#### ► Option 3: First Cut = 3 inches

- Cut rod: [3] + [0 remaining]
- Price = `price[2] + best[0]` = 8 + 0 = 8

### ☒ Compare All Options

Option 1: 6

Option 2: 6

Option 3: 8

→ Max = 8

So:

```
best[3] = 8
```

### What Just Happened?

We **used our previous best answers** for rods of length 1 and 2, tried combining them with new cuts, and then **picked the max** out of all combinations.



## Intro to Greedy

23 May 2025 11:48

**Core idea:** Always take the best immediate (local) choice hoping for global optimal.

**Analogy:** Choosing most valuable items to pack when traveling.

☑ **Real-world Example:**

**Coin change problem (Greedy version):**

You want to give change using the **fewest coins** possible.

Coins available: 25, 10, 5, 1 cents.

You always take the largest coin  $\leq$  remaining amount.

🔗 **Visualization for 63 cents:**

Take 25 → Remaining: 38

Take 25 → Remaining: 13

Take 10 → Remaining: 3

Take 1 → Remaining: 2

Take 1 → Remaining: 1

Take 1 → Remaining: 0

Answer: 6 coins.

⚠ Doesn't always give optimal for all coin systems (e.g., coins: 9, 6, 1 and amount 11 → greedy gives  $9+1+1 = 3$  but optimal is  $6+6 = 2$ ).

# Coin Change Problem

24 May 2025 14:24

Given a set of coin denominations `coins[]` and a target amount `amount`, use the **minimum number of coins** to make the amount.  
You can use each coin unlimited times.

The denominations are standard and canonical (like Indian or US currency: [1, 2, 5, 10, 20, 50, 100

You want to give change using the fewest coins possible.  
Coins available: 25, 10, 5, 1.

example:

Visualization for target amount 63:

Take 25 → Remaining: 38  
Take 25 → Remaining: 13  
Take 10 → Remaining: 3  
Take 1 → Remaining: 2  
Take 1 → Remaining: 1  
Take 1 → Remaining: 0

Answer: 6 coins.

Doesn't always give optimal for all coin systems (e.g., coins: 9, 6, 1 and amount 12 → greedy gives  $9+1+1+1 = 12$  coins but optimal is  $6+6 = 2$  coins).

- Time:  $O(n \log n)$  (highest to lowest denominations)
  - $O(n \log n + \text{amount}/\text{mincoins})$  for sorting
  - Worst-case inner loop: if using all 1s →  $O(\text{amount})$
- Space:  $O(\text{amount})$  for storing result coins (worst-case)

`n = 6`

`coins = [1, 2, 5, 10, 20, 50]`

`amount = 93`

Output:

`50 20 20 2 1`

Approach

- 
1. Sort the coins in descending order.
  2. Initialize:
    - `remaining_amount = total_amount`
    - `coin_list = []` (to store selected coins)
  3. Loop through each coin `c` in the sorted list:
    - While `remaining_amount >= c`, pick the coin:

- `remaining_amount -= c`
  - Add `c` to `coin_list`
4. Repeat until the amount becomes 0.



## Coin Exchange using DP

27 May 2025 10:01

### Key Idea:

- Use a DP array `dp` where `dp[i]` represents the minimum coins needed to make amount `i`.
- Initialize `dp[0] = 0` (0 coins needed to make amount 0).
- Initialize all other values as a large number (`amount + 1`) to represent infinity (impossible state).

For each amount `i` from 1 to target:

- Try every coin denomination `c`:
  - If  $c \leq i$ , update `dp[i]` by comparing current value `dp[i]` and `dp[i - c] + 1`.
  - `dp[i - c] + 1` means: use one coin `c` plus minimum coins needed for `i - c`.
- Take the minimum over all coins.

After filling `dp[]`, check `dp[amount]`:

- If still infinity (greater than amount), return -1 (no solution).
- Otherwise, `dp[amount]` is the minimum coins needed.

Think like this:

- To get amount 11, try using a coin `c`:
  - That coin covers `c` units.
  - We still need to cover the leftover `11 - c` units.
- If we know the minimum coins to cover `11 - c` (`dp[11 - c]`), then total is `dp[11 - c] + 1`.
- Check all coins and choose the minimum.

- `coins[] = {9, 6, 1}`
- `amount = 11`

DP Stores minimum coins required for all sub-amounts, ensuring the globally optimal solution.

### ☒ Initialization:

- `dp[0] = 0`
- All others initialized to `amount + 1 = 12` → acts as infinity.

So initially:

```
dp = [0, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12]
```

### ☒ Fill DP Table:

We process `i = 1` to 11

For each `i`, try every coin `c` such that  $c \leq i$ .

### Step-by-step Update:

Let's trace for each `i`:

**i = 1**

Check coins:

- $9 > 1 \rightarrow \text{skip}$
- $6 > 1 \rightarrow \text{skip}$
- $1 \leq 1 \rightarrow \text{update}$   
 $\rightarrow dp[1] = \min(dp[1], dp[0] + 1) = \min(12, 0 + 1) = 1$

dp = [0, 1, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12]

**i = 2**

- $1 \leq 2 \rightarrow dp[2] = \min(12, dp[1] + 1) = 1 + 1 = 2$

dp = [0, 1, 2, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12]

**i = 3**

- $1 \leq 3 \rightarrow dp[3] = dp[2] + 1 = 2 + 1 = 3$

dp = [0, 1, 2, 3, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12]

**i = 4**

$\rightarrow dp[4] = dp[3] + 1 = 4$

dp = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12]

**i = 5**

$\rightarrow dp[5] = dp[4] + 1 = 5$

dp = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12]

**i = 6**

- $6 \leq 6 \rightarrow dp[6] = \min(12, dp[0] + 1) = 1$
- $1 \leq 6 \rightarrow dp[6] = \min(1, dp[5] + 1) = \min(1, 6) = 1$

dp = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 1, 12, 12, 12, 12, 12]

**i = 7**

$\rightarrow dp[7] = \min(dp[6] + 1 = 2)$

dp = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 1, 2, 12, 12, 12, 12]

**i = 8**

$\rightarrow dp[8] = dp[7] + 1 = 3$

dp = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 1, 2, 3, 12, 12, 12]

**i = 9**

- $9 \leq 9 \rightarrow dp[9] = \min(12, dp[0] + 1) = 1$
- $6 \leq 9 \rightarrow dp[9] = \min(1, dp[3] + 1 = 4) = 1$

dp = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 1, 2, 3, 1, 12, 12]

**i = 10**

$\rightarrow dp[10] = dp[9] + 1 = 2$

dp = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 12]

**i = 11**

→  $dp[11] = dp[10] + 1 = 3$

$dp = [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3]$

| Amount | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 11 |
|--------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|----|----|
| dp[]   | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 1 | 2  | 3  |

**Time Complexity:**

- $O(n * \text{amount})$  where n is number of coins.

**Space Complexity:**

- $O(\text{amount})$  for dp and parent.

**Final Answer:**

$dp[11] = 3$

(We can make 11 using (9 + 1 + 1))

# Fractional Knapsack Problem

26 May 2025 15:30

## Greedy Approach (Optimal for fractional)

### Idea:

- Compute **value per weight**
- Sort items by **value per weight** descending
- Pick full items till capacity is left
- Pick fraction of next item if needed

```
val[] = [60, 100, 120]
```

```
wt[] = [10, 20, 30]
```

```
capacity = 50
```

- Sort items by profit/weight ratio ↓: [Item 1, Item 2, Item 3] (descending)
- Take full Item 1 → cap=40, val=60
- Take full Item 2 → cap=20, val=60+100=160
- Take 20/30 of Item 3 → val +=  $(2/3)*120 = 80$   
**Total = 60 + 100 + 80 = 240.0**

```
val = [500]
```

```
wt = [30]
```

```
capacity = 10
```

```
Value/Weight =  $500/30 = 16.6667$ 
```

→ take 10/30 of it:

→ value =  $(10/30)*500 = 166.6667$

## Min fib terms to sum upto K

30 May 2025 12:09

### Key Idea:

Always subtract the **largest Fibonacci number**  $\leq k$  from  $k$ , and repeat. and keep track of the count of numbers considered.

Because **Fibonacci numbers grow exponentially**, so larger ones cover more value in fewer terms.

You can always build any number using minimum terms by always choosing the largest possible Fibonacci number at each step.

1. Generate all Fibonacci numbers  $\leq k$
2. Start from the largest Fibonacci number
3. While  $k > 0$ :
  - Pick the largest Fibonacci number  $f \leq k$
  - Subtract  $f$  from  $k$
  - Increment count
4. Return the count

- **Time:**  $O(n)$  where  $n$  = number of Fibonacci numbers  $\leq k$
- **Space:**  $O(n)$  for Fibonacci list

**k = 7:**

**Fibonacci list:** [1, 2, 3, 5]

**Initially:**  $i = 3$  (points to 5)

**First iteration:**

- $k = 7$ ,  $\text{fib}[3] = 5$
- $5 \leq 7 \rightarrow$  **okay**, skip the while

Now we subtract 5  $\rightarrow k = 2$ , count++

**Second iteration:**

- $k = 2$ ,  $\text{fib}[3] = 5 \rightarrow$  too big
- Enter the while:
  - $\text{fib}[3] = 5 > 2 \rightarrow i-- \rightarrow i = 2$
  - $\text{fib}[2] = 3 > 2 \rightarrow i-- \rightarrow i = 1$
  - $\text{fib}[1] = 2 \leq 2 \rightarrow$  stop

Now we subtract 2  $\rightarrow k = 0$ , count++  
final count is 2

- while ( $i \geq 0 \ \&\& \ \text{fib.get}(i) > k$ )  $i--$

- This moves the pointer `i` to the largest Fibonacci number  $\leq k$ .
- You are starting from the largest Fibonacci number in the list (`fib.get(i)`), and moving left until you find one that can be subtracted from `k` (i.e.,  $\leq k$ ).

## Connect N ropes with a Minimum Cost

30 May 2025 12:28

Given an array `arr[]` of rope lengths, connect all ropes into a single rope with the minimum total cost. The cost to connect two ropes is the **sum** of their lengths.

**Examples:**

**Input:** `arr[] = [4, 3, 2, 6]`

**Output:** 29

**Explanation:** We can connect the ropes in following ways.

- 1) First connect ropes of lengths 2 and 3. Which makes the array `[4, 5, 6]`. Cost of this operation  $2 + 3 = 5$ .
- 2) Now connect ropes of lengths 4 and 5. Which makes the array `[9, 6]`. Cost of this operation  $4 + 5 = 9$ .
- 3) Finally connect the two ropes and all ropes have connected. Cost of this operation  $9 + 6 = 15$ . Total cost is  $5 + 9 + 15 = 29$ . This is the optimized cost for connecting ropes.

Other ways of connecting ropes would always have same or more cost. For example, if we connect 4 and 6 first (we get three rope of 3, 2 and 10), then connect 10 and 3 (we get two rope of 13 and 2). Finally we connect 13 and 2. Total cost in this way is  $10 + 13 + 15 = 38$ .

**Key Idea:**

Combining the two smallest ropes early keeps the cost lower

1. Push all rope lengths into a **Min-Heap**
2. While the heap has more than one element:
  - Pop the two smallest ropes  $a$  and  $b$
  - Combine them  $\rightarrow$  new rope  $= a + b$
  - Add the cost to total
  - Push new rope back into the heap
3. Return total cost

- **Time:**  $O(n \log n)$

Each insertion and extraction in heap takes  $O(\log n)$ , and we do this  $n-1$  times.

- **Space:**  $O(n)$  for priority queue

**[4, 3, 2, 6]**

Initial Min-Heap: `[2, 3, 4, 6]`

- Pop  $2 + 3 = 5$ , cost = 5  $\rightarrow$  Heap: `[4, 6, 5]`
- Pop  $4 + 5 = 9$ , cost = 9  $\rightarrow$  Heap: `[6, 9]`
- Pop  $6 + 9 = 15$ , cost = 15  $\rightarrow$  Heap: `[15]`

**Total cost =  $5 + 9 + 15 = 29$**

- Internally, the structure is a binary heap, not a sorted array
- Ordering inside the heap (e.g., `4, 6, 5`) is based on heap rules, not value order

After inserting 4, 6, and 5 into a min-heap, it might look like:



Here:

- 4 is the smallest  $\rightarrow$  root
- 6 and 5 are children (still satisfies heap property)

*How Min-Heap Works Internally:*

*It stores elements in binary tree fashion with this rule:*

- Parent  $\leq$  children

*So:*

- Heap: [4, 6, 5] is valid (root is 4)
- Heap: [4, 5, 6] is also valid

*Both satisfy the min-heap property.*

*Don't expect a min-heap to be sorted.*

*Instead, always rely on:*

- `poll()`  $\rightarrow$  gives smallest element
- `peek()`  $\rightarrow$  gives current minimum



## Buy Maximum Stocks if i stocks can be bought on i-th day

30 May 2025 12:43

- You have prices of stocks for **N days**: `arr[i]` is price on day `i` (1-based).
- On day `i`, you can buy **at most i stocks**.
- You have `k` money in total.
- Buy **maximum number of stocks** with money `k` while respecting the day limits.

**Input** : `price[] = { 10, 7, 19 }`,  
`k = 45`.

**Output** : 4

A customer purchases 1 stock on day 1 for 10 rs,  
2 stocks on day 2 for 7 rs each and 1 stock on day 3 for 19 rs.  
Therefore total of  
10,  $7 * 2 = 14$  and 19 respectively. Hence,  
total amount is  $10 + 14 + 19 = 43$   
Max number of stocks purchased is 4.

### Key Idea (Greedy):

- To maximize stocks, **buy the cheapest stocks first**.
- But you can buy **only up to i stocks on day i**.
- So sort days by price, then buy as many as you can on the cheapest days first.

Input:

**Day Price**

|   |    |
|---|----|
| 1 | 10 |
| 2 | 7  |
| 3 | 19 |

Money (`k`) = 45

### Step 1: Sort days by price:

**Day Price**

|   |    |
|---|----|
| 2 | 7  |
| 1 | 10 |
| 3 | 19 |

### Step 2: Buy stocks day by day (cheapest first):

- Day 2 (price=7, max buy=2):
  - How many can we buy? Minimum of max stocks on day and what money allows.
  - Money allows:  $45 / 7 = 6$  (can buy up to 6 stocks if no limit)
  - Max stocks allowed on day 2: 2
  - so buy  $\min(6, 2) = 2$

- So buy 2 stocks  $\rightarrow$  cost =  $2 * 7 = 14$
- Money left =  $45 - 14 = 31$
- Stocks bought = 2
- Day 1 (price=10, max buy=1):
  - Money allows:  $31 / 10 = 3$
  - Max stocks allowed on day 1: 1
  - Buy 1 stock  $\rightarrow$  cost =  $1 * 10 = 10$
  - Money left =  $31 - 10 = 21$
  - Stocks bought so far =  $2 + 1 = 3$
- Day 3 (price=19, max buy=3):
  - Money allows:  $21 / 19 = 1$
  - Max stocks allowed on day 3: 3
  - Buy 1 stock  $\rightarrow$  cost =  $1 * 19 = 19$
  - Money left =  $21 - 19 = 2$
  - Stocks bought so far =  $3 + 1 = 4$

**Result: maximum stocks = 4**

### Why sorting by price is important?

If you buy expensive stocks first, you'll run out of money quickly and buy fewer stocks. Buying cheaper stocks first lets you buy more stocks overall.

### Algorithm

-----

- Create an array of (price, day) pairs.
- Sort the pairs by **price ascending**.
- For each day in sorted order:
  - Calculate how many stocks you can buy:  $buy = \min(day, k / price)$
  - Update  $k -= buy * price$
  - Add buy to total\_stocks
- Return total\_stocks

### Complexity:

- Sorting:  $O(N \log N)$
- Buying stocks:  $O(N)$
- Space:  $O(N)$  for auxiliary array

## binary search with first and last occurrence

24 May 2025 14:26

Given an array of integers `nums` sorted in increasing order, find the starting and ending position of a given target value.

If target is not found in the array, return `[-1, -1]`.

You must write an algorithm with  $O(\log n)$  runtime complexity.

**Example 1:**

**Input:** `nums = [5,7,7,8,8,10]`, `target = 8`

**Output:** `[3,4]`

**Example 2:**

**Input:** `nums = [5,7,7,8,8,10]`, `target = 6`

**Output:** `[-1,-1]`

## Peak Element

02 June 2025 12:58

A peak element is an element that is strictly greater than its neighbors.

Given a 0-indexed integer array `nums`, find a peak element, and return its index. If the array contains multiple peaks, return the index to **any of the peaks**.

You may imagine that `nums[-1] = nums[n] = -∞`. In other words, an element is always considered to be strictly greater than a neighbor that is outside the array.

You must write an algorithm that runs in  $O(\log n)$  time.

Example 1:

Input: `nums = [1,2,3,1]`

Output: 2

Explanation: 3 is a peak element and your function should return the index number 2.

Example 2: `0 1 2 3 4`

Input: `nums = [1,2,1,3,5,6,4]`

Output: 5

Explanation: Your function can return either index number 1 where the peak element is 2, or index number 5 where the peak element is 6.

```
int low = 0;
int high = n - 1;
```

```
while (low < high) {
    int mid = (low + high) / 2;
```

```
    // Check if mid is greater than its next element
```

```
    if (nums[mid] > nums[mid + 1])
```

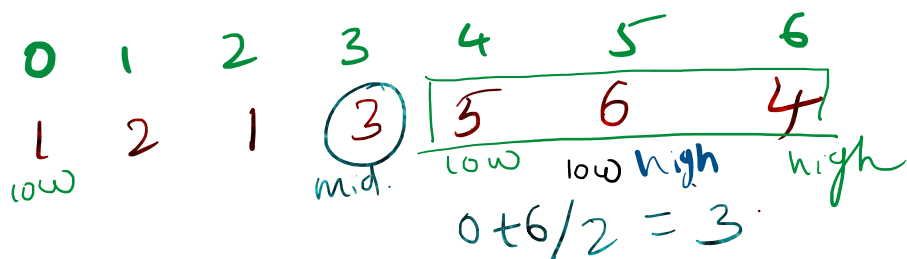
```
        high = mid; // Continue searching in the left half
```

```
    else
```

```
        low = mid + 1; // Continue searching in the right half
```

```
return low;
```

Since  $low == high$   
return low



①  $3 > 5 \times$   
 $low = mid + 1 = 4$

②  $4 + 6 / 2 = 5$   
 $6 > 4 \checkmark$   
 $high = mid = 5$

③  $4 + 5 / 2 = 4$   
 $5 > 6 \times$   $low = mid + 1 = 5$

In binary search for a value:

- If `a[mid] > target`, you do: `high = mid - 1`
- Because you know `mid` is not the answer

But in **peak search**:

- If `a[mid] > a[mid + 1]`, it means you are in the **decreasing slope** of a bitonic/peak region
  - So the **peak might be at mid itself**, or somewhere to the left
  - Thus, you do: `high = mid` (not `mid - 1`)

## Pivot Element

02 June 2025 12:58

Pivot element is the only element in input array which is smaller than it's previous element.

A pivot element divides a sorted rotated array into two monotonically increasing array.

Find such pivot element using recursive binary search.

input=7

4 5 6 7 1 2 3

output=Pivot element is: 1

\*/

```
int pivot = findPivot(arr, 0, n - 1);
System.out.println("Pivot element is: " + pivot);
```

```
public static int findPivot(int[] arr, int low, int high)
    if (low>high)
        return arr[0]    // Array not rotated, return first element

    if (high == low)
        return arr[low]    // Only one element left

    int mid = (low + high)

    // Check if mid+1 is the pivot
    if (mid < high && arr[mid] > arr[mid + 1])
        return arr[mid + 1]

    // Check if mid is the pivot
    if (mid > low && arr[mid] < arr[mid - 1])
        return arr[mid]

    if (arr[low] < arr[mid])
        return findPivot(arr, mid + 1, high) // Search in the right half
    else
        return findPivot(arr, low, mid - 1) // Search in the left half
```

## aggressive cows

24 May 2025 14:26

You are given an array with unique elements of stalls[], which denote the position of a stall. You are also given an integer k which denotes the number of aggressive cows. Your task is to assign stalls to k cows such that the minimum distance between any two of them is the maximum possible.

Examples :

Input: stalls[] = [1, 2, 4, 8, 9], k = 3

Output: 3

Explanation: The first cow can be placed at stalls[0],

the second cow can be placed at stalls[2] and

the third cow can be placed at stalls[3].

The minimum distance between cows, in this case, is 3, which also is the largest among all possible ways.

Input: stalls[] = [10, 1, 2, 7, 5], k = 3

Output: 4

Explanation: The first cow can be placed at stalls[0],

the second cow can be placed at stalls[1] and

the third cow can be placed at stalls[4].

The minimum distance between cows, in this case, is 4, which also is the largest among all possible ways.

Input: stalls[] = [2, 12, 11, 3, 26, 7], k = 5

Output: 1

Explanation: Each cow can be placed in any of the stalls, as the no. of stalls are exactly equal to the number of cows.

The minimum distance between cows, in this case, is 1, which also is the largest among all possible ways.

### Naive Approach

-----

- try all possible minimum distances d from 1 up to the maximum possible distance (max(stalls) - min(stalls)).
- For each distance d, try to place all cows in stalls so that the distance between any two cows is at least d.
- The largest d for which placement is possible is the answer.

Time:

$O(\text{max\_dist} * n)$

(since max\_dist ranges from 1 to (max-min), and for each, we do a linear scan)

stalls = [1, 2, 4, 8, 9]

k = 3 (number of cows)

Sort first step: {1,2,4,8,9}

max\_distance = stalls[max] - stalls[min] = 9 - 1 = 8

Step 2: Try each distance from 1 to 8 (inclusive)

| Distance d | Is it possible to place 3 cows with at least d? | How cows are placed?          | Result             |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------|
| 1          | Yes                                             | Cows at [1, 2, 4]             | Possible           |
| 2          | Yes                                             | Cows at [1, 4, 8]             | Possible           |
| 3          | Yes                                             | Cows at [1, 4, 8]             | Possible           |
| 4          | Yes                                             | Cows at [1, 4, 8]             | 4-1=3 not Possible |
| 5          | No                                              | Try [1, 8, ?] (9-8=1 < 5 no)  | Not Possible       |
| 6          | No                                              | Try [1, 8, ?] (9-8=1 < 6 no)  | Not Possible       |
| 7          | No                                              | Try [1, 8, ?] (9-8=1 < 7 no)  | Not Possible       |
| 8          | No                                              | Only 1 cow can be placed at 1 | Not Possible       |

### Approach 2 (Optimal - Binary Search on Answer):

1. Sort the stall positions.

2. Binary Search:

○ low = 1

○ high = max\_distance = last - first

3. For a mid value (distance), check if it's possible to place k cows such that minimum distance between any two is at least mid.

4. If yes → try bigger distance.

If no → try smaller.

```

Arrays.sort(stalls)

int low = 1;
int high = stalls[n - 1] - stalls[0]
int ans = 0

while (low <= high) {
    int mid = (low + high) / 2

    if (is_possible(stalls, n, k, mid))
        ans = mid;
        low = mid + 1;
    else
        high = mid - 1;
}

print(ans)
}

boolean is_possible(int[] stalls, int n, int cows, int dist) {
    int count = 1
    int last_pos = stalls[0]

    for (int i = 1; i < n; i++)
        if (stalls[i] - last_pos >= dist) {
            count++
            last_pos = stalls[i]
        }

    return count >= cows
}

```

## Sum of all Subarrays

05 November 2024 01:28

The total number of subarrays in an array of size  $N$  is  $N * (N + 1) / 2$ . elements should be contiguous.

(empty subarray is not allowed)

For an array  $[1, 2, 3]$ , subarrays are:  $[1]$ ,  $[2]$ ,  $[3]$ ,  $[1, 2]$ ,  $[1, 2, 3]$ ,  $[2, 3]$

- $[1] \rightarrow 1$
- $[2] \rightarrow 2$
- $[3] \rightarrow 3$
- $[1, 2] \rightarrow 1+2=3$
- $[2, 3] \rightarrow 2+3=5$
- $[1, 2, 3] \rightarrow 1+2+3=6$

$$1+2+3+3+5+6=20$$

1 appears in subarrays:  $[1]$ ,  $[1, 2]$ ,  $[1, 2, 3]$

Contribution of 1 =  $1 * 3 = 3$

2 appears in subarrays:  $[2]$ ,  $[1, 2]$ ,  $[2, 3]$ ,  $[1, 2, 3]$

Contribution of 2 =  $2 * 4 = 8$

3 appears in subarrays:  $[3]$ ,  $[2, 3]$ ,  $[1, 2, 3]$

Contribution of 3 =  $3 * 3 = 9$

Hence sum of all subarrays can be said as:  $3 + 8 + 9 = 20$ .

```
n = arr.length
long totalsum = 0
for i from 0 to n - 1
    long res = arr[i] * (i + 1) * (n - i)
    totalsum = totalsum + res
end for
print totalsum
```

- $(i + 1) \rightarrow$  Number of starting indices from which a subarray that includes  $\text{arr}[i]$  can begin.
- $(n - i) \rightarrow$  Number of ending indices at which a subarray that includes  $\text{arr}[i]$  can end.

Let's take a small array:

```
arr = [3, 1, 2]
```

```
n = 3
```

All possible subarrays are:



[3]

[3, 1]

[3, 1, 2]

[1]

[1, 2]

[2]

And their sums:

$3 + 4 + 6 + 1 + 3 + 2 = 19$

So total sum = 19

## Sum of all Subsequences(or subsets same)

05 November 2024 01:28

The total number of subsequences possible is equal to  $2^n$ . (including empty subsequence) elements need not to be contiguous.

Note: only subsequence and subset can have empty array.)

A subsequence is formed by including or excluding each element, maintaining the order.  
For array [1, 2]:

- Subsequences = [], [1], [2], [1,2]
- Sum of subsequences =  $0 + 1 + 2 + (1+2) = 6$

For an array [1, 2, 3], subsequences are:

```
[]  
[1]  
[2]  
[3]  
[1, 2]  
[1, 3]  
[2, 3]  
[1, 2, 3]
```

### Naive Approach

-----

Use recursion or backtracking to explore all combinations (include/exclude)  
import java.util.\*;

```
public class Main {  
    static int total = 0;  
  
    public static void main(String[] args) {  
        Scanner sc = new Scanner(System.in);  
        int n = sc.nextInt();  
        int[] a = new int[n];  
        for(int i = 0; i < n; i++)  
            a[i] = sc.nextInt();  
  
        generate(0, 0, a, n);  
        System.out.println(total);  
    }  
  
    static void generate(int i, int sum, int[] a, int n) {  
        if(i == n) {  
            total += sum;  
            return;  
        }  
        generate(i + 1, sum + a[i], a, n);  
        generate(i + 1, sum, a, n);  
    }  
}
```

In an array subsequence, each element appears in  $2^{n-1}$  subsequences.

first calculate array sum: which is  $1+2+3=6$   
count of each element:  $2^3-1=2^2=4$

print(sum\*countofeachelement)  $6*4=24$

```

sum = 0
for num in arr
    sum = sum + num

long res = (long) Math.pow(2, n - 1);
or
long res= 1L << (n-1))

print (sum * res)

```

```

import java.util.*;

public class subset_sum_of_all_subsets {
    public static void main(String[] args) {
        Scanner sc = new Scanner(System.in);
        int n = sc.nextInt();
        int[] a = new int[n];
        int total_sum = 0;
        for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {
            a[i] = sc.nextInt();
            total_sum += a[i];
        }
        int power = 1;
        for (int i = 1; i < n; i++) {
            power *= 2;
        }
        int ans = power * total_sum;
        System.out.println(ans);
    }
}

```

**The only difference between subsets and subsequences is the order and position of elements.**

| Characteristic                                 | Subset                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Subsequence                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Order of Elements</b>                       | The order of elements does not matter. A subset consists of any <b>combination</b> of elements chosen from the original set, regardless of their position. Example: For set $s = \{1, 2, 3\}$ , subset $\{3, 2\}$ is equivalent to $\{2, 3\}$ . | The elements must appear in the <b>same</b> relative order as in the original sequence, though they do not need to be <b>contiguous</b> . Example: For sequence $s = \{1, 2, 3\}$ , subsequence $\{3, 2\}$ is <b>invalid</b> , but $\{1, 3\}$ or $\{2, 3\}$ are valid. |
| <b>Relationship with Original Set/Sequence</b> | Defined in the context of sets, duplicates are irrelevant.                                                                                                                                                                                      | Defined in the context of sequences, duplicates are preserved.                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Size and Selection</b>                      | Formed by selecting <b>any combination</b> of elements from the set.                                                                                                                                                                            | Formed by <b>deleting specific elements</b> without rearranging the rest.                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Contextual Usage</b>                        | Primarily used in <b>set theory</b> and <b>combinatorics</b> .                                                                                                                                                                                  | Primarily used in <b>algorithms</b> , <b>string matching</b> , and <b>sequence alignment</b> .                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Example</b>                                 | For set $s = \{1, 2, 3\}$ , subset $\{3, 2\}$ is valid because order does not matter.                                                                                                                                                           | For subsequence $s = \{1, 2, 3\}$ , subsequence $\{3, 2\}$ is invalid because order is not preserved.                                                                                                                                                                  |

## Longest consecutive subsequence

03 June 2025 14:43

Given an array of  $n$  integers, find the **length of the longest subsequence** of consecutive integers (they can appear in any order).

- Duplicates and order don't matter.
- Subsequence (not necessarily contiguous in the array).

**Input:** `arr = [2, 6, 1, 9, 4, 5, 3]`

**Output:** 6

**Explanation:** The subsequence is [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]

### Approach 1: Brute Force

#### Idea:

For each element, try to find the **next consecutive number** ( $x+1$ ,  $x+2$ , ...) by checking if it's in the array.

#### Steps:

1. For every element, keep increasing and check if  $\text{element}+1$ ,  $\text{element}+2$ ... exist in array.
2. Count how far you can go.

#### 1. Initialize variables

- `max_len = 1` → keeps track of longest subsequence length

#### 2. Outer loop ( $i = 0$ to $n-1$ )

Start with each element `arr[i]` and assume it to be the **starting point** of a potential sequence.

- Let `x = arr[i]`
- Initialize `count = 1` to count this as the first element in sequence

#### 3. Inner loop ( $j = 0$ to $n-1$ )

Search for  $x+1$  in the array:

- If `arr[j] == x+1`, it means next number in sequence is found
- Then:
  - Increment `count`
  - Update `x = x + 1`
  - Reset `j = -1` to **restart** search for the next  $x+1$

#### 4. Update the maximum length

After the inner loop ends:

- If `count > max_len`, update `max_len = count`

#### 5. Repeat outer loop for all $i$

#### 6. Return `max_len`

**Visual Trace for Input:** [2, 6, 1, 9, 4, 5, 3]

| i | arr[i] | Found Sequence   | Count                                 |
|---|--------|------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 0 | 2      | 2, 3, 4, 5, 6    | 5                                     |
| 1 | 6      | 6                | 1                                     |
| 2 | 1      | 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 | 6 <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> |
| 3 | 9      | 9                | 1                                     |
| 4 | 4      | 4, 5, 6          | 3                                     |
| 5 | 5      | 5, 6             | 2                                     |
| 6 | 3      | 3, 4, 5, 6       | 4                                     |

**Time:**  $O(n^2)$

**Space:**  $O(1)$

### Approach Time

### Space Remarks

|         |               |        |                           |
|---------|---------------|--------|---------------------------|
| Brute   | $O(n^2)$      | $O(1)$ | Slow for large input      |
| Sorting | $O(n \log n)$ | $O(1)$ | Better, but needs sorting |
| HashSet | $O(n)$        | $O(n)$ | Best in time, needs space |

approach 2 using sorting

#### Idea:

- If we sort the array, all consecutive elements will appear **next to each other**.
- We can then iterate through the array and count the length of consecutive increasing numbers.
- Sorting puts numbers in order.
- Skip **duplicates** – they shouldn't reset the count.
- If  $\text{arr}[i] == \text{arr}[i-1] + 1$ , it's part of the same sequence.
- If  $\text{arr}[i] \neq \text{arr}[i-1] + 1$ , the sequence is **broken** → reset count.

- **Sort the array**
  - So that consecutive numbers are adjacent.
- **Initialize variables**
  - $\text{curr\_len} = 1$  → Current sequence length
  - $\text{max\_len} = 1$  → Max sequence length
- **Loop from index 1 to n-1**
  - If  $\text{arr}[i] == \text{arr}[i-1] + 1$  → consecutive → increment  $\text{curr\_len}$
  - If  $\text{arr}[i] == \text{arr}[i-1]$  → duplicate → skip (no change)
  - Else → not consecutive → reset  $\text{curr\_len} = 1$
- **Update max length after each step**
  - $\text{max\_len} = \max(\text{max\_len}, \text{curr\_len})$
- **Return max\_len**

[2, 6, 1, 9, 4, 5, 3]

- Sorted: [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 9]

| i | arr[i] | arr[i-1] | Relation | curr_len | max_len |
|---|--------|----------|----------|----------|---------|
| 1 | 2      | 1        | +1       | 2        | 2       |
| 2 | 3      | 2        | +1       | 3        | 3       |
| 3 | 4      | 3        | +1       | 4        | 4       |
| 4 | 5      | 4        | +1       | 5        | 5       |
| 5 | 6      | 5        | +1       | 6        | 6       |
| 6 | 9      | 6        | not +1   | 1        | 6       |

approach3: optimized using hashset

- For each number, check **only if it's the start** of a sequence (i.e.,  $\text{num} - 1$  is **not** in the set).
- Then, expand the sequence forward ( $\text{num} + 1$ ,  $\text{num} + 2$ , ...) until it's broken.
- Keep track of the longest such sequence.
- Every element is inserted and removed **at most once** in the set.
- No sorting or nested loops.
- **Time:  $O(n)$ , Space:  $O(n)$**

- **Add all elements to a HashSet**
  - So we can check existence in  $O(1)$  time.
- **Initialize  $\text{max\_len} = 0$**
- **Loop over each number num in the array:**
  - If  $\text{num} - 1$  is **not** in the set → num is the **start of a new sequence**
  - Set  $\text{current} = \text{num}$
  - Count how many  $\text{current} + 1$ ,  $\text{current} + 2$ , etc. are in the set
  - Track length of this sequence using count
- **Update max\_len with the maximum of current and previous max**
- **Return max\_len**

#### Loop Over Each Element and Apply Logic

- **i = 0, arr[i] = 2**
  - Is  $2 - 1 = 1$  in the set? → YES
  - → So 2 is NOT the start of a sequence → skip
- **i = 1, arr[i] = 6**
  - Is  $6 - 1 = 5$  in the set? → YES
  - → Not a start → skip
- **i = 2, arr[i] = 1**
  - Is  $1 - 1 = 0$  in the set? → NO

- → So 1 is the start of a new sequence

current = 1

count = 1

Loop and check for current + 1 while it's in the set:

**Step current Exists in set? count**

|   |   |     |      |
|---|---|-----|------|
| 1 | 2 | yes | 2    |
| 2 | 3 | yes | 3    |
| 3 | 4 | yes | 4    |
| 4 | 5 | yes | 5    |
| 5 | 6 | yes | 6    |
| 6 | 7 | NO  | stop |

☒ So, this sequence: [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]

Update:

max\_len = max(0, 6) = 6

## Maximum Subarray Sum (Kadane's Algorithm)

05 November 2024 01:25

/\*

Given an array of integers (can be positive, negative, or zero), find the contiguous subarray which has the maximum sum, and return that sum.

Input: arr[] = {2, 3, -8, 7, -1, 2, 3}

Output: 11

Explanation: The subarray {7, -1, 2, 3} has the largest sum 11. \*/

### Naive Approach

-----

- Initialize res =  $-\infty$  (or Integer.MIN\_VALUE in Java)
- Loop i from 0 to n - 1:
  - Initialize sum = 0
  - Loop j from i to n - 1:
    - Add arr[j] to sum
    - Update res = max(res, sum)
- After both loops, res will contain the maximum subarray sum

### Optimal Approach: Kadane's Algorithm

The idea of Kadane's algorithm is to traverse over the array from left to right and for each element, find the maximum sum among all subarrays ending at that element. The result will be the maximum of all these values.

- ◊ Time:  $O(n)$
- ◊ Space:  $O(1)$

Idea:

While traversing, keep a running curr\_sum.

- If curr\_sum becomes negative, reset it to 0.
- Track the max seen so far using max\_sum.

```
n = scanner.nextInt()
```

```
for i from 0 to n - 1
    arr[i] = scanner.nextInt()
end for
```

```
res = arr[0]
temp = arr[0]
```

```

for i from 1 to n - 1
    temp = max(arr[i], temp + arr[i])
    res = max(res, temp)

```

output res

Input: {2, 3, -8, 7, -1, 2, 3}

| i | arr[i] | curr_sum | max_sum |
|---|--------|----------|---------|
| 0 | 2      | 2        | 2       |
| 1 | 3      | 5        | 5       |
| 2 | -8     | -3       | 5       |
| 3 | 7      | 7        | 7       |
| 4 | -1     | 6        | 7       |
| 5 | 2      | 8        | 8       |
| 6 | 3      | 11       | 11      |

☒ Final Answer = 11

|        |     |    |     |    |     |    |    |
|--------|-----|----|-----|----|-----|----|----|
| Index: | 0   | 1  | 2   | 3  | 4   | 5  | 6  |
| Array: | [2, | 3, | -8, | 7, | -1, | 2, | 3] |
|        |     |    |     | ^  | ^   | ^  | ^  |

Max Subarray → Sum = 11



## subarray with 0 sum

03 June 2025 13:01

Given an array of **positive and negative integers**, check if **there exists a subarray** (of size  $\geq 1$ ) **whose sum is 0**.

### ☑ Sample Inputs:

1. {4, 2, -3, 1, 6} → ✓ true → subarray [2, -3, 1]
2. {4, 2, 0, 1, 6} → ✓ true → element 0 itself
3. {-3, 2, 3, 1, 6} → ✗ false

### Approach 1: Brute Force (Naive)

Check **sum of all subarrays**. If any subarray sum = 0, return true.

```
boolean found = false;
for(int i = 0; i < n; i++) {
    int sum = 0;
    for(int j = i; j < n; j++) {
        sum += a[j];
        if(sum == 0) {
            found = true;
            break;
        }
    }
    if(found)
        break;
}
System.out.println(found);
```

**Time:**  $O(n^2)$ , **Space:**  $O(1)$

### Prefix Sum + HashSet (Optimal)

A prefix sum, also known as a cumulative sum, is an array where each element represents the sum of all previous elements in the original array, up to and including that element. It's a powerful technique for efficiently calculating the sum of subarrays within an array.

If at any point the **prefix sum repeats**, or is 0, then a subarray with 0 sum exists.

**Reason:**

If  $\text{prefix\_sum}[j] == \text{prefix\_sum}[i]$ , then subarray from (i+1 to j) has sum 0.

**Time:**  $O(n)$

**Space:**  $O(n)$

{4, 2, -3, 1, 6}

| i | a[i] | prefix sum | seen           | prefix already seen? |
|---|------|------------|----------------|----------------------|
| 0 | 4    | 4          | {4}            | No                   |
| 1 | 2    | 6          | {4, 6}         | No                   |
| 2 | -3   | 3          | {4, 6, 3}      | No                   |
| 3 | 1    | 4          | 4 already seen | ✓ Yes → return true  |

→ So subarray [2, -3, 1] has sum 0. (only existence we are checking we cant verify through logic)

# Prime number problems

04 June 2025 14:45

Print prime numbers upto given N

Print prime numbers upto given count

Print prime numbers from given range

## sieve of eratosthenesis

24 May 2025 14:26

- **Create a boolean array `prime[0...n]`**
  - Initialize all values as true
  - `prime[i] = true` means we initially assume `i` is prime
- **Set `prime[0] = false` and `prime[1] = false`**
  - Because 0 and 1 are **not** prime
- **Loop from `p = 2` to  $\sqrt{n}$** 
  - If `prime[p] == true`:
    - It means `p` is a prime number
    - Mark all multiples of `p` as **not prime**  
(i.e., set `prime[i] = false` for all `i = p*p, p*p+p, ..., ≤ n`)
- **After the loop**, all indexes `i` where `prime[i] == true` are prime numbers

```
prime[] = [F, F, T, T, T, T, T, T, T, T, T, T]
```

```
Index      0  1  2  3  4  5  6  7  8  9 10
```

```
p = 2: mark 4, 6, 8, 10 as false
```

```
p = 3: mark 9 as false
```

Final:

```
prime[] = [F, F, T, T, F, T, F, T, F, F, F, F]
```

```
Primes:      2  3      5      7
```

## Pivot Index Prefix Sum

02 June 2025 13:32

The **efficient algorithm** avoids recomputing left and right sums every time by:

- Precomputing the **total sum**.
- Tracking the **left sum** while iterating.
- Then computing the **right sum** using:

```
right_sum = total - left_sum - nums[i]
```

This is mathematically correct because:

```
left_sum + nums[i] + right_sum = total
```

```
→ right_sum = total - left_sum - nums[i]
```

So, instead of recomputing left and right sums for every index, we use just a running left sum and a constant-time expression for right sum.

### Naive Approach

-----

For each index  $i$ , calculate:

- $\text{left\_sum}$  = sum from index 0 to  $i-1$
- $\text{right\_sum}$  = sum from index  $i+1$  to  $n-1$

```
for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {
    int left_sum = 0;
    for (int j = 0; j < i; j++)
        left_sum += nums[j];

    int right_sum = 0;
    for (int j = i + 1; j < n; j++)
        right_sum += nums[j];

    if (left_sum == right_sum)
        return i;
}
return -1;
```

### Optimized Approach

-----

```
int total = 0;
for(int i = 0; i < n; i++)
    total += nums[i]

int left_sum = 0
for(int i = 0; i < n; i++)
    int right_sum = total - left_sum - nums[i];
    if(left_sum == right_sum) {
        System.out.println(i)
        return
    }
    left_sum += nums[i]
}
```

```

        System.out.println(-1)
    }

```

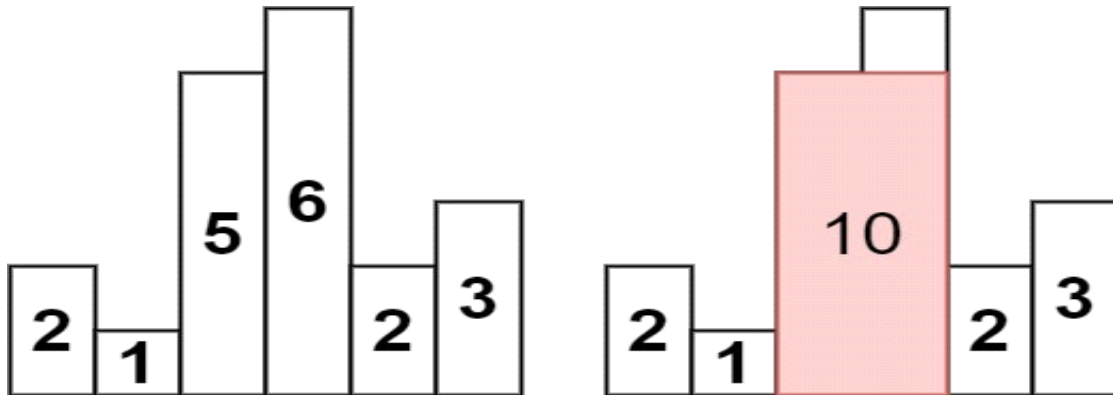
**Input:** nums = [1, 7, 3, 6, 5, 6]  
**Expected Output:** 3

| i | nums[i] | left_sum              | right_sum = total - left_sum - nums[i] | left_sum == right_sum |
|---|---------|-----------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| 0 | 1       | 0                     | 28 - 0 - 1 = 27                        | no                    |
|   |         | left_sum = 0 + 1 = 1  |                                        |                       |
| 1 | 7       | 1                     | 28 - 1 - 7 = 20                        | no                    |
|   |         | left_sum = 1 + 7 = 8  |                                        |                       |
| 2 | 3       | 8                     | 28 - 8 - 3 = 17                        | no                    |
|   |         | left_sum = 8 + 3 = 11 |                                        |                       |
| 3 | 6       | 11                    | 28 - 11 - 6 = 11                       | YES, return index 3   |

## Largest Rectangle in Histogram

03 June 2025 10:11

Given an array of integers heights representing the histogram's bar height where the width of each bar is 1, return *the area of the largest rectangle in the histogram*.



Input: heights = [2,1,5,6,2,3]

Output: 10

Explanation: The above is a histogram where width of each bar is 1.  
The largest rectangle is shown in the red area, which has an area = 10 units.

### 1. Naïve Approach - Brute Force

Time  $O(n^2)$  → two nested loops for each bar (in worst case)

Space  $O(1)$

-----  
For each bar:

- Expand **left** and **right** as far as the bars are **greater than or equal** to the current bar's height.
  - Compute area = height of current bar × width
  - Keep track of the **maximum** area found
- The current bar of height heights[i] can only be part of a rectangle as long as **all bars to the left and right** are **greater than or equal** to it.
  - If any bar is **shorter**, then it breaks the rectangle.  
If you're at index i, and heights[i] = 5,  
then you can include as many consecutive bars on the **left and right** that are  $\geq 5$ .

Index:      0   1   2   3   4   5  
heights = [2, 1, 5, 6, 2, 3]  
Let's choose i = 2, so:

heights[2] = 5

▶ Step 1: Expand Left

Start at i = 2, move left:

i = 1 → heights[1] = 1 < 5 → STOP

So left boundary = 2

► Step 2: Expand Right

Start at  $i = 2$ , move right:

$i = 3 \rightarrow \text{heights}[3] = 6 \geq 5 \rightarrow \text{OK}$

$i = 4 \rightarrow \text{heights}[4] = 2 < 5 \rightarrow \text{STOP}$

So right boundary = 3

▣ Rectangle formed:

Bars: [5, 6]

Indices: 2 3

Height: 5

Width:  $2 \rightarrow (3 - 2 + 1)$

Area:  $5 \times 2 = 10$

### Optimized Approach

-----

- for **each bar**, we want to find:
  - The **first smaller bar on the left**  $\rightarrow$  tells us how far we can go left
  - The **first smaller bar on the right**  $\rightarrow$  tells us how far we can go right
- Using these two, we compute:

$\text{width} = \text{right\_index} - \text{left\_index} - 1$

$\text{area} = \text{height} * \text{width}$

- To do this efficiently in  $O(n)$  time, we use a **monotonic increasing stack**.
- 

Instead of checking for left and right for each bar separately (which is brute force), we use a **Monotonic Stack** to do this in one pass:

**Stack maintains indices of increasing heights.**

**Why increasing?**

- So, when we encounter a **lower height**, we know:
  - We've found the **right boundary** for taller bars.
  - We can now **calculate area** for those taller bars that can't go further.

Let's say  $\text{heights} = [2, 1, 5, 6, 2, 3]$ .

1. While iterating from **left to right**:

- Keep pushing index into stack **if height increases**.
- If height **decreases**, pop from stack and compute:
  - **height** = height of bar at popped index.
  - **width** = current index - index of new stack top - 1

2. After iterating, clean up remaining stack elements.

### Step 1: Initialization

- Let stack be an empty stack storing **indices** of bars.
- Let  $\text{max\_area} = 0$

### Step 2: Iterate over the heights

For each  $i$  from 0 to  $n-1$ :



1. While the **stack is not empty** and `heights[i] < heights[stack.peek()]`:
  - It means the current bar breaks the increasing trend.
  - Pop the top index from the stack → `top = stack.pop()`
  - Compute `height = heights[top]`
  - Compute width:
    - If stack is empty: `width = i`
    - Else: `width = i - stack.peek() - 1`
  - Compute `area = height × width`
  - Update `max_area`
2. Push current index `i` into the stack.

#### ♦ Step 3: Clean up remaining stack

After reaching end of the array (`i == n`), some bars might still be in the stack.

While stack is not empty:

- Pop `top = stack.pop()`
- Compute `height = heights[top]`
- Compute width:
  - If stack is empty: `width = n`
  - Else: `width = n - stack.peek() - 1`
- Compute `area = height × width`
- Update `max_area`

#### Stack = index positions

`i = 0`

- `h[0] = 2` → stack is empty → push 0  
`stack = [0]`

`i = 1`

- `h[1] = 1 < h[stack.peek()]` → pop  
 → `top = 0`, `h[0] = 2`, `width = 1`  
 → `area = 2 × 1 = 2`  
`max_area = 2`, push 1  
`stack = [1]`

`i = 2`

- `h[2] = 5 ≥ h[1]` → push  
`stack = [1, 2]`

`i = 3`

- `h[3] = 6 ≥ h[2]` → push  
`stack = [1, 2, 3]`

`i = 4`

- `h[4] = 2 < h[3]`  
 → pop 3 → `height = 6`, `width = 1` → `area = 6`  
 → pop 2 → `height = 5`, `width = 2` → `area = 10`  
`max_area = 10`, push 4  
`stack = [1, 4]`

and so on.

#### Time Complexity = $O(n)$

- `n` pushes + `n` pops =  $O(n)$
- Everything else inside the loop is constant time.
- Stack stores at most `n` indices →  $O(n)$  space in worst case (e.g., increasing array)

## Kth Smallest element using Priority queue (max heap)

04 June 2025 15:29

Given an  $n \times n$  matrix where each of the rows and columns is sorted in **ascending** order, and an integer  $k$ , return the **kth smallest** element in the matrix.

Sample input=

```
1 5 9
10 11 13
12 13 15
k = 8
```

Sample output=

13

Naive approach

-----

**Idea:**

Flatten the matrix into a 1D array, sort it, and return the  $k$ -th element.

● **Time Complexity:**

- Flattening:  $O(n^2)$
- Sorting:  $O(n \log n)$
- Overall:  $O(n^2 \log n)$

● **Space Complexity:**  $O(n^2)$

**Better Approach (Using max Heap)**

-----

**WHY Max Heap?**

- You want to keep the **smallest  $k$  elements** from the matrix.
- In order to do that, you:
  - Insert each element into a max heap (so the **largest among the  $k$  smallest is on top**)
  - If the heap size exceeds  $k$ , **remove the largest** – i.e., discard the one that **can't be among the  $k$  smallest**.
- At the end, the largest element in the heap (the top) is **the  $k$ -th smallest overall**.
- Traverse the entire matrix ( $n \times n$  elements).
- For each element:
  - Push into a **max heap**
  - If heap size exceeds  $k$ , **remove the top (maximum) element**.
- After traversing all  $n^2$  elements:
  - Heap contains **exactly the  $k$  smallest elements** from the matrix.
  - **Top of heap =  $k$ -th smallest**

**Given matrix:**

```
10 20 30 40
15 25 35 45
24 29 37 48
32 33 39 50
```

**And  $k = 3$**

**We want to find the 3rd smallest element.**

output=20

### ☒ Step-by-Step Max Heap Simulation

We initialize:

- A **max heap** (priority queue with reverse order)
- Insert elements one by one
- If  $\text{size} > k$ , remove the **largest element** from heap

Heap state after each insertion:

**Step Inserted Heap (top is largest) Explanation**

|    |    |              |                                      |
|----|----|--------------|--------------------------------------|
| 1  | 10 | [10]         | $\text{size} \leq k$                 |
| 2  | 20 | [20, 10]     | $\text{size} \leq k$                 |
| 3  | 30 | [30, 10, 20] | $\text{size} = k$                    |
| 4  | 40 | [30, 10, 20] | remove 40 $\rightarrow$ not inserted |
| 5  | 15 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 30 $\rightarrow 30 > 15$      |
| 6  | 25 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 25 $\rightarrow 25 > 20$      |
| 7  | 35 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 35 $\rightarrow 35 > 20$      |
| 8  | 45 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 45 $\rightarrow 45 > 20$      |
| 9  | 24 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 24 $\rightarrow 24 > 20$      |
| 10 | 29 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 29 $\rightarrow 29 > 20$      |
| 11 | 37 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 37 $\rightarrow 37 > 20$      |
| 12 | 48 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 48 $\rightarrow 48 > 20$      |
| 13 | 32 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 32 $\rightarrow 32 > 20$      |
| 14 | 33 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 33 $\rightarrow 33 > 20$      |
| 15 | 39 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 39 $\rightarrow 39 > 20$      |
| 16 | 50 | [20, 10, 15] | remove 50 $\rightarrow 50 > 20$      |

### ☒ Final Heap:

[20, 10, 15]

- Top of heap (largest among  $k$  smallest) = **20**
- So, the **3rd smallest element is 20**

### ☒ Diagram of Heap Evolution

Let's visualize heap as a **binary tree (max heap)** at each main step:

After inserting 10, 20, 30:

```
    30
   /  \
  10   20
```

Insert 40:

```
    30
   /  \
  10   20
```

$\rightarrow$  remove 40  $\rightarrow$  ignored

Insert 15:

```
    20
   /  \
  10   15
```

$\rightarrow$  30 is removed to keep  $\text{size} = k$

Heap always keeps the  $k$  **smallest**, and throws away anything bigger than current top.

## Kth smallest using Binary Search

05 June 2025 11:38

```
10 20 30 40
15 25 35 45
24 29 37 48
32 33 39 50
Let k = 3
```

### ☒ Step 1: Initial range

$\text{low} = \text{matrix}[0][0] = 10$

$\text{high} = \text{matrix}[3][3] = 50$

We binary search on this value range  $[10, 50]$

### ☒ Step 2: Binary Search Loop

#### ► Iteration 1:

$\text{mid} = (10 + 50) / 2 = 30$

Now count how many elements  $\leq 30$ :

Start from bottom-left: (row = 3, col = 0)

→  $\text{matrix}[3][0] = 32 > 30 \rightarrow \text{move up}$

→  $\text{matrix}[2][0] = 24 \leq 30 \rightarrow \text{count} += 3$  (rows 0 to 2) → col++

→  $\text{matrix}[2][1] = 29 \leq 30 \rightarrow \text{count} += 3 \rightarrow \text{col}++$

→  $\text{matrix}[2][2] = 37 > 30 \rightarrow \text{move up}$

→  $\text{matrix}[1][2] = 35 > 30 \rightarrow \text{move up}$

→  $\text{matrix}[0][2] = 30 \leq 30 \rightarrow \text{count} += 1 \rightarrow \text{col}++$

→  $\text{matrix}[0][3] = 40 > 30 \rightarrow \text{move up} \rightarrow \text{out of bounds}$

### ☒ Total count = 3 + 3 + 1 = 7

→  $7 \geq 3 \rightarrow \text{So } 30 \text{ might be the answer}$

→ Update: high = 30

#### ► Iteration 2:

i

$\text{mid} = (10 + 30) / 2 = 20$

Count elements  $\leq 20$ :

Start at (3,0) = 32 > 20 → move up

(2,0) = 24 > 20 → move up

(1,0) = 15 ≤ 20 → count += 2 (rows 0,1) → col++

(1,1) = 25 > 20 → move up

(0,1) = 20 ≤ 20 → count += 1 → col++

(0,2) = 30 > 20 → move up → out of bounds

### ☒ Total count = 2 + 1 = 3

→  $3 \geq 3 \rightarrow 20 \text{ might be the answer}$

→ Update: high = 20

### Iteration 3:

$\text{mid} = (10 + 20) / 2 = 15$

Count elements  $\leq 15$ :

Start at  $(3,0) = 32 > 15 \rightarrow \text{up}$

$(2,0) = 24 > 15 \rightarrow \text{up}$

$(1,0) = 15 \leq 15 \rightarrow \text{count} += 2 \rightarrow \text{col}++$

$(1,1) = 25 > 15 \rightarrow \text{up}$

$(0,1) = 20 > 15 \rightarrow \text{up} \rightarrow \text{out of bounds}$

☒ Total count = 2

$\rightarrow 2 < 3 \rightarrow \text{Need more} \rightarrow \text{low} = \text{mid} + 1 = 16$

Initial range: [10 ..... 50]

$\rightarrow \text{mid} = 30 \rightarrow \text{count} = 7 < 3 \text{ false} \rightarrow \text{high} = 30$

$\rightarrow \text{mid} = 20 \rightarrow \text{count} = 3 < 3 \text{ false} \rightarrow \text{high} = 20$

$\rightarrow \text{mid} = 15 \rightarrow \text{count} = 2 < 3 \text{ true} \rightarrow \text{low} = 16$

$\rightarrow \text{mid} = 18 \rightarrow \text{count} = 2 < 3 \text{ true} \rightarrow \text{low} = 19$

$\rightarrow \text{mid} = 19 \rightarrow \text{count} = 2 < 3 \text{ true} \rightarrow \text{low} = 20$

Now  $\text{low} == \text{high} \rightarrow \text{stop}$ .

return low as the kth smallest element

- **Time:**  $O(n * \log(\text{max} - \text{min}))$ 
  - $\log(\text{max} - \text{min})$  = binary search steps on value range
  - Each step takes  $O(n)$  to count elements  $\leq \text{mid}$
- **Space:**  $O(1) \rightarrow \text{constant}$

### Matrix Value Compared to mid Action Why?

$\leq \text{mid}$  Add row+1 to count Move right (col++) All above are  $\leq \text{mid}$

$> \text{mid}$  Do not count Move up (row--) Need smaller values

### count < k

- This means **there are fewer than k elements** that are  $\leq \text{mid}$ .
  - So, mid is **too small** to be the k-th smallest.
  - We need **larger** values.
  - Hence, do:  $\text{low} = \text{mid} + 1$
- If  $\text{count} \geq k$ , we **can't discard mid**
  - But we want to **try to find a smaller value that still gives us  $\geq k$  elements**

- Hence we do:  $high = mid$

### Condition Meaning

count < k Not enough small elements

count >= k Enough small elements (maybe too many)

### Action

Go right →  $low = mid + 1$

Go left →  $high = mid$

- The binary search runs on the value range:  
 $[min\_element, max\_element] = [matrix[0][0], matrix[n-1][n-1]]$
- So the number of iterations is:  
 $\log_2(max - min)$
- Each time we check a mid value
- So the binary search cuts the **value range**, not the index space

Let's denote this as:

- $d = max\_element - min\_element$   
 → **Binary Search Iterations =  $O(\log d)$**

### 2. Counting Elements $\leq mid$

- For each mid, we start from **bottom-left** (row = n-1, col = 0)
- At most, we take n steps in rows and n steps in columns
- So **each count operation is  $O(n)$**

### Final Time Complexity:

$O(n * \log(max - min))$

Where:

- n = number of rows (or columns)
- max = largest element in matrix
- min = smallest element in matrix

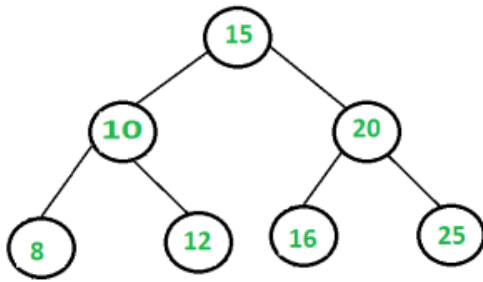
### Space Complexity

- We use **no extra data structures**
- Only a few pointers and variables

Space =  $O(1)$

## sum of all nodes in Binary Tree

04 June 2025 15:17



Output=106

```
int compute_sum(Node root) {  
    if (root == null) return 0;  
    return root.data + compute_sum(root.left) + compute_sum(root.right)  
}
```

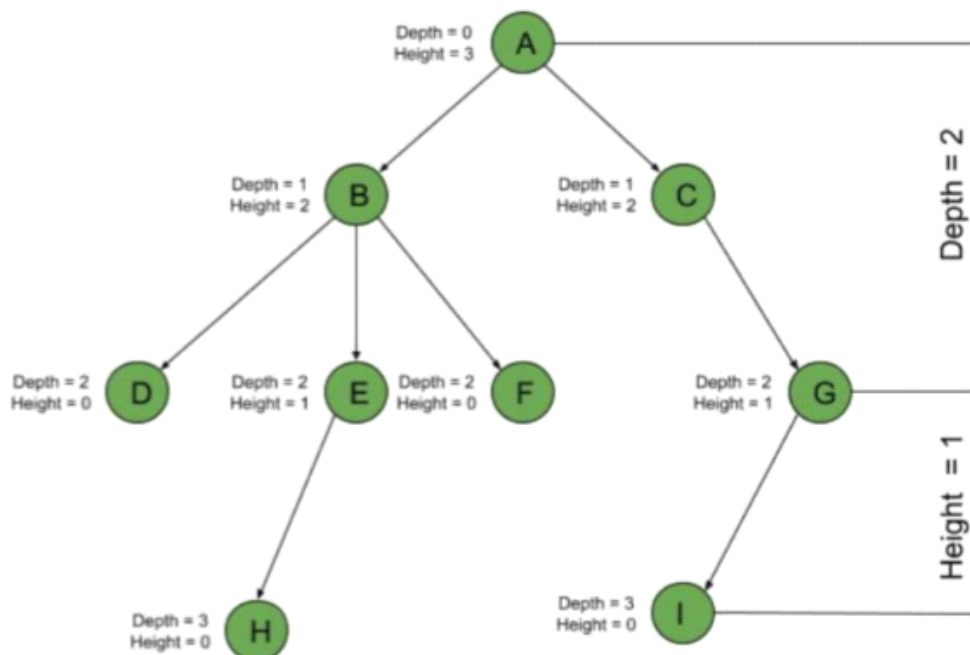
if tree is skewed stack approach is better

```
Stack<Node> stack = new Stack<>()  
stack.push(root)  
while (!stack.isEmpty()) {  
    Node node = stack.pop()  
    sum += node.data  
    if (node.right != null) stack.push(node.right)  
    if (node.left != null) stack.push(node.left)  
}
```



The **depth** of a node is the number of edges present in path from the root node of a tree to that node.

The **height** of a node is the number of edges present in the longest path connecting that node to a leaf node.



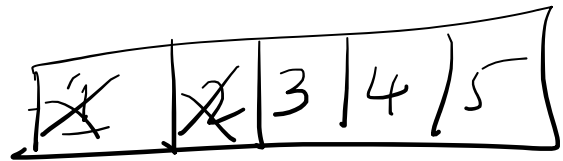
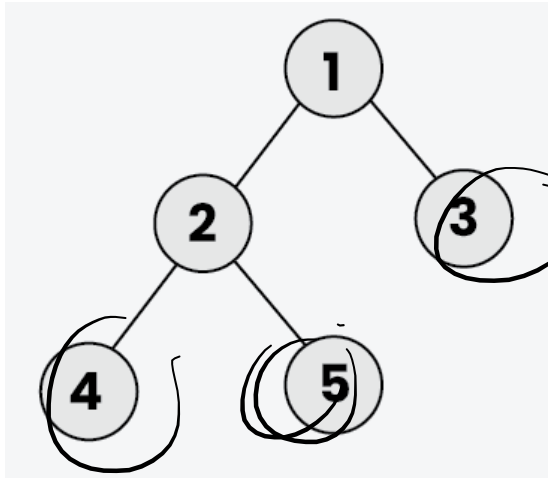
## left view of b tree

03 July 2025 15:45

You are given the **root** of a binary tree. Your task is to return the **left view** of the binary tree. The **left view** of a binary tree is the set of nodes visible when the tree is **viewed** from the **left side**.

If the tree is empty, return an **empty list**.

**Input:** root[] = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, N, N]

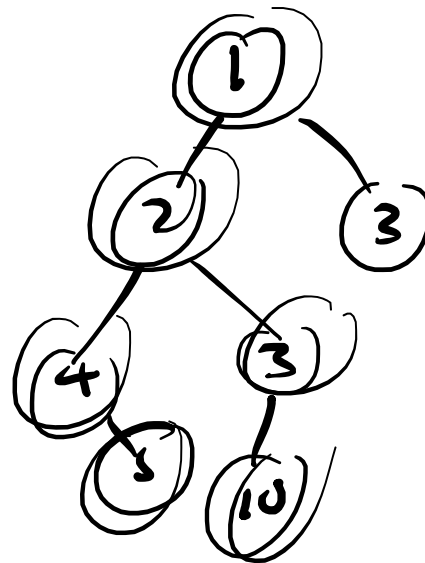
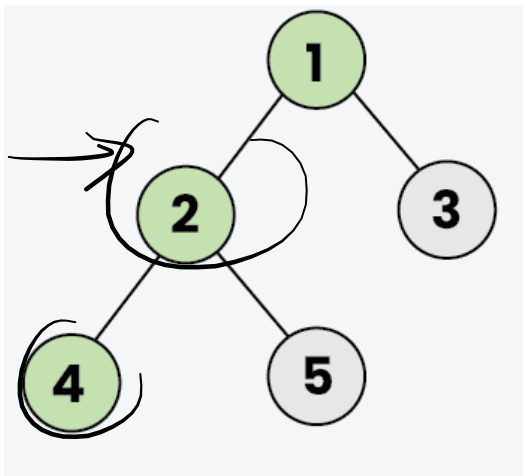


if (i == 0)

1 2 4

**Output:** [1, 2, 4]

**Explanation:** From the left side of the tree, only the nodes 1, 2, and 4 are visible.

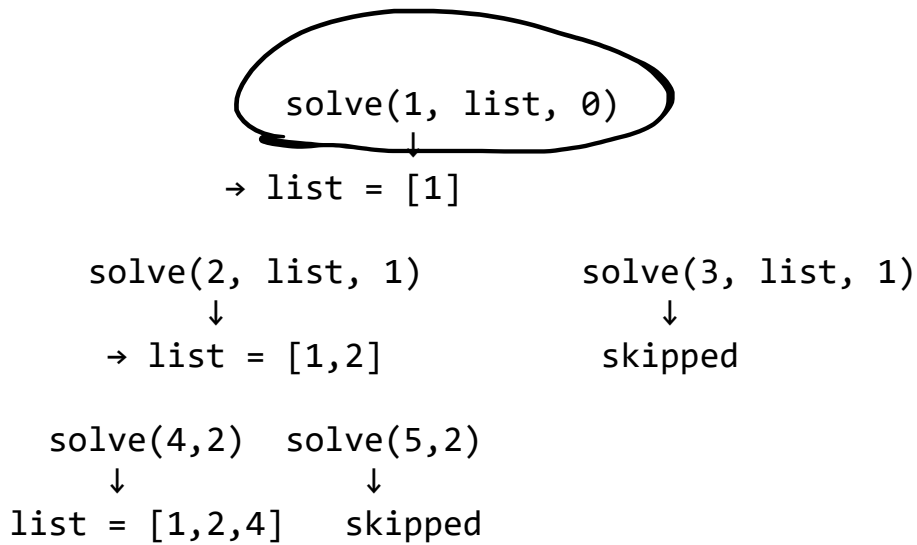


i = 0

i = 2

- **Initialize** an empty list ans to store the result (left view).
- Start a **recursive function** solve(rootnode, level=0):
  - If node is null, return.
  - If ans.size() == level, it means **this is the first node at this level**, so:
    - Add node.data to ans.
- **Recur to the left child first:** solve(node.left, level + 1)

- Then recur to the right child: `solve(node.right, level + 1)`
- After recursion completes, return ans.

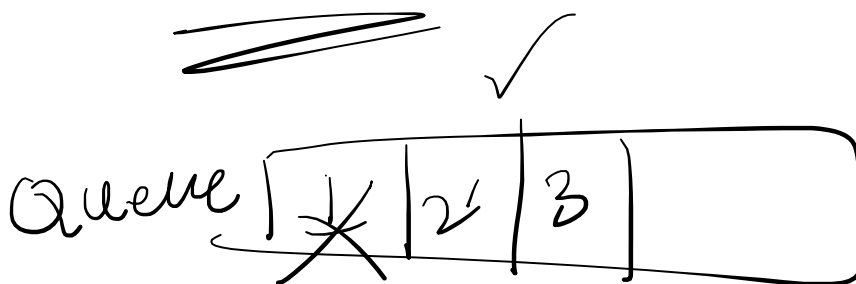


if (list.size() == level)

add node to the list

`solve(node.left, list, level+1)`  
`solve(node.right, list, level+1)`

BFS



while (queue.empty())

{

int s = queue.size

```

)
for ( 0 to S )
  node t = temp = q.poll()
  if (temp.left != null)
    q.add(t.left)
  if (temp.right != null)
    q.add(t.right)
  if (r == 0)

```

## right view of b tree

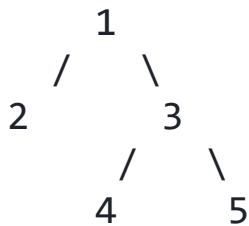
04 June 2025 15:17

Given a Binary Tree, Your task is to return the values visible from **Right view** of it.

Right view of a Binary Tree is set of nodes visible when tree is viewed from **right** side.

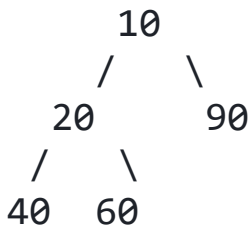
### Examples :

**Input:** root = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

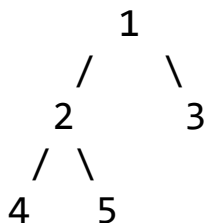


**Output:** [1, 3, 5]

**Input:** root = [10, 20, 90, 40, 60]



**Output:** [10, 90, 60]



solve(1, list, 0)

↓

→ list = [1]

solve(3, list, 1)

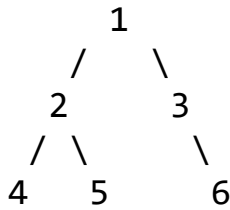
solve(2, list, 1)

|                                              |                   |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| ↓                                            | ↓                 |
| → list = [1,3]                               | skipped           |
| solve(null) solve(null)<br>solve(4, list, 2) | solve(5, list, 2) |
| ↓                                            | ↓                 |
| ↓                                            | ↓                 |
| [1,3,5]                                      | → list =          |
| return<br>skipped                            |                   |

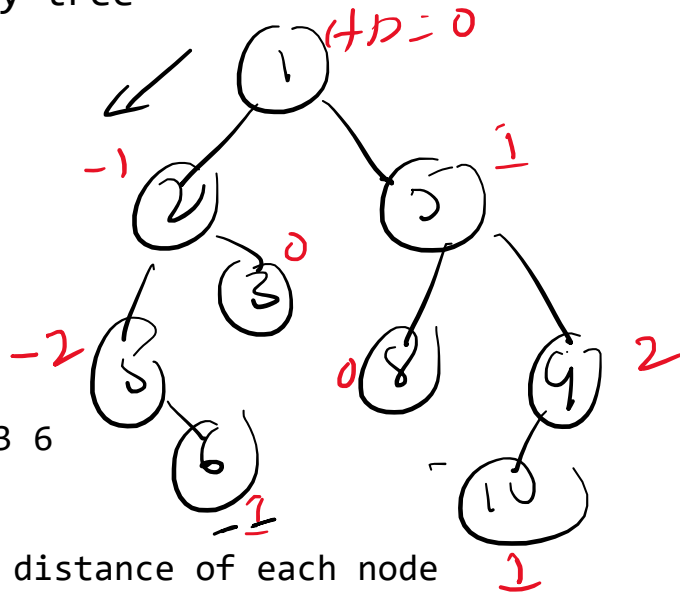
output list = [1, 3, 5]

# top view of the binary tree

04 July 2025 00:15



Top View Output: 4 2 1 3 6



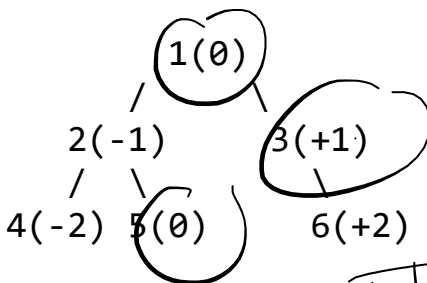
0, 1  
-1, 2  
-2, 5  
1, 5  
+2, 9

step 1: find horizontal distance of each node

HD means **how far a node is from the root**, left or right:

- Root node → HD = 0
- Go left → HD - 1
- Go right → HD + 1

-2, 5  
-1, 2  
0, 1  
1, 5  
2, 9



HD = 0

-2, 4  
-1, 2  
0, 1  
1, 3  
2, 6

→ 0, 1  
-1, 2  
-2, 4  
~~0, 5~~  
1, 3  
+2, 6

step 2:

**Traverse the Tree**

- Start with root at HD = 0
- Add it to the queue
- For each node:
  - If its HD is **not in the map**, add it (means first time we're visiting this column)
  - Add left child to queue with HD - 1
  - Add right child to queue with HD + 1

HD value  
-2, ?  
+1, ?  
-1, ?

step 3:

Once the traversal is done:

- The map has one node per HD
- We **sort the HDs from smallest to largest**
- Print the node data in that order

e

```

class Solution {
    static class Pair {
        Node node;
        int hd;
        Pair(Node n, int h) {
            node = n;
            hd = h;
        }
    }

    static ArrayList<Integer> topView(Node root) {
        ArrayList<Integer> result = new ArrayList<>();
        if (root == null) return result;

        TreeMap<Integer, Integer> map = new TreeMap<>();
        Queue<Pair> q = new LinkedList<>();
        q.add(new Pair(root, 0));

        while (!q.isEmpty()) {
            Pair temp = q.poll();
            int hd = temp.hd;
            Node curr = temp.node;

            if (!map.containsKey(hd)) {
                map.put(hd, curr.data);
            }

            if (curr.left != null)
                q.add(new Pair(curr.left, hd - 1));
            if (curr.right != null)
                q.add(new Pair(curr.right, hd + 1));
        }

        for (int val : map.values()) {
            result.add(val);
        }
        return result;
    }
}

```



## Check BST

04 June 2025 15:20

<

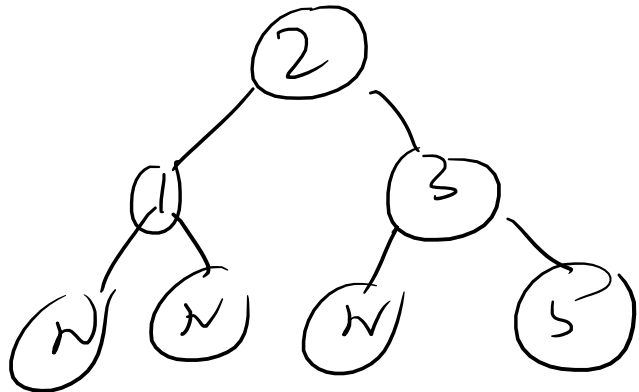
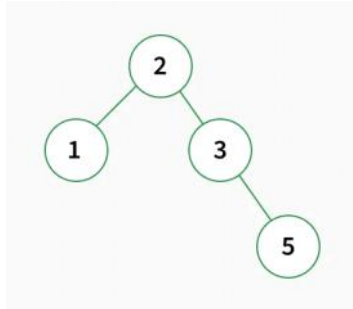
Given the root of a binary tree. Check whether it is a BST or not.

**Note:** We are considering that BSTs can not contain duplicate Nodes.

A **BST** is defined as follows:

- The left subtree of a node contains only nodes with keys **less than** the node's key.
- The right subtree of a node contains only nodes with keys **greater than** the node's key.
- Both the left and right subtrees must also be binary search trees.

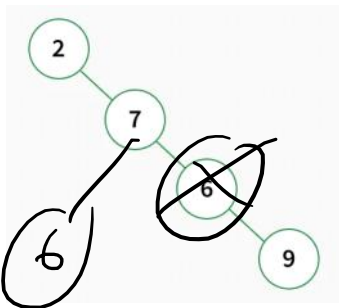
**Input:** root = [2, 1, 3, N, N, N, 5]



**Output:** true

**Explanation:** The left subtree of every node contains smaller keys and right subtree of every node contains greater keys. Hence, the tree is a BST.

**Input:** root = [2, N, 7, N, 6, N, 9]



**Output:** false

**Explanation:** Since the node 6 is in the left subtree of node 7, but 6 is greater than 7, it is not a BST.

```
boolean isBST(Node root) {  
    if(root == null)  
    {  
        return true  
    }  
    if(root.left != null && root.data < findmax(root.left).data)
```

```

    {
        return false
    }
    if(root.right != null && root.data > findmin(root.right).data)
    {
        return false
    }

    return (isBST(root.left) && isBST(root.right))
}

```

```

Node findmin(Node root)

```

```

{
    if(root == null)
    {
        return null
    }
    while(root.left != null)
    {
        root = root.left
    }
    return root
}

```

```

Node findmax(Node root)

```

```

{
    if(root == null)
    {
        return null
    }
    while(root.right != null)
    {
        root = root.right
    }
    return root
}
}

```

Better approach

```

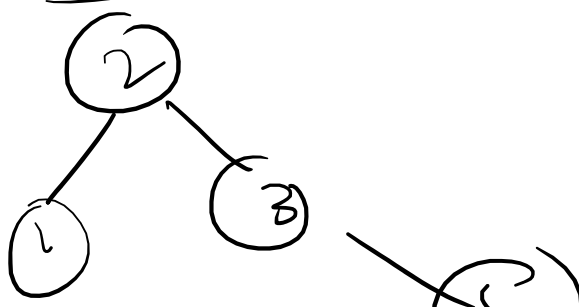
-----
if (is_bst(root, Integer.MIN_VALUE, Integer.MAX_VALUE)) {
    System.out.println("YES")
} else {
    System.out.println("NO")
}

```

```

boolean is_bst(node root, int min, int max) {
    if (root == null) return true
    if (root.data <= min || root.data >= max) return false
    return is_bst(root.left, min, root.data) && is_bst(root.right, root.data, max);
}

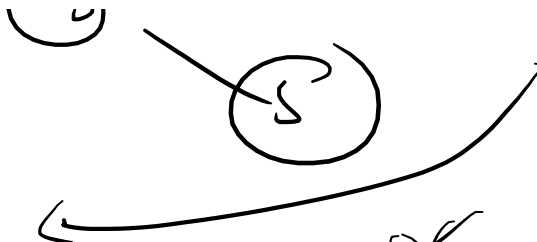
```



$1 <= min$  ✗  
 $1 >= max$  ✗

$is\_bst(1, min, 2)$

(1)



$S(1, \min, 2)$   
 $S(3, 2, \max)$

$1 < \min$   $\times$   
 $1 > 2$   $\times$

$3 < 2$   $\times$   
 $3 > \max$   $\times$

$S(5, 3, \max)$

$5 < 3$   $\times$

$5 > \max$   $\times$

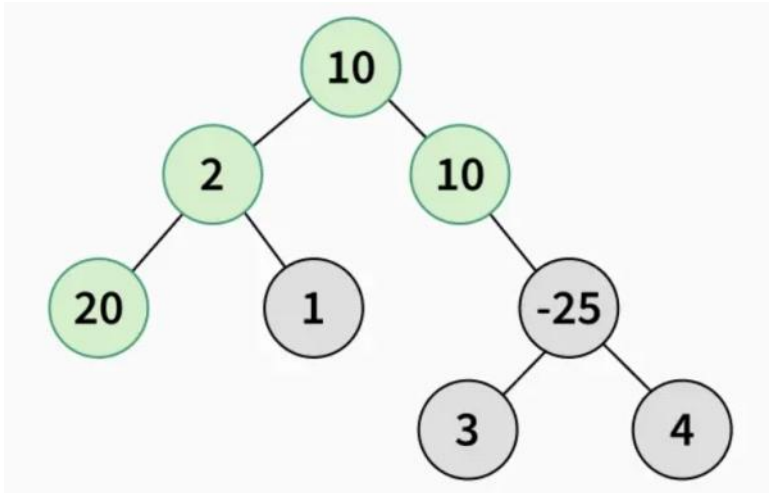
## Maximum Path sum

03 June 2025 14:43

**Input:** root[] = [10, 2, 10, 20, 1, N, -25, N, N, N, N, 3, 4]

**Output:** 42

**Explanation:**



Max path sum is represented using green colour nodes in the above binary tree.

Given a node  $n$ , and:

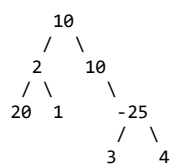
- left = max gain from left subtree
- right = max gain from right subtree

We compute:

- $\text{curr\_sum} = \text{left} + \text{right} + n.\text{val} \rightarrow$  this is the **best sum at this node**
- The function **returns**  $n.\text{val} + \max(\text{left}, \text{right}) \rightarrow$  because only **one path can be extended** upward

We also maintain a **global max** to store the best answer across all nodes.

```
static int max_path_sum(Node root) {
    if (root == null) return 0
    int left = Math.max(0, max_path_sum(root.left))
    int right = Math.max(0, max_path_sum(root.right))
    max_sum = Math.max(max_sum, root.val + left + right)
    return root.val + Math.max(left, right)
}
```



Let's trace bottom-up.

Node -25:

left = 3, right = 4

path sum through node =  $-25 + 3 + 4 = -18 \rightarrow$  update max if better

return to parent =  $-25 + \max(3, 4) = -21$

Node 10 (right of root):

right = -21

path =  $10 + -21 = -11$

return =  $10 + \max(0, -21) = 10$

Node 2:

left = 20, right = 1

local path =  $2 + 20 + 1 = 23$

return =  $2 + \max(20, 1) = 22$

Root 10:

left = 22, right = 10

$\text{path} = 10 + 22 + 10 = 42$

$\text{return} = 10 + \max(22, 10) = 32$

So:

Final max path = 42

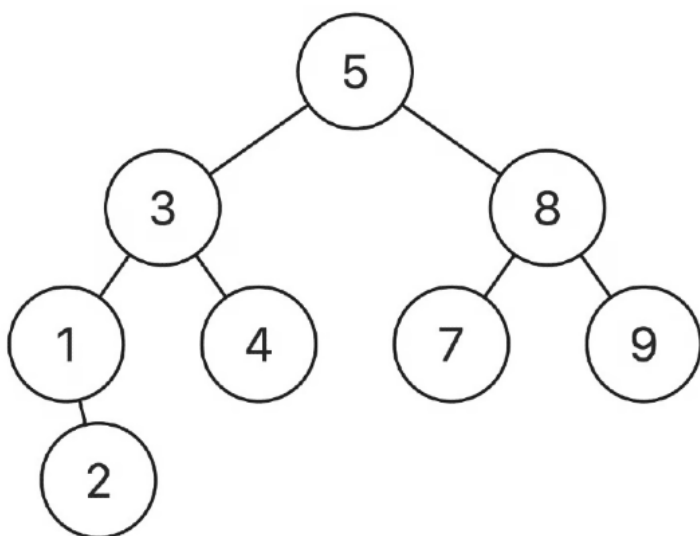
## Lowest common ancestor of given two nodes BSTppa

04 June 2025 15:20

Given a binary search tree (BST) where all node values are *unique*, and two nodes from the tree  $p$  and  $q$ , return the lowest common ancestor (LCA) of the two nodes.

The lowest common ancestor between two nodes  $p$  and  $q$  is the lowest node in a tree  $T$  such that both  $p$  and  $q$  as descendants. The ancestor is allowed to be a descendant of itself.

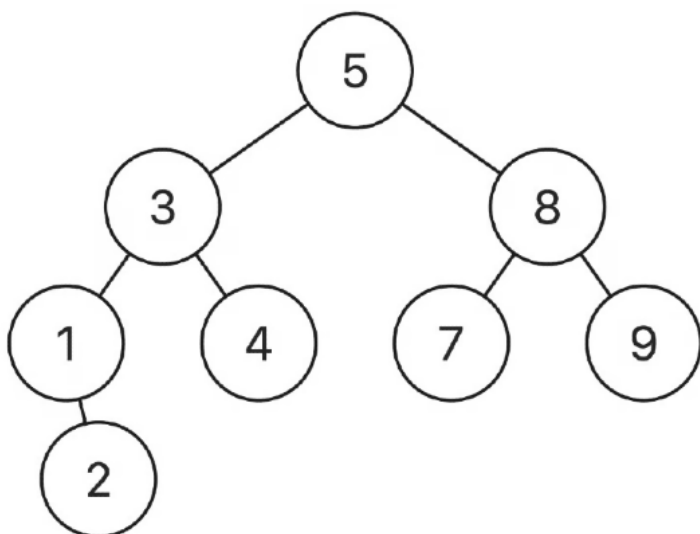
**Example 1:**



Input: root = [5,3,8,1,4,7,9,null,2],  $p = 3$ ,  $q = 8$

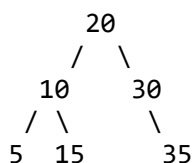
Output: 5

**Example 2:**



Input: root = [5,3,8,1,4,7,9,null,2],  $p = 3$ ,  $q = 4$

Output: 3



LCA(5, 15) → 10

LCA(5, 35) → 20

LCA(30, 35) → 30

```
Node lca(Node root, int n1, int n2) {
    while (root != null) {
        if (n1 < root.val && n2 < root.val)
            root = root.left;
        else if (n1 > root.val && n2 > root.val)
            root = root.right;
        else
            return root;
    }
    return null;
}
```

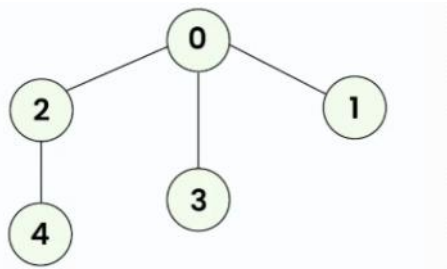


## BFS and DFS traversal

04 June 2025 15:34

Given a **connected undirected graph** containing **V** vertices, represented by a 2-d adjacency list `adj[][]`, where each `adj[i]` represents the list of vertices connected to vertex `i`. Perform a **Breadth First Search (BFS)** traversal starting from vertex `0`, visiting vertices from left to right according to the given adjacency list, and return a list containing the BFS traversal of the graph. **Note:** Do traverse in the **same order** as they are in the given **adjacency list**.

**Input:** `adj[][] = [[2, 3, 1], [0], [0, 4], [0], [2]]`



create adjacency list of this graph

```
0 → 1 2 3
1 → 0
2 → 0 4
3 → 0
4 → 2
```

**Output:** `[0, 2, 3, 1, 4]`

**Explanation:** Starting from `0`, the BFS traversal will follow these steps:

Visit `0` → Output: `0`

Visit `2` (first neighbor of `0`) → Output: `0, 2`

Visit `3` (next neighbor of `0`) → Output: `0, 2, 3`

Visit `1` (next neighbor of `0`) → Output: `0, 2, 3,`

Visit `4` (neighbor of `2`) → Final Output: `0, 2, 3, 1, 4`

```
public ArrayList<Integer> bfs(ArrayList<ArrayList<Integer>> adj) {
    int n=adj.size()
    int[] vis=new int[n+1]
    vis[0]=1
    Queue<Integer> q=new LinkedList<>()
    q.offer(0)
    ArrayList<Integer> bfs=new ArrayList<>()
    while(!q.isEmpty()){
```

```

        int node=q.poll()
        bfs.add(node)
        for(int it:adj.get(node)){
            if(vis[it]!=1){
                vis[it]=1
                q.offer(it)
            }
        }
    }
    return bfs
}
}

```

DFS traversal

-----

**Output:** [0, 2, 4, 3, 1]

**Explanation:** Starting from 0, the DFS traversal proceeds as follows:

Visit 0 → Output: 0

Visit 2 (the first neighbor of 0) → Output: 0, 2

Visit 4 (the first neighbor of 2) → Output: 0, 2, 4

Backtrack to 2, then backtrack to 0, and visit 3 → Output: 0, 2, 4, 3

Finally, backtrack to 0 and visit 1 → Final Output: 0, 2, 4, 3, 1

```

public ArrayList<Integer> dfs(ArrayList<ArrayList<Integer>> adj) {
    boolean vis[]=new boolean[adj.size()]
    vis[0]=true
    ArrayList<Integer> list=new ArrayList<>()
    helper(0,vis,adj,list)
    return list
}

private void helper(int node,boolean vis[],ArrayList<ArrayList<Integer>> adj,ArrayList<Integer> list){
    vis[node]=true
    list.add(node)

    for(int i : adj.get(node))
    {
        if(!vis[i])
            helper(i,vis,adj,list)
    }
}
}

```

# Check if there is a path from src to dest

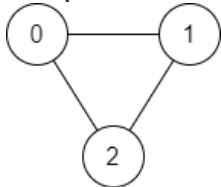
04 June 2025 15:20

There is a **bi-directional** graph with  $n$  vertices, where each vertex is labeled from  $0$  to  $n - 1$  (**inclusive**). The edges in the graph are represented as a 2D integer array `edges`, where each `edges[i] = [ui, vi]` denotes a bi-directional edge between vertex  $u_i$  and vertex  $v_i$ . Every vertex pair is connected by **at most one** edge, and no vertex has an edge to itself.

You want to determine if there is a **valid path** that exists from vertex `source` to vertex `destination`.

Given `edges` and the integers `n`, `source`, and `destination`, return `true` if there is a **valid path** from `source` to `destination`, or `false` otherwise.

**Example 1:**



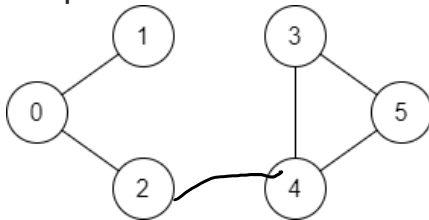
**Input:** `n = 3`, `edges = [[0,1],[1,2],[2,0]]`, `source = 0`, `destination = 2`

**Output:** `true`

**Explanation:** There are two paths from vertex `0` to vertex `2`:

- `0 → 1 → 2`
- `0 → 2`

**Example 2:**



**Input:** `n = 6`, `edges = [[0,1],[0,2],[3,5],[5,4],[4,3]]`, `source = 0`, `destination = 5`

**Output:** `false`

**Explanation:** There is no path from vertex `0` to vertex `5`.

Approach 1 using DFS

```
-----
int source = sc.nextInt()
    int destination = sc.nextInt()

    boolean[] visited = new boolean[n]
    boolean result = dfs(source, destination, adj, visited)

    System.out.println(result)
}

public static boolean dfs(int curr, int dest, ArrayList<ArrayList<Integer>> adj, boolean[] visited) {
    if (curr == dest) return true

    visited[curr] = true

    for (int neighbor : adj.get(curr)) {
        if (!visited[neighbor]) {
            if (dfs(neighbor, dest, adj, visited)) return true
        }
    }

    return false
}
```

```
    }
}
```

approach 2 using BFS

-----

- Start from the source node
- Use a **queue** to explore neighbors level by level
- Mark nodes as **visited** to avoid cycles
- If you reach destination, return true
- If BFS completes and you never reach destination, return false

```
boolean result = bfs(source, destination, adj, n);
```

```
    System.out.println(result)
}
```

```
public static boolean bfs(int source, int destination, ArrayList<ArrayList<Integer>> adj, int
n) {
    boolean[] visited = new boolean[n];
    Queue<Integer> q = new LinkedList<>();

    q.add(source);
    visited[source] = true;

    while (!q.isEmpty()) {
        int node = q.poll()

        if (node == destination) return true

        for (int neighbor : adj.get(node)) {
            if (!visited[neighbor]) {
                visited[neighbor] = true
                q.add(neighbor)
            }
        }
    }

    return false
}
```

```
public boolean validPath(int n, int[][] edges, int source, int destination) {
    ArrayList<ArrayList<Integer>> graph=new ArrayList<>()
    for(int i=0;i<n;i++){
        graph.add(new ArrayList<>());
    }
    for(int[] edge:edges){
        int u=edge[0],v=edge[1];
        graph.get(u).add(v);
        graph.get(v).add(u);
    }
    boolean[] vis=new boolean[n];
    return dfs(graph,vis,source,destination);
}
public boolean dfs(ArrayList<ArrayList<Integer>> graph,boolean[] vis,int src,int tar){
```

```

    if(src==tar)
    return true;
    vis[src]=true;
    for(int neigh:graph.get(src)){
        if(!vis[neigh]){
            boolean an= dfs(graph,vis,neigh,tar);
            if(an)
                return true;
        }
    }
    return false;
}
}

```

## Detect cycle in an undirected graph

04 June 2025 15:56

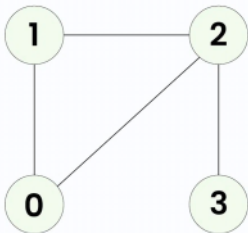
Given an **undirected graph** with **V** vertices and **E** edges, represented as a 2D vector **edges[][]**, where each entry **edges[i] = [u, v]** denotes an edge between vertices **u** and **v**, determine whether the graph contains a **cycle** or not.

### Examples:

**Input:** V = 4, E = 4, edges[][] = [[0, 1], [0, 2], [1, 2], [2, 3]]

**Output:** true

**Explanation:**

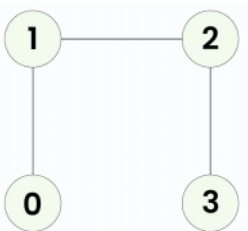


1 -> 2 -> 0 -> 1 is a cycle.

**Input:** V = 4, E = 3, edges[][] = [[0, 1], [1, 2], [2, 3]]

**Output:** false

**Explanation:**



No cycle in the graph.

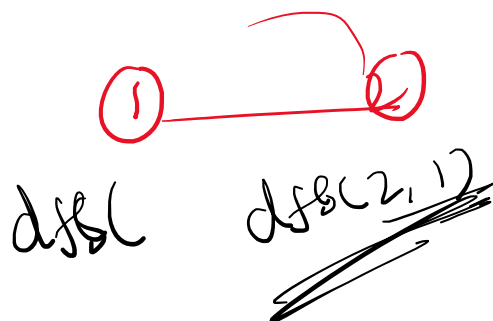
- Use a **visited array** to track visited nodes.
- For each unvisited node, do DFS.
- In DFS:
  - For every neighbor of the current node:
    - If it's **not visited**, recursively call DFS.
    - If it's **visited and not the parent**, cycle exists.

```
boolean[] visited = new boolean[v];
boolean has_cycle = false;

for (int i = 0; i < v; i++) {
    if (!visited[i]) {
        if (dfs(i, -1, visited, adj)) {
            has_cycle = true;
            break;
        }
    }
}

System.out.println(has_cycle);
}
```

```
public static boolean dfs(int node, int parent, boolean[] visited, ArrayList<ArrayList<Integer>> adj) {
    visited[node] = true
```



f

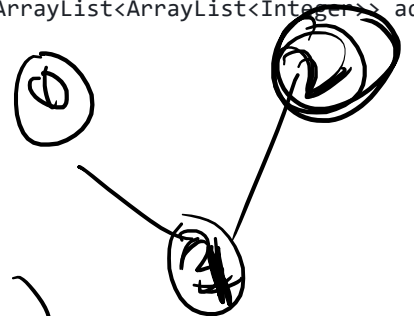
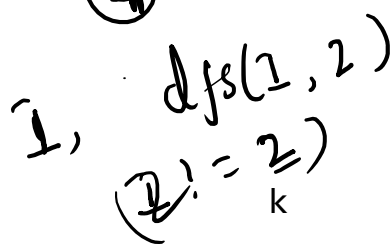
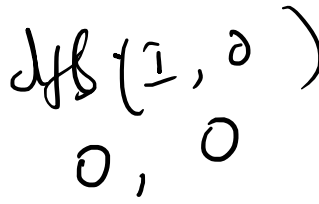
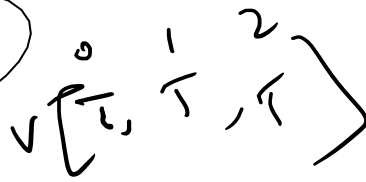
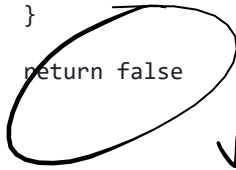
```

public static boolean dfs(int node, int parent, boolean[] visited, ArrayList<ArrayList<Integer>> adj) {
    visited[node] = true

    for (int neighbor : adj.get(node)) {
        if (!visited[neighbor]) {
            if (dfs(neighbor, node, visited, adj))
                return true
        } else if (neighbor != parent) {
            return true
        }
    }

    return false
}

```



# Dijkstras Algorithm

04 June 2025 15:55

<https://www.geeksforgeeks.org/dsa/dijkstras-shortest-path-algorithm-greedy-algo-7/>



## number of provinces

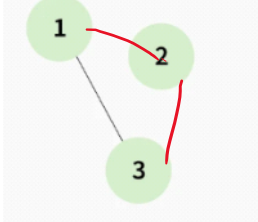
04 June 2025 15:34

Given an **undirected** graph with **V** vertices. We say two vertices  $u$  and  $v$  belong to a single province if there is a path from  $u$  to  $v$  or  $v$  to  $u$ . Your task is to find the number of provinces.

**Note:** A province is a group of **directly** or **indirectly connected** cities and no other cities outside of the group.

**Example 1:**

**Input:**[[1, 0, 1],[0, 1, 0],[1, 0, 1]]

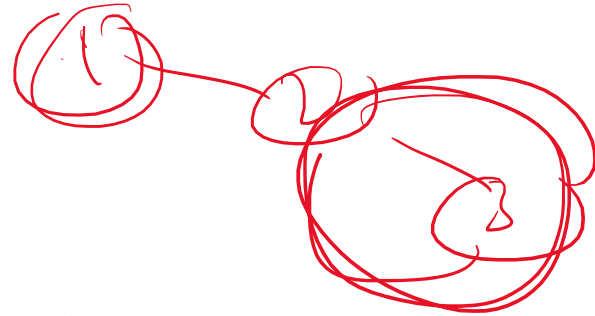


**Output:**

2

**Explanation:**

The graph clearly has 2 Provinces [1,3] and [2]. As city 1 and city 3 has a path between them they belong to a single province. City 2 has no path to city 1 or city 3 hence it belongs to another province.



```
boolean[] visited = new boolean[v];
int count = 0;

for (int i = 0; i < v; i++) {
    if (!visited[i]) {
        dfs(i, visited, adj, v);
        count++;
    }
}

System.out.println(count);
}

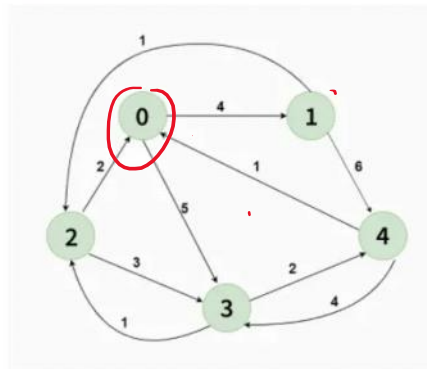
public static void dfs(int node, boolean[] visited, int[][] adj, int v) {
    visited[node] = true;
    for (int j = 0; j < v; j++) {
        if (adj[node][j] == 1 && !visited[j]) {
            dfs(j, visited, adj, v);
        }
    }
}
}
```

# Floyd warshall algorithm

04 July 2025 16:45

```
for (int k = 0; k < v; k++) {
    for (int i = 0; i < v; i++) {
        for (int j = 0; j < v; j++) {
            if (dist[i][k] < inf && dist[k][j] < inf)
                dist[i][j] = Math.min(dist[i][j], dist[i][k] + dist[k][j]);
        }
    }
}
```

Input: dist[][] = [[0, 4, 10<sup>8</sup>, 5, 10<sup>8</sup>],  
[10<sup>8</sup>, 0, 1, 10<sup>8</sup>, 6],  
[2, 10<sup>8</sup>, 0, 3, 10<sup>8</sup>],  
[10<sup>8</sup>, 10<sup>8</sup>, 1, 0, 2],  
[1, 10<sup>8</sup>, 10<sup>8</sup>, 4, 0]]



$$\begin{aligned} \text{dist}[1][2] &= \min(\text{dist}[1][2], \text{dist}[1][0] + \text{dist}[0][2]) \\ &= \min(\infty, 4 + 2) \\ &= \min(\infty, 6) \\ &= \underline{6} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{dist}[4][1] &= \min( \\ &\quad \text{dist}[4][1], \text{dist}[4][0] + \text{dist}[0][1] ) \\ &= \min(6, 1 + 4) \\ &= \underline{5} \end{aligned}$$